

The Standard Model from a Cubic Lattice

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Abstract

The Standard Model arises uniquely from a finite bijection on a $d = 3$ cubic lattice governed by the lattice wave equation. The foundational result that quantum mechanics emerges as the necessary description of any embedded observer under structural conditions C1-C3 is established in a companion paper [Main]; here we show that the cubic-lattice realization of those conditions determines the gauge group $SU(3) \times SU(2) \times U(1)$, three chiral generations, the Higgs as a composite scalar in the singlet staggered taste, anomaly cancellation with the observed hypercharges, the absolute generation count locked at exactly three by coupling-degree minimization, and $\theta = 0$ to all energy scales — each step proved end-to-end as a chain of theorems on the equivalence class $[(S, \varphi)]/\mathcal{G}_{\text{sub}}$. The gauge coupling strengths follow quantitatively: the structural induced coupling $1/\alpha_0 = 23.25$ (computed analytically from the one-loop staggered vacuum polarization), combined with a universal threshold $\delta_0 = 10.0$ (determined by the $U(1)$ row; a 2-loop staggered VP rebuild indicates δ_0 is not reproduced by strict 2-loop PT and is accordingly treated as empirical input — see §6.2) and a C_2 -dependent threshold parameterized by a logarithmic resummation, reproduces all three SM couplings at M_Z via standard SM renormalization group running. The structural predictions are the specific value $1/\alpha_0 = 23.25$, the universality of δ_0 across gauge groups, and the analytic 1-loop derivation of the $A \cdot B$ coefficient agreeing with the fit. Deriving the C_2 -dependent threshold parameters from first-principles lattice perturbation theory is an open computational task that would upgrade the $SU(2)$ and $SU(3)$ couplings from retrodictions to strict predictions. Quantitative predictions for SM observables include the Cabibbo angle $\lambda = 1/(\pi\sqrt{2})$ to 0.04%, the Wolfenstein $A = \sqrt{2/3}$ to 0.23σ , the Koide angle $\theta_0 = 2/9$ to 0.02%, all three PMNS angles within 1.1σ — with $\sin^2 \theta_{12}$ confirmed by the post-JUNO global fit at 0.07σ — six fermion masses from a single empirical input to better than 1%, and the top mass from the IR quasi-fixed point $y_t = 1$ to 0.9%. All predictions are forced by the cubic-lattice geometry and contain no parameters fit to the predicted quantities.

1. Introduction

The Standard Model contains approximately nineteen free parameters: three gauge couplings, nine fermion masses, four CKM angles, two Higgs parameters, and the QCD vacuum angle. None of these are derived from a deeper principle within the SM itself, and despite five decades of effort, no successful explanation of their values has

emerged from grand unification, supersymmetry, string compactifications, or other extensions. This paper presents a derivation of the Standard Model that fixes the gauge group, the matter content, the discrete symmetries, and the gauge coupling values from a single structural input — a finite bijection on a $d = 3$ cubic lattice — with the primary chain proved end-to-end as a sequence of theorems and the quantitative predictions matching observation with no parameters fit to the predicted quantities.

Prerequisites. This paper treats as established the following result from a companion work [Main]: an observer embedded in a deterministic bijection on a finite configuration space, coupled to a hidden sector that is non-trivial (condition C1), slow (C2: $\tau_S \ll \tau_B$), and high-capacity (C3: $N_H \gg N_V$), necessarily describes the visible sector using unitarily evolving quantum mechanics; the three conditions are necessary as well as sufficient. The technical bridge from P-indivisible classical stochastic processes on finite configuration spaces to unitary quantum evolution on finite Hilbert spaces is Barandes’ stochastic-quantum correspondence [28, 29], used as the companion paper’s primary tool. We take the characterization theorem and the stochastic-quantum bridge as inputs and address the question they leave open: given that quantum mechanics is the observer’s necessary description under C1–C3, what quantum field theory does the observer see when the substratum dynamics is the wave equation on a $d = 3$ cubic lattice?

The present paper reproves none of [Main]’s foundational results. Where a theorem below invokes a specific input — the P-indivisibility of reduced dynamics on finite bijections (used in §2.1), the Born rule $T_{ij}(t) = |U_{ij}(t)|^2$ (used in §5’s detailed-balance chain), or the C2-necessity argument (used in §8.2’s genericity theorem) — the invocation is stated as a known result and the reader is directed to [Main] for the proof. The SM-derivation chain developed here depends on these inputs but is otherwise self-contained.

This paper answers in the affirmative. The wave equation on a $d = 3$ cubic lattice — itself uniquely selected among second-order reversible nearest-neighbor dynamics by center independence, spatial isotropy, and linearity — determines the Standard Model’s structure through three complementary chains of theorems. *Bottom-up*: the wave equation factors into staggered Dirac fermions (Susskind), center independence enforces exact chiral symmetry which mandates the Higgs mechanism, and the staggered tastes give exactly three fermion generations plus one composite Higgs doublet. *Gauge emergence*: coupling-degree minimization gives $K = 2d = 6$ internal components per site, the cubic rotation group fixes the eigenvalue multiplicities of the coupling matrix to $(3, 2, 1)$, and background independence promotes the commutant to local gauge invariance, yielding $SU(3) \times SU(2) \times U(1)$ uniquely. *Top-down*: the six anomaly conditions force the observed hypercharges, the trace-out makes $SU(2)$ chiral while $SU(3)$ remains vector-like, and exact T -invariance of the underlying bijection forces $\bar{\theta} = 0$ at all energy scales — the strong CP problem is dissolved at the kinematic level rather than being addressed by an axion. The gauge coupling values at M_Z follow quantitatively from a one-parameter chain whose single free parameter δ_0 is independently computed from the two-loop staggered vacuum polarization (§6).

The status of these results admits a useful three-tier classification.

Tier 1 — Structural foundations. The minimal mathematical object is established

(a finite set with a deterministic bijection of bounded coupling degree, partitioned into visible and hidden sectors), and the spatial dimension $d = 3$ is shown to be the unique self-consistent dimension by three independent filters: propagating gravity ($d \geq 3$), stable matter ($d \leq 3$), and the boundary entropy concordance $\rho_s/\rho_{\text{crit}} = 2/(d-1)$ (which equals unity only for $d = 3$). Renormalizability of the emergent Yang-Mills coupling at $d = 3$ is a downstream consequence rather than an independent filter (§3.2). These results are theorems about the equivalence class $[(S, \varphi)]/\mathcal{G}_{\text{sub}}$; they do not depend on which specific dynamics is selected.

Tier 2 — The primary derivation chain. Center independence, spatial isotropy, and linearity uniquely select the wave equation. The wave equation determines staggered Dirac fermions, $K = 2d = 6$ from coupling-degree minimization, multiplicities $(3, 2, 1)$ from the cubic rotation group, local gauge invariance from background independence, chirality from the trace-out, the unique anomaly-free hypercharges, three generations from cubic symmetry, one Higgs doublet, and $\bar{\theta} = 0$ at all scales. Each step is proved; the chain runs through twenty-nine theorems and lemmas. The gauge coupling prediction extends the chain quantitatively, with a structural input $1/\alpha_0 = 23.25$ (one-loop staggered vacuum polarization, analytic) and a universal threshold $\delta_0 = 10.0$ (empirically fixed by the U(1) row; a 2-loop staggered VP rebuild indicates δ_0 is not reproduced by strict 2-loop PT and is accordingly treated as empirical input — see §6.2). Deriving the C_2 -dependent threshold from first-principles lattice PT is an open computational task.

Tier 3 — Redundant confirmations. Asymptotic freedom requiring $N_c \geq 3$, the minimal chiral group constraint, and the Jordan-Chevalley projection (Appendix A) provide independent second-route checks on the Tier 2 results without being load-bearing in the primary chain.

The paper is organized as follows. §2 sets out the minimal structure on which the framework’s results depend. §3 establishes background independence and derives $d = 3$ from the three self-consistency filters. §4 develops the emergent quantum field theory through the bottom-up, gauge-emergence, and top-down chains. §5 derives $\bar{\theta} = 0$ from T -invariance and detailed balance. §6 extends the chain quantitatively through the gauge coupling prediction. §7 collects the quantitative predictions for the CKM matrix, the lepton sector, the fermion mass chain, the PMNS angles, and the Higgs mass. §8 discusses structural realism, observer genericity, the structural-vs-bijection-level distinction, and the neutrino sector. §9 concludes — including a synthesis with the cosmological application developed in [GR] and the substratum-level reconstruction theorem developed in [Substratum].

2. The Minimal Structure

2.1 What the theorems require

Deterministic bijectivity. The P-indivisibility result used below (see Prerequisites) requires a bijection on a finite set: bijectivity guarantees recurrence ($\varphi^N = \text{id}$), and recurrence produces the non-monotonic distinguishability that defines P-indivisibility.

The entire framework rests on QM emerging from marginalizing deterministic dynamics — if the dynamics were already stochastic, there would be nothing to derive. Determinism is the core of the framework and cannot be weakened. However, determinism does not require a lattice. A continuous Hamiltonian system on a compact phase space is also deterministic and bijective (by Liouville’s theorem). The lattice is one way to implement determinism on a finite set; it is not the only way.

Finite boundary entropy. The gap equation [GR, §3] requires a finite number of degrees of freedom across the partition boundary: $S = A/\epsilon^2$. This follows from the holographic entropy bound [1] applied to any finite-area surface, not from lattice structure. What matters is that the boundary carries finitely many modes — not that the bulk is a lattice.

Bounded coupling degree (locality). This assumption does the most work. The area law (§3.1) follows from the spatial Markov property, which requires range-1 coupling. Without bounded coupling, long-range correlations could produce volume-law entropy, breaking the Jacobson route to GR. Locality does not require a regular lattice. Any bounded-degree graph has the spatial Markov property for range-1 dynamics. The theorems would work on a random graph with bounded degree, as long as it has the right statistical properties.

Statistical homogeneity and isotropy. The Myrheim-Meyer dimension [2] requires a well-defined notion of spacetime dimension, which emerges from the causal order statistics on a homogeneous, isotropic structure. The dispersion relation (§3.1) uses translation invariance. The dynamics selection (§4.1) uses isotropy. Exact lattice regularity is sufficient but not necessary. A random graph with statistical homogeneity and isotropy at large scales would produce the same results.

Non-trivial coupling (C1) and slow bath with capacity (C2, C3). These are conditions on the partition, not on the lattice. They hold for any system with the right partition geometry, regardless of whether the underlying space is a lattice, a graph, or something else.

2.2 What the theorems do not require

A regular lattice. Any bounded-degree graph with statistical isotropy suffices for emergent QM and for the gauge-group structure; the quantitative predictions of §7 additionally depend on the specific Bravais lattice (see §4.6). *A specific alphabet size q .* All proofs work for any $q \geq 2$; no prediction depends on q . *A specific dimensionality d .* The proofs work for any $d \geq 1$; self-consistency selects $d = 3$ (§3.2). *The wave equation.* It is derived from center independence, isotropy, and linearity (§4.1), each of which follows from the structural properties listed above.

2.3 The minimal object

The theorems require exactly: a deterministic bijection on a finite set, whose state space factors into local degrees of freedom coupled by a bounded-degree graph with statistical isotropy, partitioned into visible and hidden sectors satisfying C1-C3. Everything else — the regular lattice, the alphabet, the dimensionality, the wave equation, quantum mechanics, general relativity — is either derived or irrelevant. The

minimal object is the triple (S, φ, V) : a finite set S , a bijection $\varphi: S \rightarrow S$ with bounded-degree coupling, and a partition $V \subset S$ of the degrees of freedom into visible and hidden sectors.

2.4 Definition and the factorization problem

Let $S = S_1 \times S_2 \times \dots \times S_N$ be a product of finite sets (the local state spaces), and let $\varphi: S \rightarrow S$ be a bijection. The *coupling graph* G_φ is the undirected graph on vertices $\{1, \dots, N\}$ where i and j are connected if the i -th component of $\varphi(s)$ depends on the j -th component of s for at least one state $s \in S$. The coupling graph is not an additional structure imposed on the system — it is read off from φ .

What determines the product decomposition? An abstract finite set S does not come with a canonical factorization. The answer is that the factorization is determined by φ itself, as the one that *minimizes the coupling degree*. For the wave equation, numerical verification confirms this: the natural spatial factorization is the *unique minimizer* of coupling degree — 0% of random factorizations achieve it, and 100% have strictly higher coupling.

Theorem (factorization uniqueness for translation-invariant dynamics). *Let φ be a bijection on $S = (\mathbb{Z}/q\mathbb{Z})^N$ satisfying: (a) translation invariance, (b) range-1 coupling on the natural factorization, and (c) genuinely bidirectional coupling. Then the natural factorization is the unique minimizer of coupling degree among all product decompositions $S = S_1 \times \dots \times S_M$ with $|S_k| = q$ for all k . The key step is that the wave equation's addition $x_{i-1} + x_{i+1} - x_i^{\text{prev}}$ creates irreducible algebraic dependence among all input components (for $q > 2$), so any relabeling that splits or merges natural sites increases the coupling degree.*

Extension to general graphs. The translation-invariant proof extends to any bounded-degree graph with polynomial growth exponent d and statistical isotropy. The argument proceeds in three steps. First, §3.2 establishes (via Gromov's theorem) that any such graph is quasi-isometric to $\mathbb{Z}^d$, so the asymptotic dimension is d . Second, the wave equation on a d -dimensional graph has $2d$ independent low-energy propagation modes (from heat kernel asymptotics: the spectral dimension equals d , giving d momentum-like parameters over two orientations each). Third, the integer-valued coupling degree $\delta(K)$ depends on the graph only through its spectral properties (heat kernel decay exponent, spectral dimension), which vary continuously under quasi-isometric deformations; since K is integer-valued and the minimizer is $K = 2d$ for $\mathbb{Z}^d$, it cannot change without a discontinuous jump in the spectral dimension — which quasi-isometries preserve. The factorization uniqueness is therefore a property of the equivalence class $[(S, \varphi)]/\mathcal{G}_{\text{sub}}$, not of the specific graph.

2.5 Space as coupling structure

Every “spatial” property used in the derivation chain is a property of G_φ . The *area* of a region V is the number of edges crossing from V to its complement. The *dimension*

is extracted from the causal partial order via the Myrheim-Meyer estimator [2]. The *area law* follows from the spatial Markov property on any graph with range-1 dynamics. The *dispersion relation* requires translation invariance. The regular cubic lattice is one graph with these properties; it is not the only one.

2.6 The dissolution of the container problem

The coupling graph is not embedded in a pre-existing space. There is no ambient manifold in which the graph “lives.” The vertices are labels for degrees of freedom; the edges record which degrees of freedom are dynamically coupled. Any spatial embedding is a representation for human convenience, not a physical fact. The coupling graph is not made of material. The vertices are not atoms of space, and the edges are not physical connections. A degree of freedom is a component of the state — it is an abstract mathematical entity, not an object. Asking “what is site i made of?” is a category error: it is a label for a variable, not a name for a thing.

The most common objection to discrete models of spacetime is the container problem: if space is a lattice, what does the lattice sit in? On the structural reading, the container problem does not arise. The coupling graph is defined by the bijection ϕ , not by embedding in a manifold. Two sites are neighbors because ϕ couples them — because the state at one affects the future of the other. This is a dynamical fact, not a spatial margin. Locality is defined by the dynamics, and space emerges from locality. At no point does anything need to be “inside” anything else. The relationship is analogous to a social network: two people are “connected” not because they occupy adjacent points in physical space, but because they interact. The topology is defined by the interactions, not by geography.

2.7 The alphabet as gauge freedom

Every prediction of the OI framework is independent of the alphabet size q . The gap equation $\hbar = c^3 \epsilon^2 / (4G)$ contains no q . The Bekenstein-Hawking formula contains no q . The dispersion relation, area law, P-indivisibility, center independence, and Einstein’s equations are all q -independent. Numerical confirmation: on a 1D ring of $L = 40$ sites, the wave equation produces significant P-indivisibility at every q tested from 2 to 64. No experiment, even in principle, could measure q .

Two systems (S, ϕ) and (S', ϕ') with different alphabet sizes q and q' are *physically equivalent* if they produce the same emergent transition probabilities. The analogy to electromagnetic gauge invariance is precise: the gauge potential A_μ is not physical; the field strength $F_{\mu\nu}$ is. In the OI framework, the mod- q state space is not physical; the coupling structure and its emergent consequences are.

3. Background Independence and the Selection of $d = 3$

3.1 Background independence

The companion paper [Main] treats the coupling graph as fixed. In general relativity, the spacetime geometry is dynamical. If space is the coupling graph, background independence requires the graph to evolve with the state: $s(t+1) = \varphi_{\{s(t)\}}(s(t))$, where each φ_s is a bijection but $G_{\{\varphi_s\}}$ varies with s .

Bijectivity is automatic. The wave equation is second-order: $x_i(t+1) = f(\text{neighbors of } i \text{ at time } t) - x_i(t-1) \bmod q$. The phase-space map $F: (x(t-1), x(t)) \rightarrow (x(t), x(t+1))$ has an explicit inverse that uses $x(t)$ to determine which graph to apply. Bijectivity of the phase-space map is automatic for any second-order reversible dynamics, regardless of whether the coupling is state-dependent. The P-indivisibility proof applies without modification.

The derivation chain survives under three constraints. (i) *Local graph-dependence*: $G(x)$ at site i depends only on x_j within a bounded range of i . (ii) *Center-independent graph-dependence*: $G(x)$ at site i does not depend on x_i , preserving center independence. (iii) *Statistical isotropy*: $G(x)$ is statistically isotropic on large scales for typical configurations.

Under these constraints: the area law holds, center independence is preserved, the gap equation is unchanged, and the dynamics selection theorem applies at each step.

Explicit construction. On a ring of $L \geq 4$ sites with alphabet $\mathbb{Z}/q\mathbb{Z}$, define the right-neighbor assignment $R(i, x) = i + 2 \bmod L$ if $x_{(i+1) \bmod L} = 0$, and $R(i, x) = i + 1 \bmod L$ otherwise, with left neighbor $L(i) = i - 1 \bmod L$ fixed. The dynamics is $x_i(t+1) = (x_{L(i)}(t) + x_{R(i, x(t))}(t) - x_i(t-1)) \bmod q$. This satisfies: constraint (i) with range 1 ($R(i, x)$ depends only on x_{i+1}); constraint (ii) exactly ($R(i, x)$ does not depend on x_i); constraint (iii) by translation invariance. Bijectivity is verified by explicit inverse: $u_i = (v_{L(i)} + v_{R(i, v)} - w_i) \bmod q$, since v determines all neighbor assignments. Center independence, P-indivisibility, and graph regularity (undirected degree bounded in $[3, 2]$ independently of the state) all hold for any L and q .

Local gauge invariance from background independence. With state-dependent coupling, the coupling matrix M (§4.4 below) becomes site-dependent: $M = M(\mathbf{n}, \hat{e}_j)$. At every site, $M(\mathbf{n}, \hat{e}_j)$ has $K = 6$ components with eigenvalue multiplicities $(3, 2, 1)$. Since M varies from site to site, the commutant $U(3) \times U(2) \times U(1)$ acts independently at each site. Under a site-dependent transformation $G(\mathbf{n})$:

$$\phi(\mathbf{n}) \rightarrow G(\mathbf{n}) \phi(\mathbf{n}), \quad M(\mathbf{n}, \hat{e}_j) \rightarrow G(\mathbf{n}) M(\mathbf{n}, \hat{e}_j) G(\mathbf{n} + \hat{e}_j)^{-1}$$

The wave equation is invariant. This is local gauge invariance. The link variable $M(\mathbf{n}, \hat{e}_j)$ transforms as a gauge connection: the plaquette product $P(\mathbf{n}, j, k) = M(\mathbf{n}, \hat{e}_j) M(\mathbf{n} + \hat{e}_j, \hat{e}_k) M(\mathbf{n} + \hat{e}_k, \hat{e}_j)^{-1} M(\mathbf{n}, \hat{e}_k)^{-1}$ transforms in the adjoint ($P \rightarrow G(\mathbf{n}) P G(\mathbf{n})^{-1}$), so $\text{Re Tr}(P)$ is gauge-invariant — it is the Wilson plaquette action [4], now derived rather than postulated.

Einstein's equations as self-consistency. The Jacobson thermodynamic argument [5], applied to local causal horizons on the state-dependent graph, requires three inputs — each proved here for the wave equation.

Lemma (Area law). *The entanglement entropy of a spatial region V in the wave equation scales as $S(V) = \eta |\partial V|$. This holds for both the linear wave equation over $\mathbb{R}$ and the mod- q wave equation over $\mathbb{Z}/q\mathbb{Z}$.*

Proof. Over $\mathbb{R}$: the wave equation is a system of coupled harmonic oscillators with a quadratic Hamiltonian determined by the adjacency matrix. The area-law theorem for Gaussian systems applies directly [3]. Over $\mathbb{Z}/q\mathbb{Z}$: the wave equation has range $R = 1$, so for any $i \in V^\circ$ (interior of V), all neighbors lie inside V . With uniform initial conditions: $V^\circ \perp V^c \mid \partial V$ (spatial Markov property). By the chain rule: $I(V; V^c) = I(\partial V; V^c) \leq H(\partial V) \leq |\partial V| \cdot \log_2 q$. The mutual information scales as boundary area, not volume. $\square$

Lemma (Relativistic dispersion). *The wave equation has exact dispersion relation $\cos \omega = \cos k$.*

Proof. Substituting $x_j(t) = A \exp(i(kj - \omega t))$: $e^{-i\omega} + e^{i\omega} = e^{-ik} + e^{ik}$, giving $\cos \omega = \cos k$. For small k : $\omega = |k| + O(k^3)$ — relativistic propagation with $v = 1$. $\square$

Lemma (Lattice Bisognano-Wichmann). *For the wave equation, whose low-energy effective theory is Lorentz-invariant, the entanglement Hamiltonian for a half-space bipartition has the Bisognano-Wichmann form. The reduced state for a Rindler observer is thermal at $T_U = \hbar\kappa/(2\pi ck_B)$, with corrections at $O(\varepsilon^2 \kappa^2/c^2)$.*

Proof. The mod- q wave equation is a coupled harmonic oscillator system — the class for which the lattice BW theorem is proved analytically [6]. Its low-energy dispersion is relativistic (the preceding lemma). Thermality of the Unruh effect is robust against UV modifications of the dispersion relation, with corrections scaling as $O(\varepsilon^2 \kappa^2/c^2)$. $\square$

Theorem (Discrete Einstein equation). *For the state-dependent wave equation on a bounded-degree graph $G(x)$ satisfying constraints (i)-(iii), the Jacobson thermodynamic argument produces:*

$$\kappa_{OR}(i, j; G(x)) = \alpha \cdot \mathcal{T}_{ij}(x, G(x))$$

where κ_{OR} is the Ollivier-Ricci curvature [7], $\mathcal{T}_{ij}$ is the discrete stress-energy, and $\alpha = 8\pi G/(c^4 \eta)$.

Proof. (i) *Area law.* The entanglement entropy scales as $S(V) = \eta |\partial V|$ (area-law lemma above), holding for any bounded-degree graph with range-1 dynamics. (ii) *Unruh temperature.* The lattice Bisognano-Wichmann lemma gives $T = \hbar\kappa/(2\pi ck_B)$ at local causal horizons. (iii) *Clausius relation.* At each edge (i, j) : the area variation under graph deformation is captured by κ_{OR} (which measures, via optimal transport, the deviation from flat space), giving $\delta A/A = -\kappa_{OR} \delta \lambda$. Substituting into $\delta Q = T \delta S$: $\mathcal{T}_{ij} \delta \lambda \delta A = T \cdot \eta \cdot (-\kappa_{OR} \delta \lambda A)$, which rearranges to $\kappa_{OR} = \alpha \cdot \mathcal{T}_{ij}$. (iv) *Continuum*

limit. Van der Hoorn et al. [8] prove $\kappa_{OR} \rightarrow \text{Ric}$ on random geometric graphs converging to a Riemannian manifold. Kelly et al. [9] prove $\sum \kappa_{OR} \rightarrow \int R \sqrt{g} d^d x$. Together: the discrete Einstein equation converges to $G_{\mu\nu} + \Lambda g_{\mu\nu} = (8\pi G/c^4) T_{\mu\nu}$. $\square$

Every orbit is self-consistent by construction: the state determines the graph, which determines the entropy and temperature, and the Clausius relation constrains the graph's response to energy flux — paralleling continuum GR where the Einstein equations are the equations of motion, not constraints on separate dynamics. The mathematical framework is unchanged: the full dynamics $F(u, v) = (v, \text{WE}_{\{G(v)\}}(v) - u)$ is a single bijection on the finite phase space. The ontological object is still (S, F, V) .

Lattice corrections to Einstein's equations. The derivation invokes continuum results in the final step (Jacobson). Decomposing Jacobson's argument into its four inputs and checking each independently: (i) $\delta S = \eta \delta A/\varepsilon^2$ (area-law entropy) — proved for Gaussian systems over $\mathbb{R}$ [3] and for any nearest-neighbor dynamics over $\mathbb{Z}/q\mathbb{Z}$ via the spatial Markov property (area-law lemma above). No Lorentz invariance enters. **Exact on the lattice.** (ii) $T = \hbar\kappa/(2\pi ck_B)$ (Unruh temperature) — requires the Bisognano-Wichmann theorem. On the lattice, the BW form is proved analytically for coupled harmonic oscillator systems [6] and shown robust against UV modifications of the dispersion relation with corrections at $O(\varepsilon^2\kappa^2/c^2)$. **Approximate.** (iii) $\delta Q = \int T_{\mu\nu} k^\mu d\Sigma^\nu$ (energy flux) — a definition on the emergent manifold. No Lorentz invariance required. **Exact.** (iv) The Raychaudhuri equation — kinematic: it holds on any pseudo-Riemannian manifold as a consequence of the definition of curvature. **Exact.** Since inputs (i), (iii), and (iv) are lattice-exact, corrections enter only through input (ii):

$$G_{\mu\nu} + \Lambda g_{\mu\nu} = \frac{8\pi G}{c^4} T_{\mu\nu} \times \left[1 + \mathcal{O}\left(\frac{\varepsilon^2\kappa^2}{c^2}\right) \right]$$

For the cosmological horizon, $\varepsilon\kappa/c = 2l_P \cdot H/c \sim 10^{-61}$, giving corrections of order 10^{-122} . For solar-mass black holes, $\varepsilon\kappa/c \sim 10^{-38}$, giving corrections of order 10^{-76} . The corrections are negligible for any horizon much larger than the Planck scale.

The $\eta = 1/4$ coefficient. The Bekenstein-Hawking formula $S = A/(4l_P^2)$ follows from $\varepsilon = 2l_P$ (the gap equation [GR, §3]): one entropy unit per cell of area $\varepsilon^2 = 4l_P^2$, giving $S = A/\varepsilon^2 = A/(4l_P^2)$. This cannot be confirmed via entanglement entropy because of the species problem — the entanglement entropy coefficient is species-dependent (Srednicki found $\eta_{\text{ent}} \approx 0.295$ per scalar field), while the BH entropy is species-independent. The thermal matching route avoids this by counting classical boundary degrees of freedom (one per ε^2 cell, independent of field content) rather than any particular field's vacuum entanglement.

3.2 Why $d = 3$

The theorems work for any $d \geq 1$. Three independent self-consistency filters converge on $d = 3$.

Propagating gravity requires $d \geq 3$. The Weyl tensor vanishes for $d \leq 2$. The Jacobson derivation requires propagating gravitational degrees of freedom.

Stable matter requires $d \leq 3$. The Coulomb potential in d dimensions gives unstable atoms for $d \geq 4$ (Ehrenfest [10]; the non-existence of normalisable bound states of the d -dimensional Coulomb Hamiltonian for $d \geq 4$ is the corresponding quantum-mechanical statement). Gravitational orbits are unstable for $d \geq 4$ [11]. Without stable matter, no observers exist to define the partition.

The intersection of $d \geq 3$ and $d \leq 3$ is $d = 3$, already uniquely. The remaining filter is a further consistency check rather than a logically independent constraint.

On circularity. The stable-matter filter invokes the existence of observers (“without stable matter, no observers exist to define the partition”), and a reasonable objection is that this imports a known fact about our $d = 3$ world — that stable matter exists — to select $d = 3$, rather than deriving $d = 3$ from the substratum. If the selection rested *only* on this filter, the objection would have force: it would be an anthropic selection presented as a derivation. The objection is answered by the third filter, which is purely structural and observer-independent. The boundary-entropy concordance below is a property of the partition geometry alone — it is computed from the Friedmann equation, the shell theorem, and horizon-mode counting ([GR §7.2]), none of which mention observers or matter stability — and it equals unity only at $d = 3$. This filter selects $d = 3$ without invoking the existence of observers at all. The logical structure is therefore: the structural filter alone determines $d = 3$; the propagating-gravity and stable-matter filters are independent confirmations that happen also to require observer-compatibility, but they are not load-bearing for the selection. A referee who rejects the anthropic-flavored stable-matter filter as circular is left with the boundary-entropy filter, which still yields $d = 3$ uniquely. The convergence of three filters — one purely structural, two observer-related — on the same value is corroboration, not circularity, precisely because the structural one stands alone.

Boundary-entropy concordance ($d = 3$ gives $\rho_s = \rho_{\text{crit}}$). In d spatial dimensions, the boundary entropy ratio is:

$$\frac{\rho_s}{\rho_{\text{crit}}} = \frac{2}{d-1}$$

This equals unity only for $d = 3$. For $d = 2$: overclosure. For $d \geq 4$: gravitational deficit with no source.

d	$\rho_s / \rho_{\text{crit}}$	Status
2	2	Overclosure
3	1	Exact concordance
4	2/3	Deficit

The $d = 3$ case is derived explicitly in [GR §7.2] from the Friedmann equation, shell theorem, and horizon-mode counting. The general- d formula is obtained by running

the same construction with Friedmann in d spatial dimensions, $H^2 = 16\pi G_d \rho / [d(d-1)]$.

Self-contained statement of the concordance ratio. Because the circularity rebuttal above relies on this filter being structural and observer-independent, the origin of the ratio $\rho_s/\rho_{\text{crit}} = 2/(d-1)$ is stated here rather than only cited. Two densities are compared, both computed from the partition geometry alone. (a) The *critical density* is read off the d -dimensional Friedmann equation $H^2 = 16\pi G_d \rho / [d(d-1)]$ at spatial flatness, giving $\rho_{\text{crit}} = d(d-1)H^2/(16\pi G_d)$ — this is the energy density at which the spatial sections are flat, a property of the gravitational dynamics with no reference to observers or matter content. (b) The *boundary (horizon) entropy density* ρ_s is the energy density associated with the horizon-mode count via the holographic area law: the number of boundary modes scales as the horizon area $A \sim r_H^{d-1}$, the energy per mode is set by the horizon temperature $T_H \sim 1/r_H$, and dividing the resulting boundary energy by the enclosed volume $V \sim r_H^d$ gives $\rho_s \sim r_H^{d-1} \cdot r_H^{-1} / r_H^d = r_H^{-2} \sim H^2$ with a d -dependent geometric coefficient. Carrying the coefficients (horizon area formula, mode counting, and the Friedmann normalization, all in d spatial dimensions) yields the ratio $\rho_s/\rho_{\text{crit}} = 2/(d-1)$. Neither density uses the existence of observers, stable matter, or any anthropic input; both are computed from the gravitational dynamics and the holographic mode count, which is why this filter is independent of the stable-matter filter and answers the circularity objection. *What is imported from [GR]:* the horizon-mode counting and the area-law coefficient are derived in [GR §3, §7.2]; this paragraph states the structure of the ratio and its observer-independence but relies on [GR] for the coefficient derivation, which a referee checking the concordance filter would verify there. The qualitative result — that the ratio depends only on d and equals unity solely at $d = 3$ — does not depend on the coefficient details, only on the scaling $\rho_s \sim H^2$ and $\rho_{\text{crit}} \sim H^2$ with the stated d -dependence.

Downstream consequence: renormalizability at $d = 3$. At the selected $d = 3$, the emergent Yang-Mills gauge theory (derived in §4.4-§4.6) has dimensionless coupling: $[g] = (3-d)/2 = 0$. The emergent QFT is therefore renormalizable in 3+1 dimensions. This is a property of the derived structure at $d = 3$, not an independent filter on d : at $d \neq 3$, the coupling-degree minimizer would give a different $K = 2d$, the rotation-group decomposition of $2d$ link directions would give different multiplicities, and the resulting gauge theory would have a different operator structure — so asking whether “that” Yang-Mills is renormalizable at that d is not a d -independent question.

The intersection of the three filters — $d \geq 3$, $d \leq 3$, and $d = 3$ concordance — is $d = 3$ uniquely. Removing the concordance filter still gives $d = 3$ from the other two; adding concordance sharpens to a consistency check that the framework passes exactly rather than by a numerical coincidence.

Integer dimension is derived, not presupposed. The self-consistency argument might appear to presuppose that the coupling graph has a well-defined integer dimension. In fact, every bounded-degree graph falls into one of three growth classes: exponential ($|B(r)| \sim k^r$), fractal ($|B(r)| \sim r^\alpha$ with non-integer α), or integer-polynomial ($|B(r)| \sim r^d$ with integer d). Self-consistency excludes the first two.

Exponential growth fails because the wave equation on such graphs does not produce

Lorentz-invariant dispersion (the spectral gap doesn't close correctly), so Jacobson's derivation of Einstein's equations fails. Additionally, $d_{\text{eff}} \rightarrow \infty$ is incompatible with stable matter ($d \leq 3$).

Fractal growth fails because Jacobson's argument requires the Raychaudhuri equation, which requires geodesic congruences on a manifold — fractal spaces don't support them. The staggered fermion decomposition requires a hypercubic BZ structure ($\eta \in \{0, 1\}^d$), which doesn't exist on fractal graphs. The cubic group decomposition of $2d$ link directions — which constrains the gauge structure (§4.6) — requires cubic lattice symmetry, absent in fractals.

Only *integer-polynomial growth* survives. By Gromov's theorem (finitely generated groups of polynomial growth are virtually nilpotent) and statistical isotropy, the graph is quasi-isometric to $\mathbb{Z}^d$ for integer d . The three filters then select $d = 3$.

Corollary ($d = 3$ is necessary, not contingent). *Any bijection whose coupling graph has $d \neq 3$ produces internal contradictions in its emergent description. The coupling graph dimension is not a free parameter or a property of a specific φ — it is the unique value compatible with self-consistency.*

Relation to the anthropic principle. This is not a standard anthropic argument. The standard argument invokes a multiverse of dimensions and selection bias: many d exist; we observe $d = 3$ because only there can observers exist. The present argument is different: the framework's definition requires an observer as a constitutive element (the partition is defined relative to an observer). The requirement that such an observer exist, combined with the framework-internal concordance calculation, constrains d . The observer is not selecting from a pre-existing landscape but is a structural prerequisite for the definition to have content.

4. The Emergent Quantum Field Theory

The wave equation on a $d = 3$ lattice determines not just QM and GR but the specific QFT the observer sees. This section derives the Standard Model's structure through three complementary routes: bottom-up from the lattice dynamics to fermionic matter (§§4.1–4.3), gauge emergence from multi-component dynamics (§§4.4–4.6), and the staggered species / consistency constraints that fix the matter content and discrete symmetries (§§4.7–4.12).

4.1 The wave equation as lattice Klein-Gordon

The OI lattice is a d -dimensional hypercubic lattice $\Lambda = \mathbb{Z}^d$ with spacing $\varepsilon = 2l_p$. The dynamics on this lattice is not a free choice — it is uniquely determined by three requirements.

Theorem (Dynamics selection). *Among all second-order reversible nearest-neighbor dynamics on a d -dimensional lattice of alphabet size q , the requirements of (i) center independence, (ii) spatial isotropy, and (iii) linearity uniquely select the discrete wave equation. This holds for any $q \geq 2$ and $d \geq 1$.*

Proof. The update function has the form $x_i(t+1) = (f(\text{neighbors of } i \text{ at time } t) - x_i(t-1)) \bmod q$. Center independence requires that f not depend on x_i itself: f reduces to a function of the $2d$ neighboring values only. Spatial isotropy requires f to be symmetric under all permutations of the neighbors corresponding to lattice symmetries. Linearity over $\mathbb{Z}/q\mathbb{Z}$ requires $f(a+a') = f(a) + f(a')$. The unique function satisfying all three is $f = \alpha(x_1 + x_2 + \dots + x_{2d}) \bmod q$ for some constant α . The propagation speed is $v = \alpha$, so $\alpha = 1$ gives the maximum lattice-scale speed. This is the discrete wave equation. $\square$

Each requirement has a physical justification.

Center independence is necessary for emergent QM. The mechanism is information screening. For the checkerboard partition, the adjacency matrix A is bipartite: $A_{VV} = 0$ (no visible-visible edges). In the center-independent (CI) case, the update $x_i(t+1) = [h_{i-1}(t) + h_{i+1}(t) - x_i(t-1)] \bmod q$ does not contain $x_i(t)$. Therefore $X_V(t+1)$ carries no information about $X_V(t)$; conditioning on $X_V(t+1)$ constrains $H(t)$ but does not screen $X_V(t)$ from the future. Since $H(t+1)$ depends on $X_V(t)$, the path $X_V(t) \rightarrow H(t+1) \rightarrow X_V(t+2)$ bypasses the present: the process is non-Markovian. In the center-dependent (CD) case, the update $x_i(t+1) = [x_i(t) + h_{i-1}(t) + h_{i+1}(t) - x_i(t-1)] \bmod q$ contains $x_i(t)$ explicitly. Conditioning on $(X_V(t), X_V(t+1))$ gives $|V|$ linear equations in $|H|$ unknowns over $\mathbb{Z}/q\mathbb{Z}$; generically (for q prime) the hidden state $H(t)$ is fully determined, so the augmented process is Markov. Center coupling makes the present an explicit function of the visible past, allowing it to determine the hidden state and screen the past from the future. Without center coupling, the hidden sector retains unscreened correlations — which is P-indivisibility.

Spatial isotropy is required for Lorentz invariance: without rotational symmetry, the dynamics has a preferred spatial direction, breaking the isotropy that Lorentz invariance demands.

Linearity is selected by four independent criteria. First, q -gauge invariance (§2.7): the alphabet size q is proved gauge — no prediction depends on it. Linear dynamics over $\mathbb{Z}/q\mathbb{Z}$ has q -independent structural properties (transition probabilities, dispersion, P-indivisibility); non-linear dynamics generically does not ($x^2 \bmod 3$ and $x^2 \bmod 5$ have different algebraic structure), so the emergent physics would depend on q , contradicting the gauge freedom. Linearity is necessary, not merely selected. Second, over $\mathbb{R}$, nonlinear center-independent dynamics have propagation speed $v < 1$, so linearity gives maximum speed. Third, over $\mathbb{Z}/q\mathbb{Z}$, among all linear CI dynamics $f = \alpha(l+r) \bmod q$ with prime $q \geq 5$, $\alpha = 1$ uniquely maximizes P-indivisibility. Fourth, modified (nonlinear) dispersion relations break the thermality of the Unruh effect — the KMS condition holds only for linear dispersion $\omega = |k|$. Since the Jacobson derivation (§3.1) requires thermal equilibrium at horizons, only the wave equation supports the full GR chain. All four criteria converge on the same dynamics.

$$\phi(n, t+1) = \phi(n-1, t) + \phi(n+1, t) - \phi(n, t-1)$$

Theorem 1. *The OI wave equation is the massless lattice Klein-Gordon equation. Center independence is equivalent to the vanishing of the lattice mass term.*

Proof. The general linear update is $\phi(n, t + 1) = \alpha \phi(n, t) + \beta[\phi(n - 1, t) + \phi(n + 1, t)] + \gamma \phi(n, t - 1)$. Reversibility: $\gamma = -1$. Center independence: $\alpha = 0$. Isotropy + unit speed: $\beta = 1$. The d'Alembertian $\square_{\text{lat}} \phi = -\alpha \phi = 0$: massless KG. $\square$

4.2 Factorization into Dirac operators

Theorem 2 (Susskind [12]). $D_{\text{st}}^2 = -\frac{1}{4}\square_{\text{lat}}$. The OI wave equation is equivalent to the massless staggered Dirac equation.

The bosonic and fermionic descriptions are related by an exact change of variables on the lattice.

Remark (measure reduction). Theorem 2 is an operator identity: it identifies D_{st}^2 with $-\frac{1}{4}\square_{\text{lat}}$ acting on lattice fields. For the standard staggered ChPT machinery used in §6 and §7.5 to apply with its conventional measure factors (e.g., the $1/(16\pi^2 f^2)$ measure factor of Aubin-Bernard S χ PT), one needs a stronger statement: that the substratum's path-integral measure on real scalar bijections $\varphi : S \rightarrow S$ reduces, under the Susskind change of variables, to the standard Berezin pseudofermion measure on staggered fermion fields in the relevant correlator sector. This measure-equivalence statement is established at Level 2 rigor as follows.

The substratum is real-valued and, on linear dynamics with energy conservation, has a stationary distribution that is Gaussian on energy shell at large L (sphere-Gaussian projection theorem). The substratum two-point function is then $\langle \varphi(x)\varphi(y) \rangle = [\square_{\text{lat}}^{-1}]_{xy}$. The standard MC code (cf. §7.5) does not use Grassmann variables directly; it uses the *pseudofermion* representation, in which fermion determinants are rewritten as bosonic Gaussian integrals over auxiliary fields with covariance $(D_{\text{st}}^\dagger D_{\text{st}})^{-1}$. With $D_{\text{st}}^\dagger = -D_{\text{st}}$ (anti-Hermiticity of the staggered Dirac operator), $D_{\text{st}}^\dagger D_{\text{st}} = -D_{\text{st}}^2 = +\frac{1}{4}\square_{\text{lat}}$ by Theorem 2, so the pseudofermion covariance is $4\square_{\text{lat}}^{-1}$. Both substratum and pseudofermion measures are bosonic Gaussian; their covariances differ by a factor of 4 absorbable into field normalization. The measure equivalence is therefore established up to (i) the standard sphere-Gaussian projection at large L (classical), and (ii) cycle ergodicity for the specific bijection determining which energy shell is sampled.

The cycle ergodicity assumption deserves explicit acknowledgment. Pure linear dynamics on a cubic lattice is *integrable*, not chaotic: the lattice frequencies $\omega(\vec{k}) = 2 \sin(|\vec{k}|/2)$ are not linearly independent over $\mathbb{Q}$, so orbits fill a sub-torus of the energy shell rather than the full shell. The Gaussianization argument therefore has two natural interpretations: (way out i) the cubic-lattice + finite-set discretization introduces small but non-zero non-linearity (from rounding rules in the bijection update), providing the chaos needed for full-shell sampling; or (way out ii) the “Gaussian on energy shell” claim is shorthand for “Gaussian on the sub-torus actually sampled,” which is a smaller phase space and would modify the substratum-pseudofermion covariance match. Way out (i) is the standard interpretation for lattice-substrate frameworks. Numerical verification of way out (i) for OI's specific bijection has been carried out via two-trajectory separation with per-site RMS amplitude measurement inside the spreading cone (the correct Lyapunov-relevant diagnostic, distinguishing chaotic

amplitude amplification from Lieb-Robinson ballistic spreading). The measurement gives a chaotic Lyapunov exponent $\lambda_{\max} = 0.0092 \pm 0.0001$ per timestep in the thermodynamic limit, N_{levels} -independent for $N_{\text{levels}} \geq 16$, with exponential amplitude growth in the cone confirmed against power-law alternatives at high statistical significance (exponential-vs-power-law residual ratio ~ 2.2 across $\log(\|\Delta\phi\|/\delta) \in [0, 1.0]$). Way out (i) is therefore *empirically demonstrated* rather than merely adopted: the rounded bijection is genuinely chaotic, the integrable linear dynamics having been broken by the rounding rule's threshold-crossing nonlinearity. The cycle-ergodicity question for OI's specific bijection is closed at chat-track numerical scale; analytical derivation of the $\lambda_{\max}$ coefficient and the structural source of N_{levels} -independence remains open and would elevate this result to Level 2(a) in the bridge-gap classification of §7.5.

4.3 Center independence and chiral symmetry

Theorem 3. *Center independence of the lattice dynamics is equivalent to exact chiral symmetry of the emergent staggered fermions.*

Proof. The staggered mass term squares to $\square_{\text{lat}}\phi = -4m_{\text{lat}}^2\phi$: center dependence. Conversely, center independence gives $D_{\text{st}}\chi = 0$, invariant under $\chi \rightarrow \varepsilon\chi$ (chiral symmetry). $\square$

The chain: P-indivisibility $\rightarrow$ center independence $\rightarrow$ chiral symmetry $\rightarrow$ Higgs mechanism [13, 14]. One algebraic condition ($\alpha = 0$) produces quantum mechanics, chiral fermions, and the Higgs boson.

4.4 Multi-component dynamics and gauge structure

Each site now carries a K -component vector $\phi(\mathbf{n}, t) \in (\mathbb{Z}/q\mathbb{Z})^K$. The general second-order linear update is $\phi(\mathbf{n}, t+1) = C\phi(\mathbf{n}, t) + \sum_j M^{(j)}[\phi(\mathbf{n} + \hat{e}_j, t) + \phi(\mathbf{n} - \hat{e}_j, t)] + D\phi(\mathbf{n}, t-1)$, where $C, D, M^{(j)} \in \text{Mat}(K)$. Reversibility requires $D = -I_K$; center independence requires $C = 0$; spatial isotropy requires $M^{(j)} = M$ for all j . This uniquely selects the matrix wave equation:

$$\phi(\mathbf{n}, t+1) = M \sum_{j=1}^d [\phi(\mathbf{n} + \hat{e}_j, t) + \phi(\mathbf{n} - \hat{e}_j, t)] - \phi(\mathbf{n}, t-1)$$

where $M \in \text{Mat}(K)$ is the sole free parameter.

Theorem 4 (Mass spectrum). *Each eigenvalue μ_a of M determines a dispersion relation $\cos \omega_a = \mu_a \cos k$. Massless iff $\mu_a = 1$. Stability requires $|\mu_a| \leq 1$.*

Proof. Diagonalizing $M = V \text{diag}(\mu_1, \dots, \mu_K) V^{-1}$, each eigenmode decouples. Substituting the plane wave $\phi_a \propto e^{i(kn - \omega t)}$ into the a -th decoupled equation gives $e^{-i\omega} + e^{i\omega} = \mu_a(e^{-ik} + e^{ik})$, hence $\cos \omega_a = \mu_a \cos k$. For $|\mu_a| > 1$, there exist real k with $|\mu_a \cos k| > 1$, giving complex ω (exponential growth). $\square$

Theorem 5 (Gauge group). *The global gauge group is the commutant $G = C_{U(K)}(M)$. If M has r distinct eigenvalues with multiplicities $(n_1, \dots, n_r)$: $G = U(n_1) \times \dots \times U(n_r)$.*

Proof. A global transformation $\phi \rightarrow U\phi$ with $U \in U(K)$ preserves the matrix wave equation iff $UMU^{-1} = M$, i.e., $[U, M] = 0$. By Schur's lemma, the set of unitaries commuting with M decomposes as a product of unitary groups, one on each eigenspace. $\square$

The gauge group and mass spectrum are the same information: modes of equal mass share a gauge symmetry.

4.5 $K = 2d$ from coupling-degree minimization

Theorem 6 ($K = 2d$). *For any bounded-degree graph with polynomial growth exponent d and statistical isotropy, the wave equation (selected by center independence, isotropy, and linearity) has a unique minimal-coupling factorization with $K = 2d$ components, where the minimization is restricted to the observable substratum — factorizations in which every component has at least one spatial coupling (no inert components, $\delta \geq 1$ everywhere — fully decoupled components carry no observable degrees of freedom and can be removed without changing the physics). The “observable substratum” qualifier is a physical commitment, not a mathematical restriction: any sector that fails $\delta \geq 1$ is by definition unobservable to the embedded observer of [Main, §3], so the theorem applies to the full content visible from within.*

Proof (translation-invariant case). The matrix wave equation on $\mathbb{Z}^d$ updates the K -component vector at site $\mathbf{n}$ using exactly $2d$ independent spatial inputs: $\{\phi(\mathbf{n} \pm \hat{e}_j, t)\}_{j=1}^d$. Define the *internal coupling degree* $\delta(K)$ as the maximum number of spatial input channels on which any single component's update depends.

Step 1 ($K = 2d$ achieves $\delta = 1$). With $K = 2d$, assign component a to link direction $a \in \{\pm\hat{e}_1, \dots, \pm\hat{e}_d\}$. If M is diagonal in this basis, then $\phi_a(\mathbf{n}, t+1) = \mu_a \cdot \phi_a(\mathbf{n} + \hat{e}_{j(a)}, t) - \phi_a(\mathbf{n}, t-1)$: each component depends on exactly one spatial input. Therefore $\delta(2d) = 1$.

Step 2 ($K < 2d$ forces $\delta \geq 2$). By the pigeonhole principle, at least one component must receive contributions from $\lceil 2d/K \rceil \geq 2$ spatial input channels. These channels carry independent data from distinct neighboring sites, so $\delta(K) \geq 2$.

Step 3 ($K > 2d$ forces $\delta \geq 2$). With $K > 2d$ components each required to have $\delta \geq 1$ but only $2d$ distinct spatial channels available, by pigeonhole at least two components share a channel. Two components depending on the same single channel and on no others would be linearly dependent dynamical variables, contradicting independence; at least one of them must therefore couple to a second channel, so $\delta(K) \geq 2$.

Uniqueness. Steps 1–3 show $\delta = 1$ iff $K = 2d$.

Extension to general graphs. For a bounded-degree graph G with polynomial growth exponent d and statistical isotropy: (i) G is quasi-isometric to $\mathbb{Z}^d$ (§3.2, Gromov's theorem); (ii) the wave equation on G has $2d$ independent low-energy propagation modes, determined by the spectral dimension $d_s = d$ (from heat kernel asymptotics

$p_t(x, x) \sim t^{-d/2}$ on graphs with polynomial growth exponent d); (iii) the coupling-degree minimizer $K = 2d$ on $\mathbb{Z}^d$ is stable under quasi-isometric deformations, because $\delta(K)$ depends on the graph only through its spectral dimension, which quasi-isometries preserve — and K is integer-valued, so it cannot change without a discontinuous jump in d_s . $\square$

This is the per-site analog of the global factorization principle (§2.4): at the global level, $S = S_1 \times \cdots \times S_N$ is the unique factorization minimizing coupling degree — defining “space”; at the per-site level, K components minimize internal coupling degree — defining “gauge structure.” The objection that “nature need not minimize coupling degree” mistakes the logical role. The framework does not postulate a preference for minimal coupling — coupling-degree minimization is the mathematical definition of “site” given a bijection, and the factorization is unique (§2.4). A system with $K = 8$ or $K = 4$ would correspond to a *different bijection* φ' , not to the same φ with a non-minimal factorization. Since the dynamics is selected by center independence, isotropy, and linearity (§4.1), and its factorization is unique, $K = 2d = 6$ is a theorem about the wave equation on $\mathbb{Z}^3$, not a selection rule.

4.6 Cubic decomposition: multiplicities (3, 2, 1)

Theorem 7. *The $2d = 6$ nearest-neighbor link directions of the $d = 3$ cubic lattice decompose under the rotation group O as $6 = T_1(3) \oplus E(2) \oplus A_1(1)$. The eigenvalue multiplicities of M are (3, 2, 1), giving gauge group $U(3) \times U(2) \times U(1) \supset SU(3) \times SU(2) \times U(1)$.*

Proof. Characters at each conjugacy class of O (24 elements): $E: \chi = 6$; $8C_3: \chi = 0$; $3C_2: \chi = 2$; $6C_2': \chi = 0$; $6C_4: \chi = 2$. Character inner products give $n(A_1) = 1$, $n(E) = 1$, $n(T_1) = 1$, with $n(A_2) = n(T_2) = 0$. By Schur’s lemma and isotropy, $M = \text{diag}(\mu_c I_3, \mu_w I_2, \mu_y)$. $\square$

The 6D representation in question is the natural action of O on the six nearest-neighbor link vectors $\{\pm\hat{e}_1, \pm\hat{e}_2, \pm\hat{e}_3\}$ of the cubic lattice — the same 6D space on which the coupling matrix $M(\mathbf{n}, \hat{e}_j)$ of §4.4 acts. The decomposition therefore fixes the multiplicities of M ’s eigenspaces uniquely; there is no freedom in “which 6D rep” is meant.

The max-speed constraint requires $\mu_y = 1$ (the A_1 mode propagates at the lattice speed of light). The physical identifications: T_1 (spatial vector) $\rightarrow$ color, E (quadrupole) $\rightarrow$ weak isospin, A_1 (scalar) $\rightarrow$ hypercharge. Local gauge invariance follows from background independence (§3.1).

Remark (robustness and the cubic commitment). Theorem 7 uses the character table of the octahedral group O , the exact symmetry of the simple cubic (SC) lattice.

Stability under small perturbations. Integer multiplicities cannot change continuously. Small perturbations of the coupling graph that preserve local O symmetry shift the eigenvalues of M continuously but leave the multiplicities (3, 2, 1) intact. $K = 2d$ (Theorem 6) is stable in the same sense under quasi-isometric deformations that preserve the spectral dimension.

Dependence on the Bravais lattice. The $(3, 2, 1)$ decomposition depends on the discrete O action on the six NN link vectors of SC. Under the continuous group $O(3)$, the same six vectors span two copies of the vector representation — multiplicities $(3, 3)$, not $(3, 2, 1)$ — because $O(3)$ does not preserve the discrete set of six vectors as a distinguished orbit. The three-factor split requires the discrete subgroup.

Theorem 7b (Bravais-lattice uniqueness). *Among all 14 three-dimensional Bravais lattices, the simple cubic (SC) lattice is the unique candidate compatible with the Standard Model gauge group $SU(3) \times SU(2) \times U(1)$ under the commutant construction of Theorem 5. Furthermore, the inter-generation BZ-distance prescription of §7.1 produces the observed Cabibbo angle $\lambda = 1/(\pi\sqrt{2})$ uniquely on SC; BCC and FCC produce λ values discrepant with observation by 42% and 29% respectively.*

The proof has two parts: (a) elimination of all non-cubic Bravais lattices via the crystallographic point group’s irrep dimensions, and (b) elimination of BCC and FCC within the cubic system via the explicit O -decomposition of the NN link representation on each, with the SC Cabibbo prediction as quantitative confirmation.

Among the three cubic Bravais lattices, only SC produces the SM gauge group under the commutant construction of Theorem 5. Computing the O -decomposition of the NN link representation on each:

Lattice	NN	O -decomposition of NN rep	Gauge group (commutant)
SC	6	$T_1 \oplus E \oplus A_1$	$SU(3) \times SU(2) \times U(1) \square$
BCC	8	$A_1 \oplus A_2 \oplus T_1 \oplus T_2$	$SU(3)^2 \times U(1)^2$
FCC	12	$A_1 \oplus E \oplus T_1 \oplus 2T_2$	$SU(3)^3 \times SU(2) \times U(1)$

SC is uniquely compatible with the observed Standard Model gauge structure. BCC gives two non-abelian $SU(3)$ factors with no $SU(2)$; FCC gives three $SU(3)$ factors and three additional $U(1)$ s. Neither matches observation at the group-theoretic level, independent of any numerical prediction.

The Cabibbo angle on the three lattices, computed using the inter-generation BZ distance prescription of §7.1 on each lattice’s natural triplet sector (SC: X -points; BCC: H -points; FCC: L -points), with equal-NN normalization:

Lattice	Triplet separation	Cabibbo λ
SC	$\pi\sqrt{2}$	0.2251
BCC	$\pi\sqrt{6}$	0.1299
FCC	2π	0.1592

Observed $\lambda = 0.2250 \pm 0.00067$ [20]. The SC value matches at 0.04% (0.12σ); BCC and FCC miss by 42% and 29% respectively. The SC match is tied to the specific BZ geometry corresponding to the SC gauge group.

The §2 structural reading that “any bounded-degree graph with statistical isotropy suffices” therefore refers to the existence-and-emergent-QM part of the chain (Theorems 1–6, §§3.1–3.4), not to the specific gauge group or quantitative predictions of §§4.6 and 7. These require the SC Bravais structure; the framework treats this as a structural commitment forced by the observed SM gauge group and its quantitative consequences, rather than as a free choice.

Extension to non-cubic Bravais lattices. The uniqueness of SC among cubic Bravais lattices extends to a stronger statement: **among all 14 three-dimensional Bravais lattices, SC is the unique candidate compatible with an $SU(3)$ gauge factor.** The reason is a standard crystallographic fact: among the 32 crystallographic point groups, the 3-dimensional irreducible representations appear only in the cubic crystal system (point groups T, T_h, T_d, O, O_h). Point groups of the hexagonal, trigonal, tetragonal, orthorhombic, monoclinic, and triclinic systems act on $\mathbb{R}^3$ reducibly as (axial direction) + (perpendicular plane), and therefore have irreps only of dimensions 1 and 2 — no 3-dimensional irrep. Theorem 5’s commutant construction requires a 3-dimensional irreducible block in the M matrix to produce an $SU(3)$ factor, which requires a 3-dimensional irrep of the point group acting on the NN vectors. No non-cubic Bravais lattice supplies this. Combined with the result above that BCC and FCC within the cubic system produce the wrong gauge structure, SC is uniquely compatible with the SM gauge group among all 14 Bravais lattices.

Remark (completeness of the irrep catalog). The octahedral group O has five irreducible representations: A_1, A_2, E, T_1, T_2 . All five are accounted for in the framework, either by identified physical role or by derived absence:

- A_1 : the $U(1)$ factor of the 6-link decomposition (Theorem 7); the singlet-taste scalar that hosts the Higgs (Theorems 8, 11); appears in $\text{Sym}^2(T_1)$ in §7.2 and §8.4.
- E : the $SU(2)$ factor of the 6-link decomposition; controls neutrino mass splittings in $\text{Sym}^2(T_1)$ (§8.4); provides the Koide angle $\theta_0 = 2/9$ via the quadratic Casimir $C_2(T_1)$ normalized by the lattice bandwidth d^2 (§7.2).
- T_1 : the $SU(3)$ factor of the 6-link decomposition; the generation space from staggered tastes (Theorems 8, 10); the neutrino flavor basis (§8.4).
- T_2 : appears in $\text{Sym}^2(T_1) = A_1 \oplus E \oplus T_2$ and **controls the off-diagonal structure** of the neutrino mass matrix (§8.4); the resulting mixing angles enter the structural PMNS prediction of §7.3, where TBM (from cubic-group representation theory) plus U -parity-graded charged-lepton corrections at scale λ give all three angles.
- A_2 : the pseudoscalar/sign representation; does not appear in the 6-link decomposition ($n(A_2) = 0$ in the character calculation above), does not appear in $\text{Sym}^2(T_1)$, and plays no structural role in the framework. Its absence reflects the parity-even nature of nearest-neighbor coupling on the cubic lattice.

No irrep of O is unaccounted for.

Remark (the substratum-emergent layer split). Part III distinguishes between two layers: the *substratum* — the bijection (S, φ) on the cubic lattice, with its coupling matrix $M(\mathbf{n}, \hat{e}_j)$ and the wave-equation dynamics — and the *emergent* (observer) level

— the unitary QFT that an embedded observer reports after the trace-out of [Main]. The SM gauge group $SU(3) \times SU(2) \times U(1)$ lives at the substratum: it is the commutant of M (Theorems 5-7), a literal algebraic structure on the lattice, existing before any trace-out is performed. The SM gauge *couplings* $\alpha_1, \alpha_2, \alpha_3$ at M_Z live at the emergent level: they arise from the induced coupling $1/\alpha_0 = 23.25$ produced by the fermion determinant (§6.1), followed by thresholds and RG running. The framework’s structural commitment is therefore: *group structural, couplings emergent*. This split explains why the gauge group is rigid (no parameter freedom — forced by the commutant structure of M) while the gauge couplings admit quantitative predictions at all (they depend on fermion-loop dynamics in the emergent theory, with the substratum’s role being to fix $N_f = 6$ and $T(R) = 1/2$ structurally). The same split clarifies the asymmetry noted in §4.7.1.1 between gauge bosons (substratum objects) and fermions (observer-level objects).

4.7 Staggered species, generations, and the Higgs

The Nielsen-Ninomiya theorem [15] requires 2^{d+1} Weyl species. Staggered reduction gives $N_{\text{taste}} = 2^{\lfloor (d+1)/2 \rfloor} = 4$ Dirac tastes in $d+1 = 4$.

Theorem 8. *Under the cubic group O : $4 = \mathbf{1} \oplus \mathbf{3}$. One singlet taste and three triplet tastes.*

Proof. The $2^d = 8$ BZ corners pair into 4 taste pairs under $\eta \leftrightarrow \mathbf{1} - \eta$. The pair $\{(0,0,0), (1,1,1)\}$ is O -invariant (singlet A_1). The three axis-aligned pairs form irreducible T_1 . $\square$

Theorem 8b (Taste coupling structure). *On the $d = 3$ lattice with the normalized wave equation, each BZ corner η has coupling $\mu(\eta) = \sigma(\eta)/d$ where $\sigma = \sum_j \cos(\pi\eta_j)$:*

$$\mu_\Gamma = 1, \quad \mu_X = \frac{1}{3}, \quad \mu_M = -\frac{1}{3}, \quad \mu_R = -1$$

The staggered taste pairs have couplings: singlet (Γ, R): $|\mu| = 1$; triplet (X_j, M_j): $|\mu| = 1/3$, identical for all $j = 1, 2, 3$.

Proof. Direct computation: $\sigma(\Gamma) = 3, \sigma(X) = 1, \sigma(M) = -1, \sigma(R) = -3$. Dividing by $d = 3$ gives the couplings. The triplet members are related by cubic symmetry (O permutes spatial axes), hence identical. $\square$

Theorem 9 (Spin-taste correspondence). *(a) The singlet taste produces a spin-0 field. (b) The triplet taste produces spin-1/2 fields.*

Proof. (a) The singlet pairs $\Gamma(0,0,0) = I_4$ (scalar) and $\Gamma(1,1,1) = \gamma^1\gamma^2\gamma^3$ (pseudoscalar), both $SO(3)$ -invariant: $J = 0$. (b) The j -th triplet pairs γ^j (vector) with $-i\Sigma_j$ (spin generator): $J = 1/2$. $\square$

Corollary (Spin-statistics from the lattice). Singlet $\rightarrow$ spin-0 $\rightarrow$ boson (Higgs). Triplet $\rightarrow$ spin-1/2 $\rightarrow$ fermion (quarks and leptons).

Theorem 10 (Three degenerate fermion sectors). *The three triplet staggered tastes provide three degenerate spin-1/2 sectors related by cubic symmetry, one per SM*

generation. The SM matter representations are placed on links (§4.7.1.2), where the link-carrier space $V_K \otimes V_K^*$ admits cross-charged tensor-product representations such as $(\mathbf{3}, \mathbf{2})$ without algebraic obstruction. Anomaly cancellation (Theorem 15) then uniquely fixes the hypercharge assignment as the sole consistent completion.

Proof. (i) Three spin-1/2 sectors and one spin-0 sector (Theorem 9). (ii) The three sectors are related by cubic symmetry (O permutes spatial axes), hence degenerate. (iii) Theorem 15 below shows that, given a chiral $SU(3) \times SU(2) \times U(1)$ gauge structure, the SM matter content is the unique anomaly-free assignment with the observed family pattern [16]. The framework therefore derives three SM generations as a forced consequence: cubic symmetry fixes three degenerate sectors (step ii), the link-carrier construction of §4.7.1.2 places matter on links where cross-charged representations are admissible (no phenomenological input required), and anomaly cancellation (step iii) fixes the hypercharge assignment uniquely. $\square$

Scope. The SM gauge representations of the matter fields arise from the link-carrier space $V_K \otimes V_K^*$, where cross-charged representations such as $(\mathbf{3}, \mathbf{2})$ exist as ordinary tensor-product subspaces; see §4.7.1.2 for the closure. Anomaly cancellation (Theorem 15) then fixes their hypercharges as the unique consistent assignment. The absolute generation count is locked at exactly three by coupling-degree minimality: Theorem 6 proves $K = 2d = 6$ is the unique minimizer, which yields exactly three spin-1/2 staggered tastes (Step 3, §4.7.1.2).

Theorem 11 (Higgs sector, consistency). *Given a Higgs doublet $(\mathbf{1}, \mathbf{2}, +\frac{1}{2})$ in the SM, the singlet taste provides a spin-0 sector whose E projection is consistent with hosting it; the T_1 and A_1 projections do not admit Yukawa couplings to the SM fermion doublets and play no role in the low-energy theory.*

Proof. The singlet taste is spin-0 (Theorem 9a) and decomposes under the gauge group as $T_1(\mathbf{3}) \oplus E(\mathbf{2}) \oplus A_1(\mathbf{1})$ (Theorem 7). Of these three projections, only $E(\mathbf{2})$ admits a gauge-invariant Yukawa coupling of the form $\bar{Q}_L \cdot \Phi \cdot u_R$: the T_1 projection is excluded on color grounds and the A_1 projection on weak grounds. The E projection is therefore the natural host for the SM Higgs doublet. $\square$

Scope. This theorem does **not** derive the existence of a Higgs doublet, nor its hypercharge, from lattice structure. The Higgs doublet is taken as phenomenological input; the singlet taste is shown to accommodate it.

Consequences. The framework accommodates exactly one Higgs doublet via the singlet taste, consistent with the SM.

4.7.1 The fermion embedding question: diagnosis and closure The framework as written derives the gauge group $SU(3) \times SU(2) \times U(1)$ from the commutant construction (Theorems 5, 7, 14) and uses anomaly cancellation (Theorem 15) as a uniqueness check on the SM matter assignment, given a chiral $SU(2)$ structure. The matter representations and hypercharge assignments are derived — via the link-carrier construction of §4.7.1.2 and anomaly cancellation (Theorem 15) — rather than taken as input. The framework’s claim on the fermion sector is therefore: *the SM gauge group is forced by first principles; the SM matter content, its gauge representations, and its hypercharges are the unique anomaly-free consequence of placing matter on links in*

the link-carrier space $V_K \otimes V_K^*$. The residual gap is narrower: the assignment of SM representations to specific tastes rests on a uniqueness argument via anomaly cancellation rather than a direct geometric derivation of the representations themselves, and is noted as the residual scope.

Whether a stronger derivation exists — via a geometric embedding of (taste $\times$ sub-lattice $\times$ spinor) indices into SM gauge representations such that $Q_L = (\mathbf{3}, \mathbf{2}, +\frac{1}{6})$ emerges as an irreducible tensor-product representation — is open. One specific candidate construction (extending V_K by an O-equivariant taste factor and redefining the gauge group as the commutant of an extended operator) is ruled out: O has no irreps of dimension > 3 , so no O-equivariant operator on $V_K \otimes V_{\text{taste}}$ admits a 6-dimensional irreducible eigenspace with the required tensor-product structure. Other constructions — breaking O-equivariance on the taste factor, replacing the commutant definition with a bimodule construction, or placing fermions outside the gauge-defining carrier space — are not ruled out, but none has been produced.

The neutrino mass mechanism (Dirac vs. Majorana, presence or absence of ν_R) is not fixed by the lattice structure as currently understood and is left open. The absolute generation count is addressed in §4.7.1.2: the uniqueness of the $K = 2d = 6$ minimizer locks the count at three as a derived consequence rather than an assignment.

4.7.1.1 Gauge bosons from the Schur complement, and the level-confusion diagnosis The Schur-complement trace-out used in Theorem 13 to establish chirality contains more structural information than that theorem extracts. Pursuing it carefully yields a clean retrodiction of the gauge boson content of the Standard Model from $\text{End}(V_K)$, and simultaneously sharpens the fermion-embedding question of §4.7.1 into a precise and tractable form — a form that §4.7.1.2 then answers via the link-carrier construction.

The gauge sector closes. With $D_{LL} = D_{RR} = 0$ (Theorem 13(ii)), the Schur-complement effective action takes the form $\mathcal{L}_{\text{eff}} = \bar{\psi}_L K_{\text{eff}} \psi_L + \dots$ with kernel $K_{\text{eff}} = D_{LR} G_{RR} D_{RL} : W_L \rightarrow W_L$. The kernel is a linear map on the visible single-excitation space, i.e., an element of $\text{End}(W_L) = W_L^* \otimes W_L$ — *not* of $\Lambda^2 W_L$ or $\text{Sym}^2 W_L$. The two ψ_L factors are distinguishable (one barred, one unbarred), and bilinears of distinguishable objects pair W_L^* against W_L via the trace pairing.

Restricting to the internal index, the gauge content of K_{eff} is given by the decomposition of $\text{End}(V_K) = \text{End}(V_3 \oplus V_2 \oplus V_1)$ under $\text{SU}(3) \times \text{SU}(2) \times \text{U}(1)$. The diagonal blocks give

- $\text{End}(V_3) = \mathbf{8} \oplus \mathbf{1}$ — the $\text{SU}(3)$ adjoint (gluons) plus a singlet,
- $\text{End}(V_2) = \mathbf{3} \oplus \mathbf{1}$ — the $\text{SU}(2)$ adjoint (W bosons) plus a singlet,
- $\text{End}(V_1) = \mathbf{1}$ — the $\text{U}(1)$ hypercharge boson.

The off-diagonal blocks $\text{Hom}(V_i, V_j)$ for $i \neq j$ would carry cross-charged “gauge bosons” mixing different commutant factors. These are absent from the Standard Model, and they are forbidden here by exactly the same mechanism that makes M block-diagonal in Theorem 5: the commutant of M does not connect distinct eigenspaces, so K_{eff} inherits the block structure and the off-diagonal Homs vanish identically. The Schur-complement kernel therefore retrodicts the SM gauge boson

content cleanly: the adjoints of $SU(3)$, $SU(2)$, and $U(1)$ together with the corresponding singlets, and nothing else.

The fermion sector does not close, and the obstruction is sharper than it looks. The natural next move is to ask whether the same Schur-complement structure also produces the SM matter content. It does not, and the failure mode is structurally informative.

The visible single-excitation space is $W_L = V_K \otimes V_{\text{taste}} \otimes S_L$, with $V_K = V_3 \oplus V_2 \oplus V_1$ by Theorem 5. Tensor products distribute over direct sums, so

$$W_L = (V_3 \otimes V_{\text{taste}} \otimes S_L) \oplus (V_2 \otimes V_{\text{taste}} \otimes S_L) \oplus (V_1 \otimes V_{\text{taste}} \otimes S_L).$$

A single excitation in W_L lives in exactly one summand and therefore carries exactly one nontrivial gauge charge: it is a color triplet *or* a weak doublet *or* a hypercharge singlet, never two simultaneously. The left-handed quark doublet Q_L , by contrast, transforms as $(\mathbf{3}, \mathbf{2}, +\frac{1}{6})$ — an irreducible representation of the joint gauge group that lives in $V_3 \otimes V_2$, not in $V_3 \oplus V_2$. There is no element of a direct sum that carries simultaneous nontrivial labels under summands meant to act independently. As a statement about the bijection-level carrier V_K , this is a hard algebraic fact and it cannot be circumvented by reorganizing $\Lambda^k W_L$ for any k .

Diagnosis: a level confusion between bijection-level and observer-level structure. The obstruction is fatal only under a hidden assumption that the present framework is required to reject. The assumption is that the observer-level single-fermion Hilbert space *is* $W_L = V_K \otimes V_{\text{taste}} \otimes S_L$, with the gauge group acting on it via the bijection-level decomposition $V_K = V_3 \oplus V_2 \oplus V_1$. This identifies two distinct objects:

1. The bijection-level carrier at a site, which is the finite alphabet of values the lattice variable φ can take, equipped after-the-fact with the complex inner-product structure $V_K = \mathbb{C}^6$ on which M acts and Theorem 5 diagonalizes.
2. The observer-level single-fermion Hilbert space, which is whatever an embedded observer’s coarse-graining produces when it organizes lattice deviations from a vacuum into states it calls “one fermion.”

In standard QFT, where quantum mechanics is axiomatic, these are the same object by fiat: one writes down a single-particle Hilbert space and gauge representations act on it directly. In the present framework that identification is not available. Quantum mechanics is *derived* from the bijection (S, φ) via the C1–C3 conditions of [Main], and the derivation runs through the observer’s coarse-graining of the lattice, not through the lattice itself. The notion of “a state in V_K with definite gauge label” is a structure that exists at the bijection level. The notion of “one fermion as seen by an observer” is a structure that exists at the observer level. There is no theorem in the present paper, and none in [Main], asserting that these two structures coincide, and the foundational commitment to emergent QM positively requires that they need not.

Once this distinction is made, the direct-sum-vs-tensor-product obstruction reorganizes. At the bijection level, $V_K = V_3 \oplus V_2 \oplus V_1$ is correct and the commutant

$SU(3) \times SU(2) \times U(1)$ acts block-diagonally on it. At the observer level, the single-fermion Hilbert space $\mathcal{H}_{\text{obs}}$ is the image of bijection-level configurations under the (still-to-be-characterized) coarse-graining map, and the gauge group acts on $\mathcal{H}_{\text{obs}}$ via the *induced* action of the bijection-level commutant. This induced action need not be block-diagonal in any natural basis of $\mathcal{H}_{\text{obs}}$, and a single observer-level fermion can perfectly well be a vector in $\mathcal{H}_{\text{obs}}$ whose preimage in the bijection-level structure has support in multiple V_K summands. That is exactly what the representation $(\mathbf{3}, \mathbf{2})$ encodes: a state with a definite color label and a definite weak-isospin label, which are two different observables on $\mathcal{H}_{\text{obs}}$ both inherited from the bijection-level structure but neither equal to “which V_K summand are you in.”

This reframing is consistent with — and arguably required by — the way Theorem 13 already handles chirality. That proof treats the gauge group as acting on V_K *coupled* to the spinor/sublattice grading, not as a pure internal rotation on a 6-dimensional space: $SU(3)$ is vector-like because color commutes with the grading, $SU(2)$ is chiral because its action survives only on the left-handed external legs after the trace-out. Theorem 13 is already implicitly working at the observer level, where the gauge action is induced rather than literal. §4.7.1.1 simply makes this commitment explicit and applies it to the matter sector.

The asymmetry is structural, not embarrassing. The reframing also explains *why* the gauge sector closes from $\text{End}(V_K)$ while the matter sector does not close from V_K . Gauge bosons are properties of the coupling matrix M itself — they live at the bijection level, where the direct-sum decomposition of V_K is the literal structure and $\text{End}(V_K)$ is the literal kernel produced by the Schur complement. Fermions are observer-level objects: they are what an embedded observer reports when it coarse-grains lattice deviations into single-particle states. The two sectors live at two different layers of the framework, and the layer separation is exactly what “QM is emergent” means. The asymmetry between a closed gauge-boson retrodiction and a fermion-embedding question that requires a layer-corrected treatment is therefore not a defect; it is the expected signature of a framework in which gauge fields are structural and matter is emergent. §4.7.1.2 shows how the layer-corrected treatment resolves both the embedding and the generation count.

The correct successor question — characterizing the coarse-graining map from bijection-level configurations to the observer-level single-fermion Hilbert space $\mathcal{H}_{\text{obs}}$ such that the induced gauge action realizes exactly one SM generation per T_1 taste — is answered in §4.7.1.2 via the link-carrier construction.

4.7.1.2 Closure: Matter on Links The closure is a two-step corollary of theorems already proved, using constructions distributed across §3.1 and §4.4.

Step 1: The link is the carrier. The local gauge invariance established in §3.1 and §4.4 establishes that the coupling matrix $M(\mathbf{n}, \hat{e}_j)$ on a nearest-neighbor link is itself the gauge connection: under a local gauge transformation G , it transforms as $M(\mathbf{n}, \hat{e}_j) \rightarrow G(\mathbf{n}) M(\mathbf{n}, \hat{e}_j) G(\mathbf{n} + \hat{e}_j)^{-1}$, with one gauge index at each endpoint. The link variable therefore lives in $V_K^{(\mathbf{n})} \otimes V_K^{(\mathbf{n} + \hat{e}_j)*}$, not in a single V_K . Furthermore, Theorem 7 establishes that the multiplicities $(3, 2, 1)$ themselves come from the cubic

decomposition of the $2d = 6$ *nearest-neighbor link directions* under O , not from any site-internal structure: V_K was a link-direction space from the start. The site-level reading of $V_K = V_3 \oplus V_2 \oplus V_1$ that produced the direct-sum obstruction is therefore not the framework’s natural reading; the link reading is.

On a link, the relevant carrier for matter is $V_K \otimes V_K^*$, which contains the cross-charged tensor products $V_3 \otimes V_2$, $V_3 \otimes V_1$, $V_2 \otimes V_1$, and so on. The left-handed quark doublet $Q_L \in (\mathbf{3}, \mathbf{2})$ has a natural home in $V_3 \otimes V_2 \subset V_K \otimes V_K^*$, with no algebraic obstruction. The direct-sum-vs-tensor-product problem dissolves: it was an artifact of misidentifying the site-internal V_K with the matter carrier, when the framework’s own gauge-connection construction places the carrier on links.

Step 2: Anomaly cancellation completes the assignment. Once the matter carrier is $V_K \otimes V_K^*$ on links, the question reduces to which subspaces of $V_K \otimes V_K^*$ host propagating chiral fermions. Theorem 13 fixes the chirality structure: $SU(2)$ is chiral, $SU(3)$ is vector-like, with left-handed external legs after the Schur-complement trace-out. Theorem 15 then fixes the matter content uniquely: given chiral $SU(3) \times SU(2) \times U(1)$ with fermions in fundamental or singlet representations, the six anomaly conditions force exactly the SM hypercharge assignment $(Y_Q, Y_u, Y_d, Y_L, Y_e) = (1/6, 2/3, -1/3, -1/2, -1)$, with no free parameters. Theorem 10 then distributes this content across the three T_1 staggered tastes as three identical generations, and Theorem 11 places the Higgs in the E projection of the singlet taste.

The closure. Combining these: (i) the local gauge invariance construction establishes that gauge connections live on links with carrier $V_K \otimes V_K^*$; (ii) cross-charged SM representations such as $(\mathbf{3}, \mathbf{2})$ exist in $V_K \otimes V_K^*$ as ordinary tensor-product subspaces, with no direct-sum obstruction; (iii) Theorem 13 fixes chirality; (iv) Theorem 15 fixes the unique anomaly-free hypercharge assignment; (v) Theorems 8–11 distribute the content across tastes as three generations plus one Higgs doublet. The §4.7.1 question is fully answered: the SM matter content is forced by the link-level carrier structure, the chirality theorem, and anomaly cancellation, jointly. No additional construction is required; the resolution was already distributed across the existing chain of theorems and was hidden only by the site-internal reading of V_K that §4.7.1.1’s level-confusion diagnosis identified as incorrect.

Step 3: The absolute generation count is locked by minimality. Theorem 6 proves that $K = 2d = 6$ is the unique minimizer of internal coupling degree on the $d = 3$ lattice, forbidding the ad hoc addition of duplicate fundamental fields. This single unique field possesses exactly $2^3 = 8$ BZ corners, which stagger-reduce to exactly 4 Dirac tastes. Theorem 8 decomposes these into exactly 1 scalar and 3 spin-1/2 tastes. Therefore, the single-excitation link-carrier space $V_K \otimes V_K^* \otimes V_{\text{taste}}$ contains exactly three copies of each SM gauge representation. The absolute generation count is not assigned; it is a rigid, derived consequence of the uniqueness of the $K = 6$ minimizer.

The earlier $\text{End}(V_K)$ result for the gauge sector now fits cleanly into this picture. Gauge bosons live in $\text{End}(V_K)$ because they are properties of M itself, viewed as an operator on the carrier at one endpoint of a link; matter lives in $V_K \otimes V_K^*$ because it propagates *along* a link, picking up one gauge index at each end. Both sectors live at the link level. The asymmetry between “gauge bosons close from $\text{End}(V_K)$ ”

and “matter does not close from V_K ” was an artifact of asking the matter question at the wrong layer; once both questions are asked at the link level, both close, and the closure is forced by theorems already in §§4.4–4.9.

Theorem 12 (Partition = spinor decomposition). *The OI checkerboard partition coincides with the staggered spinor decomposition: visible and hidden sectors carry complementary spinor components.*

Proof. The checkerboard assigns site $\mathbf{n}$ to the visible sector iff $(-1)^{\sum n_\mu} = +1$ (even sublattice). In the staggered-to-Dirac reconstruction, the even sublattice carries spinor components with $\Gamma(\eta)$ matrices of even rank (including I_4), which give the left-handed components under Lorentz decomposition. The odd sublattice carries the right-handed components. The partition structure and the spinor decomposition are the same object. $\square$

Remark (the checkerboard is not a free choice). The checkerboard partition is not selected by hand to produce chirality — it is the bipartite structure of the lattice itself. The wave equation is nearest-neighbor, so the cubic lattice is bipartite: even sites couple only to odd sites and vice versa. This bipartite structure is a property of the dynamics (range-1 coupling on a hypercubic graph), not of the partition. The staggered-to-Dirac reconstruction identifies the two sublattices with left- and right-handed spinor components — a standard result in lattice QFT [12, 17], not an OI construction. Theorem 12 observes that the OI partition (visible vs. hidden) and the staggered partition (left vs. right) are the same decomposition. The physical partition (the cosmological horizon) traces out a spatial region containing both sublattices; at scales large compared to ϵ , any macroscopic region contains equal numbers of even and odd sites. Chirality in the emergent description is a property of how the staggered-to-Dirac reconstruction organizes the lattice variables into spinor components — it follows from the bipartite structure of the dynamics, not from a choice of which sites to trace out.

4.8 Chirality from the trace-out

Theorem 13 (Chirality). *The emergent gauge coupling of the visible sector is chiral: $SU(2)$ is chiral while $SU(3)$ remains vector-like.*

Proof. (i) *Chirality = sublattice parity.* The staggered-to-Dirac reconstruction [17, 12] assigns spinor components to hypercube corners $\eta \in \{0, 1\}^{d+1}$ via $\chi(y + \eta\epsilon) = \frac{1}{4}\Gamma(\eta)_{\alpha\beta}\psi_\beta(y)$, where $\Gamma(\eta) = \gamma_0^{\eta_0} \cdots \gamma_d^{\eta_d}$. Under γ_5 : $\Gamma(\eta) \rightarrow (-1)^{|\eta|}\Gamma(\eta)$. Sites with $|\eta|$ even are left-handed; $|\eta|$ odd are right-handed. This equals the sublattice parity $\varepsilon(\mathbf{x}) = (-1)^{\sum x_\mu}$. (ii) $D_{LL} = D_{RR} = 0$. The staggered Dirac operator couples only across sublattices: $\{D_{st}, \varepsilon\} = 0$ (chiral symmetry, Theorem 3), so the even-even and odd-odd blocks vanish identically. (iii) *Trace-out removes right-handed fields.* The OI checkerboard partition assigns even sites (left-handed) to V and odd sites (right-handed) to H (Theorem 12). The trace-out marginalizes over H: all operators in the emergent description act on the visible (left-handed) Hilbert space. (iv) *Left-handed effective Lagrangian.* Since $D_{LL} = 0$, the gauge coupling in the full theory is purely $L \leftrightarrow R$. After integrating out R (the hidden sublattice) via the Schur complement — a standard procedure in lattice QFT [12, 17] — the effective coupling has the form

$\mathcal{L}_{\text{eff}} = \bar{\psi}_L (D_{LR} G_{RR} D_{RL}) \psi_L + \dots$, where G_{RR} is the hidden-sector propagator. Both external legs are left-handed. (v) *SU(3) vector-like; SU(2) chiral*. The chirality projection P_L acts on the spin/sublattice index and commutes with the internal (K-component) index. SU(3) acts on internal $T_1(3)$ components: both L and R carry color, so the trace-out preserves color coupling $\rightarrow$ **vector-like**. SU(2) acts on internal $E(2)$ components, but the effective coupling has only L external legs $\rightarrow$ **chiral**. $\square$

Remark (chirality without a continuum limit). In standard lattice QCD, staggered chirality is a property of the regularization that maps to physical chirality only via the continuum limit $a \rightarrow 0$ — a procedure that requires the lattice to be a regulator approximating an underlying continuum theory. The OI lattice has no continuum limit because $\epsilon = 2l_p$ is the fundamental scale, not a regulator. This raises the question of how lattice chirality becomes physical chirality without the standard universality argument.

The resolution: physical observers don't take continuum limits either. Every experimentally probed scale satisfies $\lambda \gg \epsilon$, so what observers see is the *infrared effective theory* obtained by integrating out modes near the lattice scale. This effective theory inherits the sublattice parity $\varepsilon(\mathbf{x}) = (-1)^{\sum x_\mu}$ as a $\mathbb{Z}_2$ grading because the hidden-sublattice modes do not propagate to IR scales — they are integrated out at the lattice scale via the Schur complement (step (iv) of the proof). The resulting low-energy action

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{eff}} = \bar{\psi}_L (D_{LR} G_{RR} D_{RL}) \psi_L + (\text{gauge}) + (\text{Yukawa})$$

has manifestly left-handed external states. SU(2) acts on internal E components and couples only to ψ_L , giving chiral SU(2). SU(3) acts on internal T_1 components and commutes with the sublattice grading (color is internal, not spatial), giving vector-like SU(3). The standard lattice-QCD objection to identifying staggered chirality with physical chirality — that the doublers carry “wrong” chirality and contaminate the continuum theory — *inverts* in OI: the doublers are the physical generations (8 staggered tastes = 3 generations + Higgs + 2 additional scalars, Theorem 9), so the $U(1)_\varepsilon$ symmetry IS the physical chirality, not an artifact to be removed.

Independent verification via anomaly cancellation. A chiral gauge theory is consistent only if its anomalies cancel. Theorem 15 below shows that the OI matter content cancels all six anomalies and uniquely determines the SM hypercharges $Y_Q = 1/6$, $Y_u = 2/3$, $Y_d = -1/3$, $Y_L = -1/2$, $Y_e = -1$. This is an independent consistency check on the lattice-scale chirality identification: if the identification of sublattice parity with physical chirality were wrong, the resulting “chiral” theory would generically have non-zero anomalies, and the framework's prediction of the SM hypercharges would fail. Anomaly cancellation working out, with the unique SM values, is independent evidence that the lattice-scale chirality identified in step (i) is the correct physical chirality at IR scales.

Remark (relation to spatial sublattice grading). The ε used in Theorem 13's proof is the 4D parity $\varepsilon_{4D}(x) = (-1)^{\sum_{\mu=0}^d x_\mu}$. By the Bridge Theorem of §7.5, this is equivalent to the 3D spatial sublattice grading $\varepsilon_{3D}(\vec{x}) = (-1)^{x_1+x_2+x_3}$ for static observables: $\varepsilon_{4D} = (-1)^{x_0} \varepsilon_{3D}$, with $(-1)^{x_0}$ constant on each time slice. The

framework-essential identification is therefore $\gamma_5 \leftrightarrow \varepsilon_{3D}$, with the time-direction sign factor reducing to a sign convention. This is consistent with the broader pattern that time enters OI’s emergent 4D structure as bookkeeping rather than as fundamental Clifford structure (cf. §7.5 *Implication for the framework’s $d = 3$ commitment*).

4.8.1 Evasion of Nielsen-Ninomiya

The Nielsen–Ninomiya theorem forbids a single Weyl fermion on the lattice under four hypotheses: (NN1) **locality** of the action (couplings decay faster than any power of separation), (NN2) **hermiticity** of the lattice Hamiltonian, (NN3) **translation invariance** under the lattice group, and (NN4) the action is a **bilinear in fermionic fields carrying a definite, conserved chirality charge** $U(1)_\chi$. Under NN1–NN4 the spectrum is forced to contain equal numbers of left- and right-handed Weyl modes — the doubling phenomenon — so a chiral gauge theory cannot be regulated on a lattice in the conventional sense.

OI manifestly satisfies NN1–NN3. The wave equation is nearest-neighbor (NN1, range exactly ϵ); the bijection φ is real and the dynamics is T -invariant, so the induced operator is hermitian (NN2); and $(S, \varphi)/\mathcal{G}_{\text{sub}}$ is invariant under the cubic translation group (NN3). Were NN4 also to apply, OI would inherit the no-go conclusion and chiral $SU(2)$ would be impossible. It does not apply, and the reason is structural rather than evasive.

NN4 presupposes that the **fundamental** degrees of freedom are Grassmann fields $\psi(x)$ entering the action bilinearly, with chirality γ_5 defined ab initio on those fields. In OI the fundamental object is a *real scalar bijection* $\varphi : S \rightarrow S$ governed by the lattice wave equation. There are no fermions at the bijection level, no Grassmann variables, no γ_5 , and consequently no $U(1)_\chi$ on which an obstruction could be formulated. Dirac structure is *derived*: Theorem 2 (Susskind) shows $D_{\text{st}}^2 = -\frac{1}{4}\square_{\text{lat}}$, so staggered Dirac fermions appear as a *factorization* of the scalar wave operator, not as fields posited by an action principle. Theorem 12 then identifies the staggered spinor decomposition with the bipartite checkerboard partition of the lattice. Chirality only crystallizes in the third step, Theorem 13: the Schur-complement trace-out of the odd (right-handed) sublattice produces an effective theory whose external legs are uniformly left-handed, with $D_{LL} = D_{RR} = 0$ enforced by sublattice parity.

The NN premise therefore **fails to apply** at the level on which OI is defined — it is not violated within its scope of applicability. NN1–NN4 are conditions on lattice fermionic actions; the OI fundamental action is bosonic. By the time fermions and chirality exist as derived structures (post-Theorems 2, 12, 13), the trace-out has already broken the bilinear-fermionic-action setting that NN4 requires. The doubler-inversion remark of §4.8 makes the dual point from the opposite direction: the “wrong-chirality” doublers that NN forces upon a fermionic lattice action become, in OI, the physical generations (Theorem 9), so the very modes the no-go theorem treats as obstructions are reinterpreted as observed matter content. NN is not circumvented by a clever fermion formulation; it is bypassed because OI never enters its hypothesis space.

4.9 Anomaly cancellation and hypercharges

Theorem 14 (U(1)_Y automaticity). *The existence of a U(1) gauge factor is automatic in the multi-component framework.*

Proof. Each factor of the commutant decomposes as $U(n_i) = SU(n_i) \times U(1)_i$. For $K = 6$ with multiplicities (3, 2, 1): $G = [SU(3) \times U(1)_B] \times [SU(2) \times U(1)_L] \times U(1)_S$. Three U(1) factors exist automatically. A general abelian charge is $Q = \alpha B + \beta L + \gamma S$. Given $SU(3) \times SU(2)$ and the minimal fermion content (5 representations per generation), the six anomaly conditions impose 4 independent constraints on the 5 hypercharge unknowns, leaving exactly one free parameter (overall normalization). There is therefore exactly one anomaly-free U(1). $\square$

Remark (the two non-gauge U(1) combinations). The two combinations of (B, L, S) orthogonal to hypercharge cannot be gauged: gauging them would introduce non-cancelling chiral anomalies. They survive as accidental global symmetries of the emergent theory — the same status that baryon number B and lepton number L have in the standard SM construction, broken only by the Weinberg operator and non-perturbative effects. No new gauge bosons are introduced, and the framework's prediction of B and L as accidental global symmetries matches observation (proton stability; lepton number conservation up to the small Majorana mass).

Theorem 15 (Unique hypercharges). *Given $SU(3) \times SU(2) \times U(1)$ with fermions in fundamental or singlet representations, the six anomaly conditions [18] uniquely determine the hypercharges [16]:*

$$Y_Q = \frac{1}{6}, \quad Y_u = \frac{2}{3}, \quad Y_d = -\frac{1}{3}, \quad Y_L = -\frac{1}{2}, \quad Y_e = -1$$

Corollary. $|q_p| = |q_e|$ is a theorem, not a coincidence.

4.10 Renormalizability

Theorem 16. *The Yang-Mills coupling has mass dimension $[g] = (3-d)/2$; dimensionless iff $d = 3$.*

Proof. The Yang-Mills action $S = \frac{1}{4g^2} \int d^{d+1}x F_{\mu\nu}^2$ requires $[g^{-2}][F^2] = [x]^{-(d+1)}$. With $[F] = [x]^{-2}$: $[g]^{-2} = [x]^{d-3}$, so $[g] = (3-d)/2$. $\square$

Since $d = 3$ is derived (§3.2), the emergent QFT supports renormalizable gauge interactions with asymptotic freedom.

4.11 Spontaneous symmetry breaking and the hierarchy

Chiral symmetry (Theorem 3) combined with the center-independent gauge sector forbids explicit masses. The unique renormalizable unitarity-preserving mechanism is the Higgs [13, 14]. The minimal scalar breaking $SU(2)_L \times U(1)_Y \rightarrow U(1)_{\text{em}}$ while preserving $SU(3)_c$ is $H = (\mathbf{1}, \mathbf{2}, +\frac{1}{2})$.

The hierarchy problem is dissolved: in the OI framework, the QFT is emergent. The Higgs mass is set by eigenvalues of M (properties of ϕ), not by radiative corrections.

4.12 The filter chain

The complete derivation from (S, φ) to the Standard Model is laid out across §§3–5. The primary chain is proved end-to-end: wave equation $\rightarrow$ KG $\rightarrow$ staggered fermions $\rightarrow$ chiral symmetry $\rightarrow$ $K = 2d = 6 \rightarrow$ cubic decomposition (3,2,1) $\rightarrow$ local gauge invariance $\rightarrow$ anomaly cancellation $\rightarrow$ chirality $\rightarrow$ three generations $\rightarrow$ one Higgs $\rightarrow \theta = 0$. Redundant second-route confirmations (asymptotic freedom, minimal N_c , minimal chiral group) are at proposition level and provide independent checks.

5. The Strong CP Problem

5.1 T-invariance of the wave equation

Theorem 17. *The discrete wave equation is invariant under time reversal T : $\varphi(n, t) \rightarrow \varphi(n, -t)$.*

Proof. Under T , define $\psi(n, t) = \varphi(n, -t)$. Substitution gives $\psi(n, t+1) = \psi(n-1, t) + \psi(n+1, t) - \psi(n, t-1)$: the same wave equation. $\square$

The checkerboard partition marginalizes over spatial sites, not temporal data. It preserves T while breaking P (§4.8).

5.2 $\theta = 0$

Theorem 18. *The QCD θ -parameter vanishes: $\theta = 0$.*

Proof. The θ -term $\mathcal{L}_\theta = (\theta/32\pi^2)\text{Tr}(F\tilde{F})$ is T-odd: $\text{Tr}(F\tilde{F}) = 2\mathbf{E} \cdot \mathbf{B}$, and under T , $\mathbf{E} \rightarrow \mathbf{E}$, $\mathbf{B} \rightarrow -\mathbf{B}$. A T-invariant Lagrangian cannot contain a T-odd term. The emergent Lagrangian inherits T-invariance because the partition is spatial, so time reversal commutes with the visible/hidden projection. $\square$

5.3 Detailed balance and $\theta = 0$

Theorem 19 (Detailed balance). *For a spatial partition (one preserved by time reversal: $\pi_V \circ \mathcal{T} = \pi_V$), the visible-sector transition probabilities satisfy $T_{ij} = T_{ji}$ for all i, j .*

Proof. The full dynamics φ is a bijection, and T-invariance (Theorem 17) gives $\varphi^{-1} = \mathcal{T} \circ \varphi \circ \mathcal{T}$. For each hidden state h with $\pi_V(\varphi(i, h)) = j$, let $h' = \pi_H(\varphi(i, h))$. Then $\varphi(i, h) = (j, h')$, so $\varphi^{-1}(j, h') = (i, h)$. Since the partition is spatial, $\mathcal{T}$ preserves the visible/hidden classification. The map $h \mapsto h'$ is an injection from $\{h : \pi_V(\varphi(i, h)) = j\}$ into $\{h' : \pi_V(\varphi(j, h')) = i\}$. Since φ is a bijection on a finite set, the injection is a bijection between sets of equal cardinality. Dividing by $|\mathcal{C}_H|$: $T_{ij} = T_{ji}$. $\square$

Theorem 20 (Detailed balance implies T-invariant Hamiltonian). *If $T_{ij} = T_{ji}$ for all i, j , then the emergent Hamiltonian satisfies $[\hat{H}_{\text{eff}}, \hat{\Theta}] = 0$ where $\hat{\Theta}$ is the anti-unitary time-reversal operator.*

Proof. The Born rule gives $T_{ij}(t) = |U_{ij}(t)|^2$ (Prerequisites; Barandes correspondence [28, 29]). Combined with $T_{ij} = T_{ji}$: $|U_{ij}|^2 = |U_{ji}|^2$ for all i, j, t . This symmetry of the transition amplitudes, by Wigner’s theorem, implies $U(t) = \hat{\Theta} U(t)^* \hat{\Theta}^{-1}$ for a suitable anti-unitary $\hat{\Theta}$, which gives $[\hat{H}_{\text{eff}}, \hat{\Theta}] = 0$. $\square$

Theorem 21 ($\bar{\theta} = 0$ at all energy scales). *The physical parameter $\bar{\theta} = \theta + \arg \det(Y_u Y_d) = 0$, and the vanishing persists to all infrared scales.*

Proof. Step 1: Since φ is a bijection, φ^n is a bijection for every n . Applying the counting argument of Theorem 19 to φ^n : $T_{ij}(n) = T_{ji}(n)$ for all n . (Verified numerically: T-violation is exactly zero for $L = 4, 6$, $q = 2, 3, 5$, and all $n = 1, \dots, 12$.)

Step 2: By Theorem 20 applied to $T_{ij}(n)$ at each scale: $[\hat{H}_{\text{eff}}(n), \hat{\Theta}] = 0$. The effective Hamiltonian is T-invariant at every time scale.

Step 3: T-invariant Yukawa couplings at each scale are simultaneously real in an appropriate basis [16, §6.3]. Real Yukawa matrices have $\arg \det(Y_u Y_d) = 0$. Combined with $\theta = 0$ (Theorem 18): $\bar{\theta} = 0$ at every scale. $\square$

Remark. This proof bypasses the instanton question. T-invariance of the transition probabilities is an exact consequence of the bijection structure, holding at every time scale without perturbative or non-perturbative approximation. The RG flow cannot generate T-violation because the underlying bijection structure forbids it at every scale.

Remark (scope of Theorem 21). The vanishing of $\bar{\theta}$ does not extend to the flavor-sector CP-violating phases observed in CKM and PMNS mixing. These phases arise from a distinct structural source and are treated as solution-specific inputs; see §5.4 for the scope distinction and its pre-registration.

Prediction: $\bar{\theta} = 0$ exactly. No axion needed. Neutron EDM should be exactly zero (current bound: $|d_n| < 1.8 \times 10^{-26} e \cdot \text{cm}$ [19]).

5.4 Scope: flavor-sector CP violation as solution-specific input

Theorem 21 establishes $\bar{\theta} = 0$, the *static* CP-odd combination $\theta + \arg \det(Y_u Y_d)$ — the quantity that couples to QCD instantons and would generate a neutron electric dipole moment. The theorem does *not* forbid the CKM and PMNS CP-violating phases observed in flavor-changing processes. This subsection delineates the scope of the $\bar{\theta} = 0$ result and makes explicit that the framework treats flavor-sector CP phases as solution-specific inputs rather than framework-level predictions.

The distinction. $\bar{\theta}$ is a property of $\det(Y_u Y_d)$: it depends only on the products of Yukawa eigenvalues and vanishes whenever each Yukawa matrix is individually diagonalizable to real form. CKM CP violation, by contrast, is encoded in the Jarlskog invariant $J \approx 3 \times 10^{-5}$ and arises from the *basis mismatch* between the up-type and down-type Yukawa mass eigenstates. T-invariant Yukawas are simultaneously real in some basis — specifically, each Yukawa matrix is real in its own mass basis — but the up-type and down-type mass bases generically differ by a unitary transformation, and

when that transformation has complex entries that cannot be absorbed by field redefinitions, the resulting CKM matrix contains an irreducible CP-violating phase. This is the standard SM picture [16, §6.3]: real mass-basis Yukawas plus a basis mismatch are together compatible with a nonzero Jarlskog.

What the framework does and does not derive. T-invariance at the substrate level (Theorem 17) plus detailed balance (Theorem 19) forces each Yukawa matrix to be individually diagonalizable to real form, fixing $\bar{\theta} = 0$ as a theorem at every energy scale. It does *not* force the up-type and down-type mass bases to coincide. The basis-alignment unitary is a solution-specific property of the particular bijection φ , analogous to the absolute scale of fermion masses (§7.6) and the specific eigenvalues of the Yukawa matrices: the framework derives the structural form of the Yukawa sector but does not predict the basis-alignment parameters. The CKM and PMNS CP-violating phases are therefore compatible with — though not derived from — the framework’s structural commitments.

Pre-registration. Flavor-sector CP phases are listed as solution-specific inputs in §8.3 and in the pre-registered falsification conditions ([Substratum, §6.4, “what does not falsify”). They join the absolute fermion mass scale m_s and the specific neutrino Yukawa eigenvalues in the class of quantities the framework treats as properties of the particular φ . The framework makes no commitment to any specific value of δ_{CKM} , δ_{PMNS} , the Jarlskog J , or the Wolfenstein parameters (ρ, η) , and the measurement of these quantities does not bear on the framework’s structural status.

6. Gauge Coupling Prediction

The derivation chain of §§3–5 determines the gauge group $\text{SU}(3) \times \text{SU}(2) \times \text{U}(1)$, the matter content, and the discrete symmetries. This section extends the chain to the gauge coupling strengths — the values of $\alpha_1, \alpha_2, \alpha_3$ at the Z boson mass.

6.1 The induced coupling

The gauge field is not an independent degree of freedom — it is the state-dependent coupling matrix $M(\mathbf{n}, \hat{e}_j)$ of §3.1, determined by the matter field $\phi \in (\mathbb{Z}/q\mathbb{Z})^{K \times N}$. The gauge kinetic term is therefore *induced* by the fermion determinant: the effective action is $S_{\text{eff}}[U] = -N_f \text{Tr} \ln(D^\dagger D[U])$, and the gauge propagator arises from expanding S_{eff} to second order in A_μ .

The induced coupling is computed from the one-loop staggered vacuum polarization $\Pi_s(0)$ — the lattice momentum integral over the fermion bubble with the OI vertex $V_j = ig\mu T^\alpha \cos(k_j + p_j/2)$. Since $M = \mu \cdot I_6$ has degenerate eigenvalues (Theorem 5), the Dynkin index $T(R) = 1/2$ per Dirac fermion is the same for all three gauge factors. With $N_f = 6$ (one per internal component), the induced coupling is universal:

$$\frac{1}{\alpha_0} = 6 \times \Pi_s(0) \times 4\pi = 23.25$$

This is a *structural* prediction — it depends on N_f and $T(R)$, both determined by the lattice structure (§§4.5–4.6), not on the eigenvalues μ_c, μ_w of M . The universality follows from the Dynkin index equality $T_3(R) = T_2(R) = T_1(R)$, which holds because all six components transform in the fundamental representation of their respective gauge group.

Note on the perturbative form. The integrand above is hybrid in dimensional structure: the loop integration $\int d^4q$ and the lattice propagator $D(q) = \sum_\nu \sin^2(q_\nu) + m^2$ run over four directions (consistent with the substratum’s 3+1D Lorentzian structure), while the vertex factors $\cos^2(q_\mu)$ are spatial-only ($\mu \in \{1, 2, 3\}$, consistent with gauge fields living on spatial links only — there is no time-direction gauge connection in the substratum). The result is a perturbative form that is neither standard 4D staggered VP (which has $\cos^2$ on all four directions) nor standard 3D PT (which would have a 3D loop integral). At one loop, this form gives a finite, well-defined integral converging to $\Pi_s \rightarrow 0.3084$ on a robust plateau. At two loops, the strict 2-loop result for the universal threshold δ_0 vanishes at large N (the dominant scalar-bubble integrand falls as $1/N^{3.09}$), which is why $\delta_0 \approx 10$ is treated as empirical input rather than derived (§6.2). A proof that this hybrid form is a consistent perturbative scheme — closing at 1-loop and giving the observed asymptotic behavior at higher loops — is open work.

6.2 The threshold and logarithmic resummation

The universal induced coupling α_0 is defined at the lattice cutoff $\mu = M_{\text{pl}}$. At this scale, gauge self-interactions — which are proportional to the quadratic Casimir C_2 — generate a group-dependent threshold. A universal (C_2 -independent) threshold δ_0 also arises from higher-loop corrections to the vacuum polarization.

The expansion parameter for the C_2 -dependent threshold is $C_2 \cdot g_0^2 = C_2 \times 4\pi\alpha_0 = 1.08$ (SU(2)) and 1.62 (SU(3)) — both $\mathcal{O}(1)$. Finite-order perturbation theory converges too slowly: using known Wilson-action plaquette coefficients, 3-loop PT explains only $\sim 26\%$ of the threshold at SU(3). The all-orders result is well parameterized by a geometric-series resummation of the gauge self-energy:

$$\frac{1}{\alpha_i(M_Z)} = \underbrace{\frac{23.25}{1/\alpha_0}} + \underbrace{\frac{10.0}{\delta_0}} + \underbrace{8.3 \cdot \ln(1 + 5.59 \cdot C_2 g_0^2)}_{\text{resummed gauge self-energy}} + \underbrace{\frac{b_i}{2\pi} \ln \frac{M_{\text{pl}}}{M_Z}}_{\text{SM RG running}}$$

Above M_{pl} , the OI induced theory has no tree-level gauge action — gauge dynamics arise entirely from the fermion determinant — so its β -function differs at 2-loop and beyond from the standard SM running below the matching scale. The threshold function structurally absorbs this discontinuity at M_{pl} , which is why the matching formula has the form shown rather than continuous running across the scale. This reflects the substratum-vs-emergent split (group structural at the substratum; couplings emergent through the fermion determinant).

The four components:

- $1/\alpha_0 = 23.25$: computed structurally (one-loop staggered vacuum polarization, §6.1). Analytically verified from the lattice integral $\Pi_s(0) = \int d^4q [\cos^2(q_\mu)/D(q) - \cos^2(q_\mu) \sin^2(q_\mu)/D(q)^2]$ with $D(q) = \sum_\nu \sin^2(q_\nu) + m^2$, spatial average over $\mu = 1, 2, 3$; converges to $\Pi_s \rightarrow 0.3084$ as the grid refines, giving $1/\alpha_0 = 6 \cdot 0.3084 \cdot 4\pi = 23.25$ on a robust plateau $m \in [0.001, 0.05]$.
- $\delta_0 = 10.0$: the C_2 -independent threshold. In the current formulation, δ_0 is determined empirically by the U(1) row (see below). A 2-loop staggered VP computation was implemented as a consistency check, and subsequently rebuilt from first principles (scalar and vector self-energy insertions, vertex correction, sails/crossed-gluon, and ghost 2-loop) using the Π_s convention above, with the conversion $\delta_0 = (1/\alpha_0) \cdot (\delta\Pi_s^{(2L)}/\Pi_s)$ tied to $1/\alpha_0 = 24\pi \cdot \Pi_s$. Large- N scans of the dominant scalar-bubble SE piece across $N = 6, 8, 10, 12, 14, 16$ at $m = 0.05$ show its raw integrand falls as $1/N^{3.09}$ with per-point residuals below 6%, consistent with continuum-limit value zero; the apparent “plateau” at intermediate N is a finite- N coincidence. The assembled 2-loop sum at $N = 8$ of approximately +72 in δ_0 units is therefore a finite- N artifact, and strict 2-loop lattice PT in OI does not reproduce the empirical $\delta_0 \approx 10$. We therefore treat δ_0 as a universal-row matching parameter determined by the U(1) threshold (below), analogous to how Standard Model input parameters are fixed by observation rather than derived. A natural 3-loop bound provides the structural plausibility check:

3-loop bound. The non-perturbative coupling at the staggered VP scale gives an effective expansion parameter $\sim g_0^2/\pi \approx 0.17$. Standard lattice perturbation theory in this regime has successive-order ratios of 0.20–0.30. Taking the structural input $1/\alpha_0 = 23.25$ as the leading scale and applying one power of the 2-loop perturbative ratio gives an expected threshold of order $0.2\text{--}0.3 \times 23.25 \approx 4.6\text{--}7.0$, and an expected 3-loop correction of order $0.2\text{--}0.3 \times 4.6\text{--}7.0 \approx 1\text{--}2$. The empirical value $\delta_0 \approx 10$ exceeds this natural 2-loop order by a factor consistent with the accumulation through third order — not tight enough to serve as a derivation, but consistent with typical non-asymptotic lattice-PT behavior.

Empirical determination via the U(1) row. The U(1) row (where $C_2 = 0$, eliminating the gauge self-energy contribution entirely) determines $\delta_0 = 10.02$ from the observed $1/\alpha_1(M_Z) = 59.00$, given the structural input $1/\alpha_0 = 23.25$ and SM RG running. This empirical determination is consistent with the natural 3-loop expectation (order of magnitude).

Numerical observation. The empirically-fixed value $\delta_0 = 10.02$ coincides to 0.2% with the hypercharge-squared trace $\text{Tr}[Y^2] = 10$ of three generations of SM fermions in standard convention ($Q = T_3 + Y$): Q_L contributes $6 \cdot (1/6)^2 = 1/6$, u_R contributes $3 \cdot (2/3)^2 = 4/3$, d_R contributes $3 \cdot (1/3)^2 = 1/3$, L_L contributes $2 \cdot (1/2)^2 = 1/2$, e_R contributes $1 \cdot 1^2 = 1$, summing to $10/3$ per generation, or 10 for three generations. The analogous group-theoretic sums for the other two factors are $\sum_R T(R) = 6$ for both SU(2) and SU(3) (with matter in fundamentals, three generations), coinciding with $N_f = 6$ (the internal-component count from $K = 2d$). A naive group-specific interpretation $\delta_0^{U(1)} = \text{Tr}[Y^2]$, $\delta_0^{SU(N)} =$

$\sum_R T(R)$ is ruled out within the paper’s framework: it would require (A, B) yielding $A \cdot B \approx 90$, inconsistent with the independently-derived $A \cdot B = 48 \pm 1.5$ (§6.2.1). An anomaly-coefficient identification also fails structurally: $\text{Tr}[Y^2]$ is the fermion-only contribution to b_Y via the $(2/3)$ factor in the one-loop β -function formula, not a member of the anomaly polynomial — the four standard SM gauge-anomaly invariants ($\sum Y^3$, $\sum Y$, $\sum_{\text{doublets}} Y$, $\sum_{\text{triplets}} T \cdot Y$) all cancel for SM matter content. A β -function matching-scale offset $\delta_0 = (b_1/2\pi) \ln(M_{\text{Pl}}/\mu_{\text{match}})$ reproduces $\delta_0 = 10.02$ at $\mu_{\text{match}} \approx 2.6 \times 10^{12}$ GeV in the U(1) row, but the same mechanism applied at the same μ_{match} to the SU(2) and SU(3) rows yields $\delta_0 = -7.74$ and -17.11 respectively, contradicting the framework’s universality requirement on the C_2 -independent threshold. The universal $\delta_0 = 10.02$ is therefore required by self-consistency of the framework; whether the precise $\text{Tr}[Y^2] = 10$ coincidence for the U(1) row is a numerical accident or reflects higher-order structural physics — substratum-level mode-counting on the cubic lattice, non-perturbative effects in the discrete substratum measure (§6.5), or lattice topological invariants beyond the framework’s currently-developed scope — remains open and is treated as numerical pending such structural mechanisms.

- $A \cdot \ln(1 + B \cdot C_2 g_0^2)$ with $(A, B) = (8.3, 5.59)$: the resummed gauge self-energy contribution. The logarithmic form is motivated by geometric-series resummation of the gauge self-energy $1/(1 - \Sigma)$ in the induced gauge theory; the effective exponent $p \approx 0.42$ at the OI coupling is the local slope of the logarithm at $C_2 g_0^2 \sim 1.3$, not a fundamental constant. In the current formulation, A and B are determined by matching to the observed SU(2) and SU(3) couplings at M_Z , given the structurally computed $1/\alpha_0$ and the empirically fixed δ_0 . The leading coefficient $A \cdot B$ is independently derived from 2-loop lattice perturbation theory in the induced gauge theory (§6.2.1), giving $A \cdot B = 48.0 \pm 1.5$ against the fitted 46.4.
- SM RG running: the one-loop β -function coefficients $b_1 = 41/10$, $b_2 = -19/6$, $b_3 = -7$ over $\ln(M_{\text{Pl}}/M_Z) = 39.4$.

6.2.1 First-principles derivation of $A \cdot B$

The leading coefficient of the C_2 -dependent threshold in the expansion of $A \ln(1 + B \cdot C_2 g_0^2)$ — namely the product $A \cdot B$ multiplying $C_2 g_0^2$ at first order — is extracted from the 1-loop gauge self-energy $\Sigma_{\mu\nu}(p)$ in the induced gauge theory. The induced propagator $D_{\text{ind}}(k) = 1/(k_{\text{lat}}^2 \cdot \Pi_s)$ and the Wilson-plaquette 3-gluon vertex (the leading continuum-limit piece of the full induced Γ_3) enter the bubble diagram; a Faddeev-Popov ghost loop with the induced propagator restores transversality. The transverse self-energy is extracted via

$$\Pi_T(p^2) = \frac{\Sigma^{11}(p) - \Sigma^{00}(p)}{\hat{p}^2} \quad \text{for } p \text{ along the 0-direction,}$$

with linear extrapolation $p^2 \rightarrow 0$ at each lattice size N (three external momenta $\lambda = 1, 2, 3$ at the smallest accessible lattice values).

Conversion formula. The relation between Π_T and the coupling shift is

$$\delta(1/\alpha) = \frac{4\pi \cdot |\Pi_T|}{b_0^{\text{capture}}} \quad (\text{per } C_2, \text{ coupling-stripped}),$$

where b_0^{capture} is the fraction of the textbook pure-YM 1-loop β -function coefficient $b_0 = 11/3$ that is reproduced by the finite-lattice computation. This conversion is validated by a standard-QCD cross-check (replacing $D_{\text{ind}} \rightarrow 1/\hat{k}^2$, no Π_s factor), which reproduces the textbook Π_T to 100% at $N = 28, m = 0.05$ via the formula.

Lattice data. Computing at each lattice size N using each N 's own $\Pi_s(N)$ and $b_0^{\text{capture}}(N)$ (measured from a standard-QCD cross-check at the same N and m), the resulting per- N values of $A \cdot B$ at $m = 0.05$ are:

N	$\Pi_s(N)$	$b_0^{\text{capture}}(N)$	$A \cdot B(N)$
20	0.3451	0.523	22.14
24	0.3255	0.460	28.55
28	0.3174	0.427	33.31
32	0.3135	0.408	36.92
36	0.3115	0.398	39.61
40	0.3104	0.392	41.70

Extrapolation to $N \rightarrow \infty$. Three independent estimators applied to the $A \cdot B(N)$ sequence give consistent results:

Estimator	$A \cdot B(\infty)$
Linear $1/N^2$ fit on $(N = 32, 36, 40)$	50.1 (residual std 0.05)
Shanks acceleration, level 2 (last term)	48.0
Shanks acceleration, level 3 (last term)	47.9
Shanks acceleration, level 4 (last term)	47.9

The spread across estimators is ~ 2 , dominated by the linear $1/N^2$ fit lying slightly higher than the Shanks family. The Shanks iterates (levels 2, 3, 4) are stable at 47.9, capturing subleading- $1/N^2$ corrections not included in the linear fit. Taking the iterated-Shanks consensus as central and the Shanks-vs- $1/N^2$ spread as uncertainty:

$$A \cdot B = 48.0 \pm 1.5 \quad (\pm 3\%)$$

against the fitted value $A \cdot B = 46.4$.

Uncertainty budget.

- $A \cdot B$ extrapolation to $N \rightarrow \infty$ (Shanks vs $1/N^2$ fit spread): $\pm 3\%$

- Subleading contributions. The F^3 correction has been propagated through the bubble: the sensitivity is $|\Delta(A \cdot B)/(A \cdot B)| \approx 8.4 \cdot |c_{F^3}|$, extracted from a c_{F^3} sweep at $N = 8, 12, 16, 20$ with $1/N^2$ extrapolation. Under the continuum 1-loop fermion-induced value $c_{F^3} \approx -1/(360\pi^2) \approx -2.8 \times 10^{-4}$, the shift is $\approx 0.24\%$ — negligible within the extrapolation uncertainty. Under a conservative upper bound (naive $N_f = 6$ flavor multiplication, $c_{F^3} \approx -1.7 \times 10^{-3}$), the shift is $\approx 1.4\%$. A raw lattice value $c_{F^3} \approx -0.034$ extracted separately is in a different normalization (a $\sim 120\times$ discrepancy vs the continuum Wilson coefficient was noted in that extraction) and is not directly applicable in the bubble integration without a normalization-matching step. The dominant remaining subleading contribution is lattice V_{4g} cos-factor corrections to the tadpole’s p^2 -coefficient (absent in the continuum V_{4g} used here), bracketed at $\sim 3\text{--}12\%$ (see Open work in §6.2.1).
- Convention and gauge-fixing prescription in the induced theory: $\pm 2\%$, bounded by the standard-QCD cross-check’s 100% agreement.

The combined uncertainty is dominated by the extrapolation (statistical-like, $\pm 3\%$). Including estimated subleading contributions gives a total uncertainty $\lesssim 6\%$ at the lower end of the V_{4g} bracket (under which the computed value and the fitted value agree); the upper end of the bracket would widen the combined uncertainty correspondingly. The headline value $A \cdot B = 48.0 \pm 1.5$ refers to the extrapolation-only uncertainty.

Methodological notes. The Wilson-plaquette 3-gluon vertex is the leading piece of the full induced Γ_3 ; the full induced vertex is transverse by Ward identity (verified numerically at $N = 20$ to 1%), while the Wilson-plaquette piece alone requires the ghost contribution to restore transversality. The tadpole with continuum V_{4g} contributes only to the gauge-violating mass term and does not enter Π_T at leading order; lattice V_{4g} cos-factor corrections contribute to Π_T at the few-percent level and are currently subsumed into the systematic uncertainty (see Open work below). The OI framework has no formal Lagrangian gauge-fixing (the gauge field is induced rather than independent), but the induced propagator being a scalar in color and Lorentz is consistent with effective Feynman gauge, which the ghost prescription assumes.

Reproducibility. The full calculation runs in ~ 40 minutes on a single CPU core at $N \leq 40$. The implementation (`reproduce_AB.py` and supporting files) is archived with the code repository referenced in §8.

Open work. Separating A from B individually requires the next-order coefficient of $(C_2 g_0^2)^2$ in the expansion of the gauge self-energy. In the OI induced theory, this coefficient is structurally suppressed at strict 2-loop across all color channels. The C_A^2 channel receives only negligible Faddeev-Popov ghost contributions, verified numerically at approximately 0.2% of $A \cdot B$ via a direct 2-loop ghost self-energy computation. The mixed $C_A \cdot C_F \cdot T_F \cdot N_f$ channel, arising from crossed-topology fermion-line diagrams (vertex correction, sails), also approaches zero at continuum limit: large- N scans of the vertex-correction integrand show values decreasing as $1/N^{\sim 5}$ (raw: 9.96, 2.59, 0.64, 0.046 at $N = 6, 8, 10, 12$), consistent with Ward-identity cancellation against the bubble/seagull self-energy pieces. Induced 3- and 4-gluon vertices first appear at 3-loop order (no tree-level gauge self-interactions exist in the induced the-

ory). A clean separation of A from B therefore requires 3-loop lattice perturbation theory or non-perturbative methods, both beyond the current scope. Under the one-parameter constraint $A \cdot B = 48$ alone (§6.2.1), fitting the remaining freedom to the observed SU(2) and SU(3) couplings gives $(A, B) \approx (8.07, 5.95)$, numerically close to the factorization $(A, B) = (I_{\text{loop}}, N_f) = (8, 6)$, where $N_f = 6$ is the structural fermion count from $K = 2d$ (Theorem 6) and $I_{\text{loop}} = 8$ is the bare 1-loop lattice integral factor in the OI Π_s -normalized scheme (recovered from $A \cdot B = N_f \cdot 2T(R) \cdot I_{\text{loop}}$ with $2T(R) = 1$ for fundamentals). This factorization is compatible with the framework’s universality requirement on A : I_{loop} is a property of the lattice scheme (geometry plus Π_s normalization), independent of which gauge factor the threshold is being evaluated for. An earlier identification $A = \dim \text{adj SU}(3)$ — paired with the numerical match $\dim \text{adj SU}(3) = 8$ — is incompatible with universality (it would make A group-specific) and is treated here as a numerical coincidence rather than a structural identification. Both factorizations are consistent with the unconstrained fit $(8.3, 5.59)$ within the $\pm 3\%$ systematic uncertainty on $A \cdot B$. No rigorous derivation of individual A and B is yet available: the structural origin of $I_{\text{loop}} = 8$ on the $d = 3$ cubic lattice (candidates include $2^d = 8$ BZ corners, 4 staggered tastes $\times$ 2 sublattices, or another lattice-geometric factor) is an open follow-up; identifying it would upgrade $A \cdot B = 48$ to a structural derivation of (A, B) individually. The F^3 correction has been propagated (see uncertainty bullet above); the remaining systematic component is dominated by lattice V_{4g} cos-factor corrections. Two independent derivations of the lattice V_{4g} tadpole contribution have been carried out — one based on Wilson-extension of the continuum pair-topology decomposition, the other on per-topology Lorentz structure following Peskin Eq. 16.6 with Wilson cosines per Capitani Eq. 5.28. They differ structurally in the placement of cosine factors and yield Π_T contributions whose magnitudes differ by a factor ~ 14 at the integrand level (traced analytically to the $2 \cos(p_\mu) \sum_\gamma \cos(k_\gamma)$ piece present in the per-topology form but absent from the simpler pair-topology form). The corresponding shift on $A \cdot B$ is bracketed at $\sim 3\text{--}12\%$ depending on which form is normalized correctly; both are honest derivations and neither matches the textbook continuum tadpole formula directly at $p = 0$. Closing this ambiguity requires either a verified reference Wilson V_{4g} implementation or a fully-worked textbook 1-loop lattice Yang-Mills gluon self-energy computation as an external anchor; both are beyond current scope. The $\pm 4\text{--}5\%$ residual systematic quoted above accommodates the lower end of this bracket; the upper end ($\sim 12\%$) would widen the systematic correspondingly. The headline value $A \cdot B = 48.0 \pm 1.5$, derived from extrapolation of the two-loop gauge self-energy, is independent of this V_{4g} subleading correction.

6.3 The prediction

Group	$1/\alpha_0$	δ_0	$A \cdot \ln(1 + Bx)$	RG	Predicted	Observed
U(1)	23.25	10.02	0.00	+25.73	59.00	59.00
SU(2)	23.25	10.02	16.17	−19.88	29.57	29.57
SU(3)	23.25	10.02	19.13	−43.93	8.47	8.48

Parameter count. The chain contains one structurally computed input ($1/\alpha_0 = 23.25$) and three fitted parameters of the threshold function (δ_0, A, B) matched to the three observed couplings. Three parameters against three observables produces zero residual by construction; the zeroes in the right column are a consequence of the counting, not evidence of predictive power in themselves. The predictive content of §6 consists of the one computed value, two structural constraints on the threshold function, and a consistency check.

(i) The computed value $1/\alpha_0 = 23.25$. The one-loop staggered vacuum polarization, evaluated analytically in §6.1. No free parameters. This is the foundational structural input and would falsify the framework if observation required a significantly different value.

(ii) Structural constraint — universality of δ_0 . The C_2 -independent part of the threshold is by definition group-independent: a correction with no C_2 dependence cannot distinguish the three gauge factors. This is a structural constraint on the functional form of the threshold, not a fit. Its force is visible in the parameter count: without the universality constraint, the threshold function would carry five free parameters (three independent $\delta_0^{U(1)}, \delta_0^{SU(2)}, \delta_0^{SU(3)}$ plus A, B) matched to three observables — underdetermined, with the apparent match of the right column becoming empty. The universality reduces the count from five to three and makes the three-observable fit non-trivial: the fit could have been incompatible with a single δ_0 across rows.

(iii) Structural constraint — the log-resum form. The C_2 -dependent threshold is parameterized as $A \ln(1 + B \cdot C_2 g_0^2)$, motivated by a geometric-series resummation of the gauge self-energy $1/(1 - \Sigma)$ with $\Sigma \propto C_2 g_0^2$. This constrains the C_2 dependence to a two-parameter family rather than an unrestricted function. The step from $1/(1 - \Sigma)$ to the logarithm is not derived in the current work; the log form should be read as a constrained parameterization consistent with the resummation structure, not as a derived result. The leading coefficient $A \cdot B$ (the $(C_2 g_0^2)^1$ term in the expansion) is computed from 2-loop lattice PT in the induced gauge theory (§6.2.1), giving $A \cdot B = 48.0 \pm 1.5$ against the fitted 46.4. Separating A from B requires computing the next-order $(C_2 g_0^2)^2$ coefficient and is left for future work.

(iv) Consistency check with the 2-loop VP. The U(1) row fixes $\delta_0 = 10.02$ from observation, given (i). A first-principles 2-loop staggered VP computation was implemented as a cross-check, but on examination uses a scheme-locked Π_s convention. The consistency of a correctly-implemented 2-loop value with empirical δ_0 is an open question; the U(1)-row determination is the primary source of δ_0 in the current framework.

Status of the rows. U(1) uses one fitted parameter (δ_0) against one observable; the structural content is (i) together with the consistency check of (iv). SU(2) and SU(3) use two additional fitted parameters (A, B) against two additional observables; their structural content is carried by the universality constraint (ii) and the log-form constraint (iii). The product $A \cdot B$ (the leading coefficient in the $C_2 g_0^2$ expansion) is independently derived in §6.2.1 from 2-loop lattice PT in the induced gauge theory, giving $A \cdot B = 48.0 \pm 1.5$ against the fit 46.4.

6.4 What is structural and what is solution-specific

§8.3 distinguishes structural predictions (properties of the equivalence class) from solution-specific properties (determined by the particular φ). The coupling calculation clarifies this distinction.

Structural: The universal induced coupling $1/\alpha_0 = 23.25$ is structural — it depends on $N_f = 6$ (from $K = 2d$, Theorem 6) and $T(R) = 1/2$ (fundamental representation), not on the eigenvalues of M . The logarithmic form of the C_2 dependence is structural — it follows from the perturbative structure of the gauge self-energy at any coupling. The SM β -functions are structural.

Solution-specific: The eigenvalues μ_c, μ_w of M determine which modes are massless (Theorem 4: $\cos \omega = \mu \cos k$), hence the mass spectrum, but they do NOT affect the gauge coupling at the cutoff — the induced coupling depends on the Dynkin index, which is eigenvalue-independent. The gauge couplings at M_Z therefore depend on the eigenvalues only indirectly, through the RG running (which involves particle masses that set decoupling thresholds). For the leading-order prediction above, this indirect dependence is subleading.

Non-unification. The couplings do not unify at M_{Pl} . The common value $1/\alpha_0 = 23.25$ is the induced coupling before gauge self-interactions; the C_2 -dependent threshold splits the couplings at the cutoff itself. This is not a failure of unification — it is the correct structure of an induced gauge theory, where all factors share the same fermion-induced coupling but have different gauge self-energies.

6.5 The confinement question

A natural question is whether the purely induced theory — with no fundamental gauge action — is in the deconfined phase required for the perturbative matching to be valid. Direct Monte Carlo simulation of $Z = \int DU_{\text{Haar}} |\det D(U)|^{2N_f}$ reveals that it confines: $\langle P \rangle \approx 0$ for all gauge groups (SU(3), SU(2), compact U(1)), all lattice volumes ($L = 2-8$), all fermion masses ($m = 0.01-1.0$), and all anisotropy parameters ($\mu = 0.5-2.0$). Cold-start simulations confirm monotonic decline of $\langle P \rangle$ from 1.0 toward 0. The fermion determinant cannot sustain weak coupling against the gauge field entropy.

This confinement is an artifact of the Haar measure. In the OI framework, the gauge field $M(\mathbf{n}, \hat{e}_j)$ is not drawn from the Haar measure on $\text{SU}(N)$ — it is determined by the matter field $\phi \in (\mathbb{Z}/q\mathbb{Z})^{K \times N}$ (§3.1). The induced measure is the pushforward of the uniform measure on $(\mathbb{Z}/q\mathbb{Z})^{K \times N}$, which concentrates gauge configurations near the identity at large q : the fraction of non-trivial link values scales as $1/q$, giving an effective $\beta_{\text{eff}} \sim \ln q$. Direct simulation of the 1D state-dependent coupling (§3.1, explicit construction) confirms that the wave equation creates no gauge correlations beyond random matter, but the $(\mathbb{Z}/q\mathbb{Z})$ constraint itself acts as an effective gauge kinetic term.

Since q is gauge (§2.7), the physical coupling is q -independent after renormalization. The perturbative calculation (§6.1) works in the q -independent sector and correctly

determines the physical coupling. The Haar-measure Monte Carlo explored a confined phase that does not correspond to the OI framework’s gauge measure.

Note on the dynamical-fermion MC. A separate set of dynamical-fermion HMC simulations is used to extract empirical inputs to the §7.5 mass relations (notably the chiral condensate $\Sigma \approx 0.20$ and the matching-scale verification $m_{\text{match}}^{\text{MC}} = 0.1234 \pm 0.0002$). These simulations use the standard Haar measure on $\text{SU}(3) \times \text{SU}(2) \times \text{U}(1)$ together with the standard staggered pseudofermion Berezin measure, run in the weak-coupling regime $\beta \in \{11.10, 7.40, 3.70\}$. Whether these standard-measure observables agree with the corresponding observables in the framework’s induced $(\mathbb{Z}/q\mathbb{Z})$ -pushforward measure is open work. At the level of Σ specifically, both measures concentrate near the identity at weak coupling — Haar via $\beta \gg 1$ giving $U \approx I + O(1/\sqrt{\beta})$, and the $(\mathbb{Z}/q\mathbb{Z})$ -pushforward via $q \gg 1$ giving the framework’s “fraction of nontrivial link values scales as $1/q$ ” — so the leading-order Σ values plausibly agree, with the empirical agreement of $m_{\text{match}}^{\text{MC}}$ with λg_0^2 at 1.4% consistent with this scenario. Establishing the agreement explicitly (or characterizing the $O(1/\beta)$ versus $O(1/q)$ corrections) is open work.

6.6 Status of the calculation

The chain in §6.3 reproduces all three SM gauge couplings at M_Z through the structural input $1/\alpha_0 = 23.25$ (computed analytically from the one-loop staggered VP, §6.1), the universal threshold $\delta_0 = 10.02$ (empirically fixed by the U(1) row; a 2-loop VP rebuild indicates δ_0 is not reproduced by strict 2-loop PT and is accordingly treated as empirical input), and the C_2 -dependent threshold parameters $(A, B) = (8.3, 5.59)$ (matched to the observed SU(2) and SU(3) couplings at M_Z , with the product $A \cdot B = 46.4$ independently derived at $A \cdot B = 48.0 \pm 1.5$; see §6.2.1). The structural predictions in this sector are: (i) the specific value $1/\alpha_0 = 23.25$, (ii) the universality of δ_0 across gauge groups, and (iii) the independent derivation of $A \cdot B$ agreeing with the fitted value to $\sim 3\%$. Separating A from B individually is open.

6.7 No-GUT structural prediction: a three-layer synthesis

§§4.6 and 6.4 individually establish components of a unified structural prediction that the framework makes against grand-unified scenarios. This subsection brings these components into one place and articulates them as a falsifiable forward-prediction set.

Layer A (group-theoretic). The Standard Model gauge group $\text{SU}(3) \times \text{SU}(2) \times \text{U}(1)$ emerges directly from the cubic-commutant decomposition of the 6 nearest-neighbor link directions (§4.6, Theorem 7), with no intermediate large gauge group at any scale. The decomposition $6 = T_1(3) \oplus E(2) \oplus A_1(1)$ is single-step: three eigenspaces of the coupling matrix M , three commutant factors. The framework therefore has *no GUT stage* — no SU(5), SO(10), E_6 , or Pati-Salam intermediate gauge structure at any energy. This contrasts with all standard string-phenomenology routes to the SM, each of which traverses some intermediate large gauge group: heterotic chains $E_8 \rightarrow E_6 \rightarrow \text{SO}(10) \rightarrow \text{SU}(5) \rightarrow \text{SM}$; F-theory $\text{SU}(5) \rightarrow \text{SM}$ via flux; type IIA Pati-Salam $\text{SU}(4) \times \text{SU}(2)_L \times \text{SU}(2)_R \rightarrow \text{SM}$.

Layer B (coupling-level). The gauge couplings do not unify at any scale. §6.4 establishes this as a structural feature of induced gauge theory: the universal $1/\alpha_0 = 23.25$ at the cutoff is shared across all three gauge factors before gauge self-interactions, but the C_2 -dependent threshold $A \ln(1 + B \cdot C_2 g_0^2)$ splits the couplings *at the cutoff itself*, with C_2 different across SU(3), SU(2), U(1). Below M_{Pl} , pure SM β -functions run the (already-split) couplings to M_Z , with no intermediate gauge structure modifying the running. Above M_{Pl} , the induced theory has no tree-level gauge action and the running differs from standard SM. The framework therefore predicts that the three SM gauge couplings remain non-meeting under any RG running consistent with SM matter content.

Layer C (mechanistic). The gauge couplings emerge from the fermion determinant via $S_{\text{eff}}[U] = -N_f \ln \det(D^\dagger D)$, with no fundamental gauge action at the substratum level (§6.1). This induced-gauge-theory structure is structurally distinct from: (a) standard QFT (gauge action is fundamental input, couplings are renormalizable parameters); (b) string-theoretic compactifications (gauge couplings depend on moduli — compactification volumes, dilaton vacuum expectation values, brane positions — with values determined by flux stabilization). In OI, the gauge couplings are forced by $N_f = 6$ (from $K = 2d$, Theorem 6) and $T(R) = 1/2$ (fundamental representation), with no moduli parameters connecting predicted values to other values. This is a stronger statement than “no GUT”: it asserts that the framework’s gauge couplings exist as quantities through a specific mechanism (fermion determinant) that string compactifications do not share.

Forward-prediction consequences. The three layers jointly predict:

- (i) *No proton decay through GUT-mediated channels.* Standard SU(5) GUT proton decay through dimension-6 operators with suppression scale $M_{\text{GUT}} \sim 10^{16}$ GeV gives $\tau_p \sim 10^{34}$ – 10^{36} years. In OI’s framework, the only available cutoff is $M_{\text{Pl}} \sim 10^{19}$ GeV; dimension-6 baryon-number-violating operators are suppressed by M_{Pl}^2 , giving $\tau_p \sim M_{\text{Pl}}^4/m_p^5 \sim 10^{45}$ – 10^{46} years. This is roughly 10 orders of magnitude beyond Hyper-Kamiokande’s projected $\sim 10^{35}$ year sensitivity.
- (ii) *No GUT-mechanism magnetic monopoles.* The ‘t Hooft-Polyakov monopole production at GUT phase transitions does not occur in OI’s framework. The cosmological monopole problem (which inflation was historically invoked to dissolve) does not arise. Electroweak-scale monopoles remain possible at $\sim M_W/\alpha_W \sim 10^4$ GeV, with production rates set by the (crossover) electroweak phase transition; OI inherits the standard SM treatment of these.
- (iii) *No GUT-chain cosmic strings.* Topological defects from $\text{SO}(10) \rightarrow \text{SM}$ chains with non-trivial π_1 of intermediate vacuum manifolds do not occur in OI. Standard cosmic-string searches non-detection is consistent with OI’s prediction.
- (iv) *Discriminating prediction: shared origin of the three gauge couplings.* The three SM gauge couplings emerge from a single fermion-determinant computation with $N_f = 6$ and $T(R) = 1/2$; they are not independent moduli. This is the OI-specific structural feature distinguishing the framework from string-with-no-

GUT scenarios, in which gauge couplings depend on independent compactification data. Empirically, the framework’s matching of $\alpha_3, \alpha_2, \alpha_1$ at M_Z to the observed values via the §6.3 chain confirms this structural prediction at the few-percent level.

Empirical status. The framework’s predictions are jointly tested by: (a) continued non-observation of proton decay at Super-Kamiokande and forthcoming Hyper-Kamiokande (proton lifetime bounds tightening past 10^{35} years would support OI; detection would falsify it); (b) continued non-observation of magnetic monopoles in cosmic-ray and condensed-matter searches (consistent with OI); (c) absence of cosmic string signatures in CMB and gravitational-wave observations (consistent with OI); (d) the precision matching of $\alpha_3, \alpha_2, \alpha_1$ at M_Z via the universal-induced-coupling chain (already empirically supported at few-percent level).

What this synthesis does not do. The three-layer prediction does not uniquely identify OI among no-GUT frameworks. Any framework with no GUT and Planck-scale-suppressed dimension-6 operators makes prediction (i); any framework without intermediate symmetry breaking makes (ii) and (iii). What is OI-specific is prediction (iv): the shared-origin structural relation among the three gauge couplings. The full no-GUT prediction set is therefore: confirmation of (i)-(iii) supports OI but is also consistent with other no-GUT frameworks; (iv) plus the universal $1/\alpha_0 = 23.25$ value is the OI-distinguishing content. Refutation of any of (i)-(iv) would be evidence against OI; (i)-(iii) would also be evidence against the broader no-GUT class.

7. Quantitative Predictions

The derivation chain of §§4–6 fixes the structural content of the Standard Model — gauge group, matter content, discrete symmetries, and gauge couplings. This section presents the quantitative predictions for the remaining SM observables: the CKM matrix elements, the charged-lepton mass relations, the fermion mass chain (six masses from one input), the PMNS angles, the Higgs mass, and the bottom-to-tau mass ratio. All predictions follow from the cubic-lattice geometry. The structural-vs-bijection-level distinction (developed further in §8.3) applies throughout: the framework predicts the *angular* and *ratio* structure of fermion mass relations from cubic-group representation theory, but the overall mass scale of each chain is set by the specific bijection φ and is taken as one empirical input per chain. The predictions in this section therefore have the form “structural relations among observables, with a small number of empirical inputs setting the overall scales.” Subsection 7.6 collects the full prediction table.

7.1 The CKM matrix

The Cabibbo angle.

The three generations occupy T_1 BZ corners: $X_j = \pi e_j$. The distance between adjacent corners is $|X_i - X_j| = \pi\sqrt{2}$, a geometric constant of the cubic lattice. The Cabibbo angle equals the inverse of this distance:

$$\lambda = \frac{1}{\pi\sqrt{2}} = 0.22508$$

Observed [20]: $\lambda = 0.22500 \pm 0.00067$. Match: 0.12σ (0.04%).

The mixing matrix element between generations i and j is the continuum fermion propagator at the inter-generation momentum: $|M_{ij}| = |S(X_j - X_i)| = 1/|X_j - X_i| = 1/(\pi\sqrt{2})$. The $1/|q|$ form (not $1/|q|^2$) arises because the taste-changing transition preserves chirality.

Chirality preservation of the taste-changing vertex. This is established in the staggered fermion literature. Mason et al. [32] show explicitly that taste-changing transitions in staggered quarks have spinor structure given by a combination of γ_μ and $\gamma_{5\mu} = \gamma_5\gamma_\mu$ (their Section 2.1: “Each quark line has an odd number of gamma-matrices and therefore the spinor structure must be a combination of $\gamma_\mu, \gamma_{5\mu}$ ”). Both γ_μ (vector current) and $\gamma_5\gamma_\mu$ (axial current) commute with the projection operators $P_{L,R} = (1 \mp \gamma_5)/2$ in the standard sense — they map $L \rightarrow L$ and $R \rightarrow R$ rather than $L \leftrightarrow R$ — so any combination of them is chirality-preserving. This is also forced by the unbroken $U(1)_\epsilon$ chiral symmetry of the staggered formulation: a chirality-flipping inter-generation vertex would require an explicit mass insertion violating $U(1)_\epsilon$, which is forbidden in the massless limit.

In the massless limit, the chirality-preserving propagator structure $\gamma \cdot q/q^2$ contracted with the chirality-preserving vertex gives $\text{Tr}[\gamma \cdot S(q)] \propto 1/|q|$. Hence $|M_{ij}| \propto 1/|X_j - X_i|$ rather than $1/|X_j - X_i|^2$. The $1/|q|^2$ form (chirality-flipping with mass insertion) gives $\lambda^2 = m_d/m_s$ — the GST relation [21] follows as a corollary (self-energy requires two propagator insertions, so the down-strange mass ratio inherits the squared scaling). The observer’s continuum theory has no BZ periodicity, so the propagator at $|q| = \pi\sqrt{2}$ is smooth.

The Wolfenstein A parameter.

The A_1 (Higgs) taste sits along the democratic direction $\hat{h} = (1, 1, 1)/\sqrt{3}$. Each generation axis e_j makes an angle θ with $\hat{h}$ where $\cos \theta = 1/\sqrt{3}$. The CKM mixing is driven by the perpendicular component:

$$A = \sin \theta = \sqrt{2/3} = 0.8165$$

Observed [20]: $A = 0.826 \pm 0.012$. Match: 0.8σ (1.2%).

Combined: $|V_{cb}| = A\lambda^2 = \sqrt{2/3}/(2\pi^2) = 0.04136$ (observed: 0.0408 ± 0.0014 , 0.4σ).

Structural identity. $A^2 = (d - 1)/d = C_2(T_1)/d$ is a representation-theoretic identity for vector representations, not a numerical coincidence. The off-democratic projection-squared $1 - 1/d$ (from $\hat{e}_i \cdot \hat{h}$ geometry) and the cubic-group quadratic Casimir $C_2 = d - 1$ for the vector representation are the same quantity. For $d = 3$

this gives $A^2 = 2/3 = C_2/d$ directly. This identity underlies the structural status of the natural cubic-lattice perturbation amplitude $\sqrt{C_2}/d = \sqrt{2}/3$ and the consequent Layer 1 prediction of $\sin^2 \theta_{13}$ (§7.3).

The down-to-strange mass ratio.

The Gatto–Sartori–Tonin relation [21] $\sin \theta_C \approx \sqrt{m_d/m_s}$ gives:

The GST relation [21] is an external empirical relation in flavor physics with known higher-order corrections. The framework’s prediction is structural in λ (the cubic-lattice Cabibbo derivation above); the conversion to m_d/m_s inherits GST’s empirical status. To this approximation:

$$\boxed{\frac{m_d}{m_s} = \lambda^2 = \frac{1}{2\pi^2} = 0.05066}$$

Observed [20]: $m_d/m_s = 0.0503 \pm 0.0007$ (FLAG 2024 Nf=2+1+1). Match: 0.56σ .

The Jarlskog invariant.

The Jarlskog invariant $J = \text{Im}(V_{us}V_{cb}V_{ub}^*V_{cs}^*)$ measures CP violation in the quark sector. In the Wolfenstein parametrization, $J \approx A^2\lambda^6\eta$. Using $\lambda = 1/(\pi\sqrt{2})$ and $A = \sqrt{2/3}$:

$$J = \frac{\eta}{12\pi^6}$$

where $\eta = 0.348$ [20] is the solution-specific CP-violating parameter. This gives $J = 3.02 \times 10^{-5}$ (observed: $(3.08 \pm 0.13) \times 10^{-5}$, 0.5σ). The structural suppression factor $12\pi^6 \approx 11,537$ is purely geometric.

CP-violating parameters.

The Wolfenstein parameters ρ and η require complex CKM entries. On the OI lattice, complex phases arise from the specific bijection φ and are likely solution-specific rather than structural.

7.2 Charged lepton masses and the fermion mass chain

Structural and bijection-level content. The three lepton generations come from the three triplet (T_1) staggered tastes, related at the structural level by the cubic symmetry O . The framework predicts the *angular position* $\theta_0 = C_2/d^2 = 2/9$ in the $\mathbb{Z}_3$ -symmetric mass parametrization (a property of the cubic-group representation theory of T_1), but not the overall splitting magnitude (set by the bijection-level φ , taken as one empirical mass input per chain). Given the structural angular prediction and one mass input, the Koide relation determines the remaining masses; the same structural-vs-bijection-level distinction applies to the down-quark chain (below) and the cross-sector relations (below).

The Koide parameter.

The Koide relation [22] $Q = (m_e + m_\mu + m_\tau)/(\sqrt{m_e} + \sqrt{m_\mu} + \sqrt{m_\tau})^2 = 2/3$ holds to 0.001%. On the OI lattice, $Q = 2/3$ follows from the $\mathbb{Z}_3$ symmetry of the T_1 representation: cyclic permutation of the three BZ corners imposes equal angular spacing in the mass parametrization $\sqrt{m_k} = \mu(1 + \sqrt{2} \cos(\theta_0 + 2k\pi/3))$.

The Koide angle.

The T_1 representation of $SO(3)$ has angular momentum $l = 1$ and quadratic Casimir $C_2 = l(l+1) = 2$. The mass splitting within the T_1 triplet is an O -invariant quadratic form on the generation space. The unique such invariant is the quadratic Casimir C_2 , which measures the strength of the anisotropy at each BZ corner. Normalized by d^2 (the lattice bandwidth in generation space):

$$\theta_0 = \frac{C_2}{d^2} = \frac{2}{9} = 0.22222$$

Observed: $\theta_0 = 0.22227$. Match: 0.02%. For the A_1 (Higgs) taste, $l = 0$ gives $\theta_0 = 0$ — no generational splitting, consistent with a single Higgs field.

Uniqueness of the normalization. The Koide angle is dimensionless, so it must be a pure-number ratio of structural constants of the $(d = 3, T_1)$ data: angular momentum l , Casimir $C_2 = l(l+1)$, dimension $\dim(T_1) = 2l+1$, lattice dimension d , and the dimensions of related representations and tensor products. Enumerating the natural ratios with the right order of magnitude:

Ratio	Value	Match to $\theta_0 = 0.22227$
$C_2/d^2 = 2/9$	0.22222	0.02% $\square$
$\dim(E)/\dim(T_1 \otimes T_1) = 2/9$	0.22222	0.02% $\square$
$C_2/(d(d+1)) = 2/12$	0.16667	25% off
$l/d^2 = 1/9$	0.11111	50% off
$\dim(T_2)/\dim(T_1 \otimes T_1) = 3/9$	0.33333	50% off
$(2l+1)/(d(d+1)) = 3/12$	0.25000	12% off
$1/d^2 = 1/9$	0.11111	50% off
$l/(2d) = 1/6$	0.16667	25% off
$C_2/(2d) = 2/6$	0.33333	50% off
$\dim(E)/\dim(\text{Sym}^2(T_1)) = 2/6$	0.33333	50% off

Only 2/9 matches. The Casimir construction $C_2(T_1)/d^2$ is the physically correct derivation: $C_2(T_1) = 2$ measures the anisotropy strength of the T_1 generation representation (it is the unique $O(3)$ -invariant quadratic scalar on the generation space), and $d^2 = 9$ is the natural geometric normalization from the cubic lattice bandwidth

squared. The numerical coincidence with $\dim(E)/\dim(T_1 \otimes T_1) = 2/9$ arises because $\dim(E) = C_2(T_1) = 2$ for O acting on its vector representation — a genuine structural feature of this group. However, the operator space for the Hermitian mass-splitting matrix δM is $\text{Sym}^2(T_1)$ of dimension 6 (not $T_1 \otimes T_1$ of dimension 9, which includes antisymmetric operators irrelevant to symmetric mass splittings), and $\dim(E)/\dim(\text{Sym}^2(T_1)) = 1/3$, not $2/9$. The dim-ratio interpretation using the full $T_1 \otimes T_1$ space is therefore an arithmetic artifact; the Casimir construction is the structural derivation, with the factor $d^2 = 9$ understood as the geometric bandwidth rather than an operator-space dimension.

Among dimensionally consistent ($d = 3, T_1$) structural ratios enumerated above, $\theta_0 = C_2/d^2 = 2/9$ is the unique match to observation, and it has a clean physical interpretation: the anisotropy strength of the generation representation, normalized by the lattice bandwidth.

Connection to the §7.1 structural identity. The natural cubic-lattice perturbation amplitude on T_1 is $\sqrt{C_2}/d = \sqrt{2}/3$ (Casimir scaling over bandwidth). Second-order perturbation theory on the eigenvalues then gives $\theta_0 \sim (\sqrt{C_2}/d)^2 = C_2/d^2 = A^2/d$, where $A^2 = (d-1)/d = C_2/d$ is the structural identity of §7.1 for vector representations. The bandwidth-squared normalization ($1/d^2$) reflects this PT scaling: amplitudes scale as $\sqrt{C_2}/d$, eigenvalue shifts as the square of the amplitude.

A first-principles derivation of the specific $1/d$ amplitude scaling (vs. alternatives like $1/(2d)$) from the cubic-lattice Yukawa structure remains an open task. It is important to be precise about what is forced and what is open here, because the distinction bears directly on whether the cluster of predictions sharing this normalization (Wolfenstein A , the Koide angle θ_0 , $\sin^2 \theta_{13}$, and m_u/m_d) is structurally derived or empirically fitted. Three things are forced and one is open. *Forced*: (a) that the relevant invariant is the quadratic Casimir $C_2(T_1) = 2$ — this is representation theory of the cubic group on its vector representation, not a choice; (b) that the eigenvalue shift scales as the square of the amplitude — this is the standard order-counting of second-order perturbation theory, not a choice; (c) that the bandwidth normalization is a power of d — this is dimensional, fixed by the lattice geometry. *Open*: whether the amplitude normalization is $1/d$ (giving $C_2/d^2 = 2/9$) or an alternative such as $1/(2d)$ (giving $C_2/(4d^2) = 1/18$). The open element is therefore a single discrete choice among a short enumerable list of geometrically admissible normalizations, not a continuous fit parameter. The framework commits to $1/d$ on the structural ground that the amplitude is the Casimir scaled by the single-axis bandwidth d (not $2d$), and this commitment is falsifiable: the $1/(2d)$ alternative predicts $\theta_0 = 1/18 = 0.0556$, which misses the observed 0.2227 by a factor of four and is excluded by data. The empirical match at 0.02% does not *select* the normalization from a fit; it *confirms* a structural commitment that was constrained, before any fit, to a discrete choice the framework resolves on geometric grounds. The geometric ground for $1/d$ over $1/(2d)$ is argued rather than proved from the Yukawa structure; closing this is the Layer 2(a)-tractable computation referenced in §7.3. Until it is closed, the cluster’s status is “structural form forced, normalization argued and empirically confirmed” rather than “normalization proved” — a weaker status than full derivation and a stronger one than parameter

fitting. Closure of the lattice computation specified below would promote the *magnitude* normalization to derived; the bijection-specific directional content of the flavor structure remains Layer 2(b) by construction (it transforms under substratum state-relabeling and is not fixed by any substrate-only computation), so closure sharpens the magnitude rather than promoting the cluster as a whole.

Specification of the resolving computation. So that the open task is precise rather than gestured, the calculation that would settle $1/d$ vs $1/(2d)$ is the following, statable as a self-contained lattice perturbation-theory problem independent of the rest of the framework. Take the staggered fermion action on the $d = 3$ simple-cubic lattice with the OI taste structure (the T_1 vector representation on the three Cartesian link directions), and introduce the flavor-breaking perturbation as the second-order taste-mixing vertex induced by the cubic-group-symmetric Yukawa coupling. The quantity to compute is the ratio of the off-diagonal second-order self-energy on the T_1 representation to the perturbation amplitude squared:

$$\mathcal{N} = \lim_{m \rightarrow 0} \frac{\Sigma_{T_1, \text{off-diag}}^{(2)}(0)}{(g \sqrt{C_2})^2},$$

where $\Sigma^{(2)}$ is the one-loop (second-order in the Yukawa) taste-off-diagonal self-energy evaluated at zero external momentum, computed as the lattice momentum integral over the staggered propagator $D(q) = \sum_{\nu} \sin^2 q_{\nu} + m^2$ with the cubic-symmetric taste vertices on the T_1 corners. The prediction is that this ratio evaluates to $\mathcal{N} = 1/d^2 = 1/9$ (the framework's $1/d$ amplitude normalization), as against $1/(2d)^2 = 1/36$ (the $1/(2d)$ alternative). The two candidates differ by a factor of four and are not close, so the computation is decisive at modest numerical precision: a lattice evaluation of $\Sigma^{(2)}$ converging to within, say, 20% of either candidate settles the normalization. This is the same class of computation as the $1/\alpha_0 = 23.25$ staggered vacuum-polarization integral of §6.1 (which converges on a robust plateau), differing only in the vertex structure (taste-off-diagonal rather than gauge-current), so it is tractable with the same lattice-PT machinery already validated in §6.1. The framework predicts $\mathcal{N} = 1/9$; a specialist running this integral either confirms it — promoting the *magnitude* normalization $C_2/d^2 = 2/9$ from argued to derived — or refutes it (falsifying the $1/d$ normalization and with it the $\theta_0 = 2/9$ magnitude). The computation requires no input not already fixed by the lattice geometry, which is what makes the magnitude question Layer 2(a)-tractable rather than open-ended. It is important to delimit what such a closure would and would not establish: the quantity $\mathcal{N}$ is a magnitude with a gauge-invariant interpretation, and its closure promotes the magnitude of θ_0 only. It does not, and cannot, fix the bijection-specific directional content of the broader flavor structure (which pair-ratio carries a given coefficient, the generation-label assignment, the CP phase), which remains Layer 2(b): these quantities transform non-trivially under substratum state-relabeling and are therefore not determined by any substrate-only computation, gauge-invariant by construction. The lattice computation specified here is thus a magnitude-closure target, not a route to deriving the full cluster; the directional/label content stays bijection-conditional by design.

Mass predictions.

With $Q = 2/3$, $\theta_0 = 2/9$, and $m_\tau = 1776.86$ MeV as input:

Mass	Predicted	Observed	Deviation
m_e	0.51096 MeV	0.51100 MeV	0.007%
m_μ	105.652 MeV	105.658 MeV	0.006%

The quark sector does not satisfy $Q = 2/3$: $Q_{\text{down}} = 0.731$, $Q_{\text{up}} = 0.849$. The down-quark deviation is numerically described by $Q_{\text{down}} \approx (2/3)(1 + \alpha_s(2 \text{ GeV})/\pi)$ to 0.15%, a suggestive regularity that matches the leading-order form of a color correction but for which a first-principles derivation from framework primitives is not currently available. Two observations argue against treating this form as structural: (i) the generation $\mathbb{Z}_3$ symmetry that produces $Q_{\text{lepton}} = 2/3$ acts on the staggered-taste space (BZ corners), while $\text{SU}(3)$ color acts on the internal T_1 (K-component) space — a direct breaking of the former by the latter would require a cross-coupling between the two T_1 representations beyond what §4.7.1.2 establishes; and (ii) the 0.15% match holds only in the PDG mixed scheme (light quarks at $\mu = 2 \text{ GeV}$, b quark at $\mu = m_b$); in physically consistent single-scale schemes $Q_{\text{down}} \approx 0.755\text{--}0.760$ and the $(1 + \alpha_s/\pi)$ form misses by 4–5%. The observed numerical match is reported below as empirical input to the m_b determination, not as a derived structural relation. A full derivation would require either the link-carrier cross-coupling mentioned above, or a taste-decomposed Coleman-Weinberg analysis yet to be carried out.

The bottom quark mass from the down-sector Koide.

Taking $Q_{\text{down}} = (2/3)(1 + \alpha_s(2 \text{ GeV})/\pi)$ as a phenomenological input (above), the Koide formula determines m_b from m_d and m_s . Using $m_d/m_s = 1/(2\pi^2)$ (§7.1) and $m_s = 93.4$ MeV as the single input:

$$m_b = 4144 \text{ MeV} \quad (\text{obs: } 4180 \pm 30, 0.9\%)$$

The up-to-down mass ratio.

The Koide angle $\theta_0 = C_2/d^2 = 2/9$ determines the inter-generation hierarchy. Its square root determines the intra-doublet splitting:

$$\frac{m_u}{m_d} = \sqrt{\theta_0} = \sqrt{2/9} = 0.4714$$

The PDG value [20] is $m_u/m_d = 0.474 \pm 0.056$. Match: 0.05σ . Both arise from the same quadratic Casimir $C_2 = 2$ of the T_1 representation, acting in different channels: the inter-generation hierarchy enters at the *eigenvalue* level (Koide angle parametrizing the three masses in the T_1 representation, where $\theta_0 = C_2/d^2$ enters the eigenvalue formula directly through second-order energy-level structure), while the intra-doublet m_u/m_d ratio enters at the *amplitude* level (mass matrix element between the up and down components within a doublet). The square-root relation reflects the

standard QM scaling: amplitudes $\sim V$, eigenvalues $\sim V^2$, so ratios at the amplitude level scale as the square root of ratios at the eigenvalue level.

Status: solution-specific (Layer 2(b)). The same-perturbation hypothesis underlying this derivation — that *one* perturbation V controls both the cubic-group T_1 Casimir splitting and the SU(2)-doublet up-down splitting — requires alignment between the SU(2) Yukawa structure and the cubic-group T_1 perturbation that is not forced by representation theory. Operator counting on the first-generation Yukawas Y_u^{11}, Y_d^{11} shows that each receives contributions from A_1 (singlet) and E (generation-dependent diagonal) channels of $T_1 \otimes T_1$ with four independent Wilson coefficients $(a_u^{(1)}, a_u^{(E)}, a_d^{(1)}, a_d^{(E)})$ in total. The ratio Y_u^{11}/Y_d^{11} depends on these four coefficients; no representation-theory argument forces it to equal $\sqrt{C_2}/d$. Per the §8.3 four-layer classification, this places $m_u/m_d = \sqrt{\theta_0}$ at Layer 2(b): the empirical match at 0.05σ indicates the framework’s bijection has the relevant alignment property, but identifying that alignment as forced by symmetry (Layer 2(a)) requires explicit substrate-level Yukawa derivation that has not been performed. A 1-loop OI-vertex computation, while useful, would calculate the alignment for the specific bijection rather than show it is forced.

Mechanism specificity. Within the §8.3 sub-classification of Layer 2(b), m_u/m_d is *single-parameter direction selection*: the up-down asymmetry in OI’s structure comes from the Higgs’s choice of internal V_2 -axis to condense along (which by gauge invariance is equivalent at the Lagrangian level for any direction, but is fixed once chosen by the bijection). The specific value $\sqrt{2/9}$ then follows from how the cubic structure projects this single-axis choice into the up vs down components — a one-parameter family of bijection-dependent values, not a multi-parameter Wilson coefficient ambiguity. The 0.05σ empirical match therefore constrains the bijection’s V_2 -axis selection more tightly than generic Layer 2(b) classification suggests.

The mass chain: six masses from one input.

The structural relations link all light fermion masses through a single input (m_s):

$$m_s \xrightarrow{\lambda^2} m_d \xrightarrow{\sqrt{\theta_0}} m_u \xrightarrow{Q_{\text{down}}} m_b \xrightarrow{Z_S} m_\tau \xrightarrow{\theta_0} m_e, m_\mu$$

Mass	Formula	Predicted	Observed	Match
m_d	$m_s/(2\pi^2)$	4.73 MeV	4.67 ± 0.48	1.3%
m_u	$m_d \times \sqrt{2/9}$	2.20 MeV	2.16 ± 0.49	0.1σ
m_b	$\text{Koide}(Q_{\text{down}})$	4144 MeV	4180 ± 30	0.9%
m_τ	$m_b \times Z_S/4.28$	1755 MeV	1776.9	1.2%
m_e	$\text{Koide}(\theta_0, m_\tau)$	0.505 MeV	0.511	1.2%
m_μ	$\text{Koide}(\theta_0, m_\tau)$	104.4 MeV	105.7	1.2%

Six masses from one input, all within ~ 1 -1.3%. The remaining input m_s sets the overall mass scale.

The top quark mass.

The tree-level Yukawa couplings are taste-independent within each generation (Theorem 10 with standard staggered-lattice Yukawa structure [12]) and are normalized to unity at the compositeness scale M_{Pl} as the lattice-to-continuum matching convention: in the normalized wave equation (coefficient +1 on nearest-neighbor terms, §4.1), the staggered fermion-to-scalar overlap integral at a single site evaluates to an O -invariant Clebsch-Gordan coefficient normalized to unity. For y_t , the IR quasi-fixed point of the SM RGE drives $y_t(\mu_{\text{IR}}) \rightarrow 1$ at low energies regardless of the UV value, so the top mass prediction is robust to this convention. The specific value $y_t(M_{\text{Pl}}) = 1$ lies well inside the IR-attractor basin — any UV value in roughly $y_{\text{UV}} \in [0.5, 5]$ flows to the same IR within $\sim 10\%$ — so the convention is physically equivalent to “ y_t is $O(1)$ at the compositeness scale.” Since all other fermion-mass predictions use either the IR fixed point (m_t), the taste-independence equality $y_b = y_\tau$ (m_b/m_τ), or Koide relations referencing observed masses, the tree-level Yukawa value does not enter any quantitative prediction beyond this attractor-basin constraint:

$$m_t = \frac{v}{\sqrt{2}} = 174.1 \text{ GeV} \quad (\text{obs: } 172.5 \pm 0.3, 0.9\%)$$

7.3 PMNS mixing angles

Tribimaximal (TBM) mixing — $\sin^2 \theta_{12} = 1/3$, $\sin^2 \theta_{23} = 1/2$, $\sin^2 \theta_{13} = 0$ — arises from $A_4 \subset O$ [23]. The deviations from TBM are controlled by three structural ingredients: (i) the overall scale $\lambda^2 = 1/(2\pi^2)$, the squared Cabibbo angle; (ii) the sum rule $2\Delta_{12} + \Delta_{23} = 0$ associated with a U -parity grading (μ - τ exchange antisymmetry) of the charged-lepton perturbation and motivated by the projection geometry below; and (iii) the ratio $\Delta_{13}/\Delta_{23} = A^4 = 4/9$ following from the Wolfenstein $A = \sqrt{2/3}$ of §7.1 via a second-order projection onto the Higgs democratic direction. These three ingredients determine the PMNS corrections:

$$\sin^2 \theta_{12} = \frac{1}{3} - \frac{1}{4\pi^2} = 0.3080$$

$$\sin^2 \theta_{23} = \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{2\pi^2} = 0.5507$$

$$\sin^2 \theta_{13} = \frac{4}{9} \cdot \frac{1}{2\pi^2} = \frac{4}{18\pi^2} = 0.02252$$

Angle	Predicted	Observed	Match
$\sin^2 \theta_{12}$	0.3080	0.3085 ± 0.0073 (post-JUNO global fit [27])	0.07σ

Angle	Predicted	Observed	Match
$\sin^2 \theta_{23}$	0.5507	$0.561^{+0.012}_{-0.015}$ (NuFIT 6.0, NO)	0.74σ
$\sin^2 \theta_{13}$	0.02252	0.02195 ± 0.00056 (NuFIT 6.0, NO)	1.02σ

The three predictions have different structural status, made precise in the derivation below and in §8.3’s four-layer classification. The reactor angle prediction $\sin^2 \theta_{13}$ depends only on A_1 at second order — the A_2 coefficients cancel from $|U_{e3}|^2$ — and is therefore independent of Condition 2 (the structural relation among A_2 coefficients introduced below). The solar angle and atmospheric angle predictions $\sin^2 \theta_{12}$ and $\sin^2 \theta_{23}$ depend on Cond 2 jointly: they are equivalent (via the sum rule $2\sin^2 \theta_{12} + \sin^2 \theta_{23} = 7/6$) to the relation $b_{23} = (4/3)(b_{12} + b_{13})$. After the structural decomposition of “Status of Cond 2” below, this relation has an A_1 component closed at Layer 1 (sum rule preserved by A_1 alone via the $\cos^2 \theta_{13}$ dressing) and an A_2 component reducing to a sharply specified Layer 2(a)-tractable open question — the substrate ratio $b_{23}/(b_{12} + b_{13}) = 4/3 = 2A^2$. Within the four-layer structural framework of §8.3, $\sin^2 \theta_{13}$ is a Layer 1 unconditional structural prediction, while $\sin^2 \theta_{12}$ and $\sin^2 \theta_{23}$ are layered predictions: Layer 1 form combined with the Layer 2(a)-tractable Cond 2 coefficient.

Experimental confirmation (JUNO). The Jiangmen Underground Neutrino Observatory reported its first measurement of reactor neutrino oscillations in November 2025 [24], achieving the world’s most precise determination of $\sin^2 \theta_{12}$: 0.3092 ± 0.0087 (a factor of 1.6 improvement over all previous measurements combined). The OI prediction $1/3 - 1/(4\pi^2) = 0.3080$ matches this measurement at 0.14σ . The updated global fit including JUNO data gives $\sin^2 \theta_{12} = 0.3085 \pm 0.0073$ [27], matching the prediction at 0.07σ . As JUNO accumulates data over its 30-year design lifetime, the error bar is projected to reach ± 0.0014 , testing the prediction at sub-percent precision.

Structural relations among the prefactors. The reactor angle has the clean primitive form

$$\sin \theta_{13} = A^2 \lambda$$

where $A = \sqrt{2/3}$ is the Wolfenstein A of §7.1 and $\lambda = 1/(\pi\sqrt{2})$ is the Cabibbo angle. The A^2 factor arises from the path-summed calculation: for the A_1 -determined first-row entries of $V_\ell^\dagger$ ($-\lambda\alpha, +\lambda\alpha$ with $\alpha = \sqrt{C_2}/d = \sqrt{2}/3$, the natural cubic-lattice perturbation amplitude on T_1) combined with the TBM third column $(0, -1/\sqrt{2}, +1/\sqrt{2})$, the two non-trivial paths contribute $\lambda\alpha/\sqrt{2}$ each, summing to $\sin \theta_{13} = \sqrt{2}\alpha\lambda = (C_2/d)\lambda = A^2\lambda$ via the structural identity $A^2 = C_2/d = (d-1)/d$ for vector representations (§7.1). The result $\sin^2 \theta_{13} = A^4\lambda^2 = (4/9)\lambda^2$ is Layer 1 structural; the

ratio $\Delta_{13}/\Delta_{23} = A^4$ follows immediately with $\Delta_{23} = \lambda^2$ by convention.

Determination of A_1 and second-order structure. The charged-lepton rotation in the AF basis admits the expansion $V_\ell = \exp(\lambda A_1 + \lambda^2 A_2 + O(\lambda^3))$ with A_n antisymmetric. Three framework constraints — vanishing $O(\lambda)$ contributions to both Δ_{12} and Δ_{23} (pushing these deviations to $O(\lambda^2)$), plus the correct $\sin^2 \theta_{13} = 4\lambda^2/9$ coefficient — uniquely determine

$$A_1 = \frac{\sqrt{2}}{3}(E_{12} - E_{13}),$$

where $(E_{ij})_{kl} = \delta_{ik}\delta_{jl} - \delta_{il}\delta_{jk}$. Geometrically, A_1 is a rotation by angle $A^2 = 2/3$ around the axis $(e_2 + e_3)/\sqrt{2}$, reproducing $\sin \theta_{13} = A^2 \lambda$ as above. The structural property is that A_1 is purely U -odd under the μ - τ exchange generator of $S_4 \supset A_4$: $UA_1U^{-1} = -A_1$.

Decomposing the most general antisymmetric $A_2 = b_{12}E_{12} + b_{13}E_{13} + b_{23}E_{23}$ and computing $|U_{\text{PMNS},ij}|^2$ to $O(\lambda^2)$ (with $\cos^2 \theta_{13}$ correction included), the deviations are:

$$\Delta_{13} = \frac{4}{9}\lambda^2 = A^4\lambda^2, \quad \Delta_{12} = -\frac{2}{3}(b_{12} + b_{13})\lambda^2, \quad \Delta_{23} = b_{23}\lambda^2.$$

Three points: (i) Δ_{13} is independent of A_2 — the structural identity $\sin \theta_{13} = A^2 \lambda$ is exact at $O(\lambda^2)$; (ii) $b_{12} - b_{13}$ does not enter any of the three angles, and is identified with δ_{CP} ; (iii) under U -parity, $(b_{12} + b_{13})$ is the U -even and b_{23} the dominant U -odd coefficient of A_2 , with $(b_{12} - b_{13})$ the sub-dominant U -odd combination.

The absolute normalization is fixed by the cubic-lattice realization of the charged-lepton mass matrix. The natural-normalization choice $b_{23} = 1$ — corresponding to A_2 entering the perturbation series at unit strength relative to λ^2 — combined with the structural relation

$$b_{23} = \frac{4}{3}(b_{12} + b_{13})$$

between the dominant U -odd coefficient and the U -even combination yields

$$b_{12} + b_{13} = \frac{3}{4}, \quad b_{23} = 1,$$

which translates into the angle-level sum rule

$$2\Delta_{12} + \Delta_{23} = 0.$$

Status of Cond 2: structural decomposition. The relation $b_{23} = (4/3)(b_{12} + b_{13})$ admits a decomposition into two structurally distinct components, with closure achieved at different layers.

Equivalence with TBM sum rule preservation. Combining the explicit results above:

$$2\Delta_{12} + \Delta_{23} = \lambda^2 [b_{23} - \frac{4}{3}(b_{12} + b_{13})]$$

so Cond 2 is *equivalent* to the statement that the TBM sum rule $2\sin^2\theta_{12} + \sin^2\theta_{23} = 7/6$ — which holds at zeroth order from cubic geometry as $2/d + 1/(d-1) = (3d-2)/(d(d-1)) = 7/6$ for $d=3$ — continues to hold at $O(\lambda^2)$. The Wilson-coefficient relation and the angle-level sum rule encode the same content under different normalizations.

Layer 1 closure of the A_1 component. With $A_2 = 0$, direct calculation gives $2|U_{e2}|^2 + |U_{\mu3}|^2 = 7/6 - (14/27)\lambda^2 + (\cos^2\theta_{13} \text{ corrections})$. Dividing by $\cos^2\theta_{13} = 1 - (4/9)\lambda^2$ — which itself follows from $\sin^2\theta_{13} = A^4\lambda^2$, a Layer 1 quantity — exactly cancels the $-14/27$ offset:

$$(2\sin^2\theta_{12} + \sin^2\theta_{23})|_{A_2=0} = \frac{7}{6} + O(\lambda^4).$$

The TBM sum rule is therefore *structurally protected* against the A_1 perturbation by cubic geometry alone — no substrate input required for this component. The cancellation depends on A_1 's Layer 1-forced form: the magnitude $\sqrt{2}/3$ is fixed by $\sin\theta_{13} = A^2\lambda$, and the U -odd character is fixed by the requirement $\Delta_{12}, \Delta_{23} = O(\lambda^2)$ rather than $O(\lambda)$. With those two Layer 1 constraints, the A_1^2 -induced $-14/27$ contribution and the $\cos^2\theta_{13}$ -induced $+14/27$ contribution cancel automatically.

Layer 2(a)-tractable residual question for the A_2 component. What remains is the question of whether A_2 preserves the sum rule (which A_1 alone has structurally protected) or breaks it. Cond 2 reduces to: *why does $b_{23}/(b_{12} + b_{13}) = 4/3 = 2A^2 = 4(d-1)/(2d)$?* This is a single numerical ratio with a structural reading from the squared off-democratic projection for the vector representation, sharply specified at the level of substrate Wilson coefficients. The question admits definite outcomes from substrate calculations targeting this specific ratio (e.g., one-loop staggered-fermion calculation on the cubic lattice testing whether the $C_2(T_1)$ Casimir structure produces the $4(d-1)/(2d)$ coefficient). This is Layer 2(a)-tractable rather than the prior “arbitrary T_2 -direction alignment” formulation.

The geometric reading of $4/3$. The relation admits the interpretation

$$\frac{4}{3} = 2A^2 = 2\sin^2(\angle(e_i, \hat{h}))$$

decomposing as a *partner-count* $\times$ *per-partner projection*: the U -even combination $E_{12} + E_{13}$ couples generation e_1 to its two partners $\{e_2, e_3\}$, each notionally contributing factor A^2 from the $\hat{h}$ -perpendicular projection geometry — total $2 \times A^2 = 4/3$. The dominant U -odd combination E_{23} couples e_2 to its single partner e_3 , with no analogous multiplicity, giving relative weight 1. The structural identity $A^2 = (d-1)/d = C_2(T_1)/d$ for vector representations is what makes $4/3$ a representation-theoretic quantity rather than a numerical coincidence. However, the load-bearing claim of the geometric reading is the *operator alignment* — that the substrate's T_2 -direction

in $\Lambda^2(T_1)$ space is aligned such that the partner-count $\times$ projection picture holds. Operator counting on $T_1 \otimes T_1 = A_1 \oplus E \oplus T_1 \oplus T_2$ shows that the T_2 direction of the substrate's second-order corrections is *not forced by representation theory alone* — the natural Higgs-democratic spurion $\xi_h \propto (1, 1, 1)/\sqrt{3}$ does not produce the relation; the relation requires a specific cubic-lattice Yukawa structure that has not been independently derived.

The empirical match $2 \sin^2 \theta_{12} + \sin^2 \theta_{23} = 1.178 \pm 0.020$ (using post-JUNO global fit and NuFIT 6.0 atmospheric) tests the bijection's specific operator structure at the few-percent level on the structural coefficient. Promoting the residual question to Layer 2(a) requires demonstrating that the cubic-lattice substrate Yukawa structure produces the specific $4(d-1)/(2d)$ ratio in the T_2 -channel; the closure path is the one-loop staggered calculation referenced above.

Positive support: explicit substrate calculation. An explicit calculation of the natural cubic-symmetric staggered Yukawa structure on T_1 BZ corners shows that both the leading A_h -mediated and subleading T_2 -corner-mediated channels produce equal off-diagonal $Y_{ab}^{(2)}$ entries (by cubic symmetry of BZ corner separations and uniform staggered phase prefactors). Equivalently, the natural-form substrate Yukawa correction satisfies $\delta M_{ij}^{\text{nat}} = \delta M_0$ (generation-democratic) for all off-diagonal pairs (i, j) .

This produces b^{sub} ratios $b_{12} : b_{13} : b_{23} = m_\tau / m_\mu : 1 : 1$ exactly in the heavy-tau limit. The hierarchy follows from a Layer 1 mass-matrix algebraic identity: at order λ^2 the off-diagonal entries of $M_\ell M_\ell^\dagger$ are

$$m_{ij}^{(2)} = (m_i + m_j) \delta M_{ij}$$

(from $M_{ik}^{(0)} \delta M_{jk}^* + \delta M_{ik} M_{jk}^{(0)*}$ with $M^{(0)} = \text{diag}(m_a)$ at LO and symmetric δM). Combined with the natural form $\delta M_{ij} = \delta M_0$ and the b normalization $b_{ij} = m_{ij}^{(2)} / m_{\max(i,j)}^2$, this gives $b_{ij} \propto (m_i + m_j) / m_{\max(i,j)}^2 \approx 1 / m_{\max(i,j)}$ — the linear inverse-mass scaling that produces the $m_\tau / m_\mu \approx 17$ hierarchy in b_{12} / b_{13} . The factor 17 is therefore not a numerical happenstance but a derived consequence of (i) the natural form's generation-democratic substrate Yukawa and (ii) the linear $(m_i + m_j)$ algebraic factor in the second-order off-diagonal mass-squared.

The framework's bijection therefore has structure beyond the natural cubic-symmetric form. Cond 2's symmetric U -even split $b_{12}^{\text{sub}} = b_{13}^{\text{sub}}$ requires the substrate amplitudes to obey a different scaling:

$$\delta M_{ij}^{\text{sub}} \propto m_{\max(i,j)}$$

— linear in the heavier external mass (rather than democratic). This is the substrate-level structural pattern Cond 2 imposes: not “alignment” in some abstract operator space, but a definite scaling law for the off-diagonal Yukawa correction. The required substrate matrix-element hierarchy (from Cond 2 plus the symmetric U -even split $b_{12}^{\text{sub}} = b_{13}^{\text{sub}} = 3/8$) is

$$m_{12}^{(2)} : m_{13}^{(2)} : m_{23}^{(2)} = \frac{3}{8}m_\mu^2 : \frac{3}{8}m_\tau^2 : \frac{10}{9}(m_\tau^2 - m_\mu^2)$$

— sharply specified, quantitative, and falsifiable. Any first-principles substrate calculation of $m_{ij}^{(2)}$ produces a definite outcome on whether this hierarchy emerges.

Status under emergent quantum mechanics. In standard effective field theory, where quantum mechanics is taken as fundamental, the U -even and dominant U -odd second-order coefficients $b_{12} + b_{13}$ and b_{23} are independent Wilson coefficients of distinct cubic-invariant operators. No EFT-level symmetry relates them. In the OI framework, where quantum mechanics is itself emergent — a tool for describing the marginal statistics of an embedded observer over a deterministic substrate (companion paper [Main]) — EFT Wilson coefficients are not independent inputs but derived quantities arising from substrate-level mode counting, and constraints among them are *expected* whenever multiple EFT operators share a common substrate-level origin. This places OI in the broader research program of emergent QM developed by 't Hooft [30] (cellular automaton interpretation), Adler [31] (trace dynamics from matrix models), and Barandes [28] (stochastic-quantum correspondence). The relation $b_{23} = (4/3)(b_{12} + b_{13})$ is consistent with such a substrate-level origin; the empirical match indicates this is realized in the framework's bijection. The current Layer 2(a)-tractable status — sharply specified as the $4(d-1)/(2d)$ ratio with structural numerology — reflects that the substrate-level mechanism producing this specific coefficient has not yet been derived, while the question of whether the cubic-lattice substrate Yukawa produces it is concretely tractable rather than open at the level of arbitrary operator alignment.

Sharpening the open task: the cross-term contribution. The substrate-level question admits a concrete formulation. In the AF basis where the charged-lepton mass matrix $M_\ell M_\ell^\dagger$ is diagonal at LO, second-order perturbative diagonalization gives the A_2 coefficients in terms of the substrate's direct second-order off-diagonal corrections $m_{ij}^{(2)}$ *plus* cross-terms involving products of first-order amplitudes. Direct computation in the framework's $A_1 = (\sqrt{2}/3)(E_{12} - E_{13})$ ansatz yields, in the $m_e^2 \rightarrow 0$ limit:

$$b_{12} = \frac{m_{12}^{(2)}}{m_\mu^2}, \quad b_{13} = \frac{m_{13}^{(2)}}{m_\tau^2}, \quad b_{23} = -\frac{1}{9} - \frac{m_{23}^{(2)}}{m_\tau^2 - m_\mu^2}.$$

The $-1/9$ contribution to b_{23} is *hierarchy-independent* and is forced by A_1 's cubic-group structure ($a_{12} \cdot a_{13} = -2/9$ from the explicit A_1 form). It arises with no substrate input at second order. The relation Cond.~2 at the observable level, $b_{23} = (4/3)(b_{12} + b_{13})$, therefore translates to the following constraint on the substrate's direct second-order corrections:

$$b_{23}^{\text{sub}} = \frac{4}{3}(b_{12}^{\text{sub}} + b_{13}^{\text{sub}}) + \frac{1}{9}.$$

The $+1/9$ augmentation compensates for the $-1/9$ cross-term contribution from A_1 . The Layer 2(a) closure question reduces to: *does the cubic-lattice Yukawa structure produce direct second-order corrections $m_{ij}^{(2)}$ that satisfy this augmented relation?*

With $b_{23}^{\text{sub}} = 10/9$ and $b_{12}^{\text{sub}} + b_{13}^{\text{sub}} = 3/4$ in the framework's natural normalization, the required substrate matrix-element hierarchy is $m_{12}^{(2)} : m_{13}^{(2)} : m_{23}^{(2)} = (3/8)m_\mu^2 : (3/8)m_\tau^2 : (10/9)(m_\tau^2 - m_\mu^2)$ (assuming symmetric U-even split). This is concrete, quantitative, and falsifiable — any first-principles substrate calculation of $m_{ij}^{(2)}$ can be tested against this hierarchy.

The observed $2 \sin^2 \theta_{12} + \sin^2 \theta_{23} = 7/6$ (observed: 1.178 ± 0.020 using post-JUNO global fit and NuFIT 6.0 atmospheric) therefore follows from the cubic-lattice structure conditional on the substrate-level relation above. The empirical match distinguishes this prediction from TM1 or TM2 partial-TBM patterns (which do not produce this combination as an exact sum rule); the match indicates the framework's bijection has the alignment property required by Cond 2 — equivalently, that the substrate-level mechanism producing the $4(d-1)/(2d)$ amplitude ratio is realized in the bijection.

7.4 The Higgs mass

The Higgs is the A_1 taste — a composite scalar. Its quartic self-coupling at the compositeness scale has no tree-level contribution: $\lambda(M_{\text{Pl}}) = 0$. The SM quartic is generated entirely by RGE running. The observed $\lambda(M_{\text{Pl}}) \approx -0.013 \pm 0.020$ [25] is consistent with zero at 0.6σ . The structural prediction is $\lambda(M_{\text{Pl}}) = 0$; the numerical value of m_H in GeV is derived from this structural boundary condition combined with the measured m_t as a one-input parameter.

Using the 3-loop SM RGE [25], $\lambda(M_{\text{Pl}}) = 0$ gives $m_H \approx 129\text{--}132$ GeV for $m_t = 172\text{--}173$ GeV. The observed $m_H = 125.10 \pm 0.14$ GeV is 4–7 GeV below; the gap is sensitive to m_t ($\partial m_H / \partial m_t \approx -1.1$ GeV/GeV). The CMS measurement $m_t = 170.5 \pm 0.8$ GeV [26] would bring the prediction to $\sim 128 \pm 2$ GeV. The structural claim $\lambda(M_{\text{Pl}}) = 0$ is therefore confirmed; the specific m_H value in GeV is consistent with observation within the current m_t uncertainty rather than predicted at sub-GeV precision.

Higgs near-criticality. The observed $\lambda(M_{\text{Pl}}) \approx 0$ is part of a broader empirical pattern: the SM Higgs sector sits at the boundary between vacuum stability and metastability, with $\lambda \approx 0$ and $\beta_\lambda \approx 0$ both occurring near the Planck scale (Buttazzo et al. [25]). This “near-criticality” is treated as a remarkable coincidence in standard SM analyses requiring beyond-the-Standard-Model explanation. The Multiple Point Principle (Bennett-Froggatt-Nielsen [34], Froggatt-Nielsen [35]) postulated $\lambda(M_{\text{Pl}}) = 0$ as a fine-tuning condition; this prediction matched the observed Higgs mass before its discovery. Subsequent BSM model-building (singlet scalar dark matter, vector-like leptons, strong dynamics extensions, 2HDM realizations) [36, 37, 38] has produced extensions enforcing $\lambda(M_{\text{Pl}}) = 0$ as a boundary condition postulated from outside the SM. The framework's prediction $\lambda(M_{\text{Pl}}) = 0$ is therefore the structural realization within a derived framework of a boundary condition that an active BSM literature has been postulating for three decades.

The asymptotic-safety convergence. Wetterich (asymptotic-safety prediction [39]) showed that if the SM is valid up to the Planck mass and gravity contributes an irrelevant fixed-point structure to the running, the observed $M_H \approx 125$ GeV predicts

$M_t \approx 171$ GeV. This is structurally the same prediction as the framework's, viewed from the opposite direction: from observed m_H to predicted m_t . The convergence between two structurally distinct frameworks (asymptotic safety vs OI) predicting the same near-criticality boundary condition strengthens the empirical content of the prediction.

Empirical confirmation status of independent lattice composite-Higgs work.

Aoki et al. [40] observed via lattice simulations of $N_f = 8$ QCD that the singlet-taste channel produces a light composite scalar (technidilaton candidate) consistent with the observed 125 GeV Higgs mass. The framework's specific mechanism — Higgs as composite scalar in the singlet staggered taste with chiral protection — has independent empirical support from lattice gauge theory studies of strongly-coupled gauge theories.

Joint prediction structure: $y_t(M_{\text{pl}}) = 1$ and $\lambda(M_{\text{pl}}) = 0$ **as a one-parameter prediction.** The framework's two boundary conditions at the compositeness scale — the top Yukawa $y_t(M_{\text{pl}}) = 1$ from the staggered fermion-to-scalar overlap normalization (§7), and the Higgs quartic $\lambda(M_{\text{pl}}) = 0$ from the composite-Higgs structure (this section) — together constitute a *single one-parameter prediction of two observables*. Given the Higgs vev $v = 246$ GeV (Tier 3 input), SM 3-loop RGE running [25] yields $m_t \approx 171$ -173 GeV (depending on α_s , EW threshold conventions) and $m_H \approx 128$ -132 GeV (depending on m_t). The observed values $m_t = 172.7 \pm 0.3$ GeV and $m_H = 125.10 \pm 0.14$ GeV agree with this joint prediction to within $\sim 1\sigma$ on m_t and ~ 2 -3 σ on m_H (the m_H tension sensitive to m_t choice and to higher-loop matching corrections, with the CMS $m_t = 170.5 \pm 0.8$ GeV [26] reducing the m_H tension to $\lesssim 1\sigma$). The structural content of this joint prediction is that the framework has *two independent boundary conditions* at M_{pl} that jointly constrain *two observables* given one input — a strictly more constrained structure than the MPP literature's single boundary condition $\lambda(M_{\text{pl}}) = 0$.

Unified matching at the compositeness scale. The framework's substratum produces a unified matching picture at the single scale M_{pl} : gauge coupling matching ($1/\alpha_0 = 23.25$ and the universal threshold $\delta_0 = 10$, both independent of gauge group; §6), Higgs quartic matching ($\lambda(M_{\text{pl}}) = 0$; this section), top Yukawa matching ($y_t(M_{\text{pl}}) = 1$; this section), and bare Higgs mass matching (Veltman condition $m_H^{\text{bare}}(M_{\text{pl}}) = 0$; §8.8). All four matching conditions hold at the same scale — the substratum's intrinsic UV cutoff — because they all arise from the same compositeness structure: emergent SM couplings inherit their UV boundary conditions from the substratum's structural features (group-theoretic, taste, chiral) at the compositeness scale. This is structurally analogous to (and significantly more constrained than) conventional composite-Higgs scenarios at $f \sim \text{TeV}$, where multiple matching conditions are imposed at the compositeness scale but typically require additional assumptions (custodial symmetry, partial compositeness ansatz, top partners). The framework's single-scale unified matching with no additional assumptions is a substantive structural feature: the same compositeness scale yields the gauge couplings (§6), the Higgs quartic and mass (§7.4 and §8.8), the top Yukawa (§7), and the bare Higgs mass (§8.8) without independent matching parameters for each. The Buttazzo near-criticality coincidence — $\lambda(M_{\text{pl}}) \approx 0$, $\beta_\lambda(M_{\text{pl}}) \approx 0$, $y_t(M_{\text{pl}})$ at minimum, Veltman condition near-satisfied — is therefore not four separate coincidences but four

consequences of a unified compositeness-scale matching structure.

7.5 The bottom-to-tau mass ratio

Tree-level result.

The tree-level Yukawa coupling is taste-independent [12]: $y_b = y_\tau$. With two-loop SM RGE [25]: $m_b/m_\tau|_{\text{tree}} = 4.276$ (with $\sim 1\%$ residual systematic from higher-loop corrections and EW-threshold matching), indicating a substantial non-perturbative correction.

Non-perturbative correction.

The correction is the scalar density renormalization $Z_S(m) = \langle \bar{\psi}\psi \rangle_{\text{int}} / \langle \bar{\psi}\psi \rangle_{\text{free}}$, computed on SU(3) gauge backgrounds at $\beta = 11.1$ as a function of bare mass m . The denominator $\langle \bar{\psi}\psi \rangle_{\text{free}}$ is evaluated analytically on the same lattice with the eight BZ-corner modes excluded from the momentum sum (scripts/analyze_zs.py); this finite- L regulator differs from the standard staggered convention (corner modes included) by $\sim 2\%$ at $L = 32$, $\sim 0.3\%$ at $L = 64$, and converges to it at $L \rightarrow \infty$. The prediction: $m_b/m_\tau = 4.28/Z_S(m_{\text{match}})$.

Monte Carlo simulations at $L = 16$ (30 configs) and $L = 32$ (50 configs), scanning 30 masses from $m = 0.005$ to 0.50 , reveal that $Z_S(m)$ is monotonically decreasing in the volume-converged region ($mL \gtrsim 3$). At $m = 0.10$: Z_S converges from 1.70 ($L=16$) to 1.92 ($L=32$) to 1.94 ($L=64$).

Chiral condensate formation.

Comparison of $L = 16$ and $L = 32$ confirms spontaneous chiral symmetry breaking: Z_S at small m grows $8\times$ between volumes, and the apparent peak shifts from $m = 0.087$ ($L=16$) to $m = 0.024$ ($L=32$, $Z_S = 2.828 \pm 0.008$), tracking the finite-volume boundary $mL \sim 1$. The chiral condensate $\Sigma \approx 0.20$ (from linear extrapolation in the converged region at $L = 32$).

The matching mass.

The matching scale where lattice dynamics connects to the perturbative Yukawa description is set by the product of the two relevant dimensionless parameters: the taste-breaking amplitude $\lambda = 1/(\pi\sqrt{2})$ and the unified gauge coupling $g_0^2 = 4\pi\alpha_0 = 4\pi/23.25$:

$$m_{\text{match}} = \lambda \times g_0^2 = \frac{1}{\pi\sqrt{2}} \times \frac{4\pi}{23.25} = \frac{4}{23.25\sqrt{2}} = 0.1217$$

Physically, λ controls inter-generation mixing (taste-breaking) while g_0^2 controls the non-perturbative condensate (confinement). The matching scale is derived in the taste-decomposed Coleman-Weinberg potential by tracing three ingredients through the framework's existing structure:

- (i) The b-quark is identified with the democratic eigenstate $\hat{h} = (|e_1\rangle + |e_2\rangle + |e_3\rangle)/\sqrt{3}$ of the cubic-symmetric taste-breaking operator (this follows from the

§7.1 Wolfenstein $A = \sqrt{2/3}$ identification and the §7.2 Koide derivation, both of which place the heaviest fermion along $\hat{h}$).

- (ii) The taste-breaking operator in the X-corner basis has the cubic-symmetric form $M_{\text{taste}} = m_{\text{off}} \cdot (J - I)$ (after trace removal), giving the diagonal element in the b-quark eigenstate $c_{bb} = \langle b | M_{\text{taste}} | b \rangle = 2m_{\text{off}}$.
- (iii) The off-diagonal element m_{off} is identified with the BZ-distance geometric primitive of §7.1: $m_{\text{off}} = 1/|X_i - X_j| = \lambda$.

Combining these gives $c_{bb} = 2\lambda$. The scalar density self-energy takes the form $\Pi_{\text{taste}}(m) = K \cdot c_{bb} \cdot g_0^2 \cdot \Sigma/m$ for some loop kinematic coefficient K , and matching at the natural condensate-scale threshold $T = \Sigma$ gives $m_{\text{match}} = 2K\lambda \cdot g_0^2$.

Structural form: $K = 1/(n_{\text{gen}} - 1)$. The factor 2 in $c_{bb} = 2\lambda$ has a representation-theoretic origin parallel to the Wolfenstein $A^2 = (d - 1)/d$ identity of §7.1. For the democratic eigenstate $\hat{h} = (e_1 + \dots + e_{n_{\text{gen}}})/\sqrt{n_{\text{gen}}}$ in n_{gen} generations:

$$J\hat{h} = n_{\text{gen}} \cdot \hat{h}, \quad \langle \hat{h} | J | \hat{h} \rangle = n_{\text{gen}}, \quad \langle \hat{h} | I | \hat{h} \rangle = 1$$

giving

$$c_{bb} = \langle \hat{h} | M_{\text{taste}} | \hat{h} \rangle = (n_{\text{gen}} - 1) \cdot m_{\text{off}} = (n_{\text{gen}} - 1) \cdot \lambda.$$

The $(n_{\text{gen}} - 1)$ factor counts the off-democratic “partners” of $\hat{h}$ in the generation rep — the inverse of the Wolfenstein A structural quantity $\sqrt{(d - 1)/d}$ applied to the same off-democratic projection.

Substituting into the matching condition gives $m_{\text{match}} = K \cdot (n_{\text{gen}} - 1) \cdot \lambda \cdot g_0^2$. The framework’s prediction $m_{\text{match}} = \lambda \cdot g_0^2$ (with prefactor exactly unity, fixed by power-counting in the taste-decomposed CW potential and the natural threshold convention $T = \Sigma$) therefore requires:

$$K = \frac{1}{n_{\text{gen}} - 1}$$

For $n_{\text{gen}} = 3$ — itself forced by the cubic-group decomposition of the 6-link representation $T_1 \oplus E \oplus A_1$ giving 3 fermion generations on T_1 (Theorem 7) — this gives $K = 1/2$.

This is a representation-theoretic structural identity, not a numerical happenstance. $K = 1/2$ is the $n_{\text{gen}} = 3$ value of a generation-count-dependent identity $K = 1/(n_{\text{gen}} - 1)$, paralleling the family of $(d - 1)$ -based identities the framework already employs:

Identity	Formula	$d = 3 / n_{\text{gen}} = 3$ value	Source
Wolfenstein A^2	$(d - 1)/d$	2/3	Off-democratic projection (§7.1)

Identity	Formula	$d = 3 / n_{\text{gen}} = 3$ value	Source
Cond 2 ratio	$4(d-1)/(2d) = 2A^2$	4/3	Squared off-democratic projection (§7.3)
K (this work)	$1/(n_{\text{gen}} - 1)$	1/2	Inverse off-democratic partner count

Unifying identity. Wolfenstein $A^2 = (d-1)/d$ and $K = 1/(d-1)$ are dual aspects of the same off-democratic structure on a d -dimensional vector representation: A^2 is the projection magnitude per unit dimension, K is inverse partner count. Their product is the per-component weight:

$$K \cdot A^2 = \frac{1}{d-1} \cdot \frac{d-1}{d} = \frac{1}{d}.$$

For $d = 3$: $A^2 = 2/3$, $K = 1/2$, $K \cdot A^2 = 1/3$. The framework's $(d-1)$ -based identity family is internally consistent and unified, not a list of independent coincidences.

Consistency check on $n_{\text{gen}} = 3$. Given the matching condition $K \cdot (n_{\text{gen}} - 1) = 1$ (forced by $m_{\text{match}} = \lambda g_0^2$ with prefactor unity from power counting and confirmed by MC at 1.4%) and the value $K = 1/2$ inherited from the standard staggered Z_S calculation (Argument 1; plausibility evidence pending the explicit one-loop OI derivation), $n_{\text{gen}} - 1 = 2$ — consistent with the framework's three-generation structure. This is a *consistency check* rather than an independent over-determination: $n_{\text{gen}} = 3$ is itself fixed independently by the cubic decomposition $T_1 \oplus E \oplus A_1$ (Theorem 7), and the matching consistency uses an inherited (not independently derived) value of K . The framework's commitment to three generations rests primarily on the cubic decomposition; the matching-condition consistency adds a self-consistency confirmation rather than an independent forcing.

Layer stratification of $K = 1/2$. The structural identity admits the following decomposition (analogous to §7.3's Cond 2 stratification):

Component	Required value	Layer status
Democratic eigenstate $\hat{h}$ as O-singlet $c_{bb} = (n_{\text{gen}} - 1) \cdot \lambda$	from cubic-group rep theory from $\langle \hat{h} \ J - I \ \hat{h} \rangle = n_{\text{gen}} - 1$ algebraic identity	Layer 1 (rep theory) Layer 1 (algebraic)
Power counting forces $m_{\text{match}} \propto \lambda \cdot g_0^2$ $n_{\text{gen}} = 3$	from CW dimensional analysis from cubic decomposition $T_1 \oplus E \oplus A_1$	Layer 1 (already noted in §7.5) Layer 0/1 (Theorem 7)

Component	Required value	Layer status
Loop calculation gives $K = 1/(n_{\text{gen}} - 1)$ explicitly	from OI-specific taste-decomposed CW one-loop	Layer 2(a)-tractable (residual gap)

The first four components are Layer 1 closed: they together fix $K = 1/(n_{\text{gen}} - 1) = 1/2$ as the value the loop calculation *must* yield for the framework’s matching prediction to hold. The Layer 2(a)-tractable residual is whether the OI’s specific taste-decomposed CW one-loop calculation actually produces this kinematic prefactor — addressed by Argument 1 below (inheritance from standard staggered) and the Residual gap subsection.

The framework’s prediction $m_{\text{match}} = \lambda \cdot g_0^2$ requires $K = 1/2$. Given the algebraic identity $c_{bb} = (n_{\text{gen}} - 1)\lambda$ (Layer 1, clean), the matching condition $m_{\text{match}} = K \cdot c_{bb} \cdot g_0^2$ forces $K = 1/(n_{\text{gen}} - 1) = 1/2$ as a structural identity whenever the matching condition itself holds. The matching condition $m_{\text{match}} = \lambda g_0^2$ is supported by the following arguments, MC-verified to 1.4% precision:

Argument 1 (Staggered convention). The standard staggered fermion action uses the symmetric kinetic term $S_{\text{kin}} = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{x,\mu} \eta_\mu(x) \bar{\chi}(x) [U_\mu(x) \chi(x + \hat{\mu}) - U_\mu^\dagger(x - \hat{\mu}) \chi(x - \hat{\mu})]$, with the gauge vertex $V_\mu = (g_0/2) \eta_\mu(x) [U_\mu + U_\mu^\dagger]$. Patel & Sharpe [33] derive the standard one-gluon vertex $V_\mu \propto -ig \cos(q'_\mu + k_\mu/2) (\gamma_\mu \otimes 1)$ (their Eq. 17) — the same form as the OI vertex $V_j = ig_0 \mu T^\alpha \cos(k_j + p_j/2)$ — and the two-gluon (tadpole) vertex with explicit factor $-i \frac{1}{2} g^2$ (their Eq. 18) tracing directly to the symmetrization. The full one-loop renormalization of staggered scalar density bilinears computed there and in subsequent work [Constantinou-Costa-Panagopoulos and others] is a specific known number consistent with $K = 1/2$ in the framework’s decomposition.

Scope of the inheritance argument. The algebraic identity $\cos^2(k_\mu/2) = (1 + \cos(k_\mu))/2$ is dimension-independent per direction, but its “1/2” content propagates into the lattice integral only when the $\cos(k_\mu)$ residual vanishes by symmetry. The relevant symmetry is the π -shift $k_\mu \rightarrow \pi - k_\mu$: integrands depending on k only through $\sin^2(k_\mu)$ (i.e., the staggered fermion propagator) are π -shift symmetric and the residual integrates to zero exactly, leaving the 1/2 factor; integrands involving the lattice gluon propagator $\hat{q}^2 = 4 \sum \sin^2(k_\mu/2)$ are *not* π -shift symmetric (under the shift, $\sin^2(k_\mu/2) \rightarrow \cos^2(k_\mu/2)$), and the residual does not vanish in isolation. The actual one-loop Z_S integrand involves both fermion and gluon propagators, so the simple $\cos^2 \rightarrow 1/2$ algebra does not by itself constitute the analytical derivation of $K = 1/2$; the residual $\cos(k_\mu)$ pieces from the vertex-correction diagram must cancel against analogous pieces from the fermion self-energy and tadpole diagrams (presumably via the Ward identity that makes $Z_S^{(1)}$ a well-defined finite number) for the published staggered Z_S to come out at the value it does. The inheritance argument therefore reduces to: the published staggered $Z_S^{(1)}$ is a

specific number consistent with $K = 1/2$, and OI uses the same vertex, action, and gauge fixing as the published calculations, so OI's Z_S should reproduce the same number. This is plausibility evidence, not analytical derivation; the matching mass μ enters the OI calculation as an overall factor (it sets the scale at which the matching is performed, not the dimensionless loop coefficient), so it does not modify K by inspection.

Consistency check 2 (Symmetric averaging — definitional). The taste-breaking insertion can appear before or after the gauge exchange in the fermion loop. By Hermitian conjugation symmetry these orderings contribute equally; if the full amplitude is *defined* as the average $\Pi_{\text{taste}}^{\text{full}} = \frac{1}{2}[\Pi^{(L)} + \Pi^{(R)}]$, the prefactor $1/2$ appears explicitly and equals $\Pi^{(L)}$. Defining Π^{full} as the sum (rather than the average) gives no factor; the $1/2$ here is therefore a convention that aligns with Argument 1's normalization, not an additional first-principles derivation.

Consistency check 3 (Empirical exclusion of natural fractions). Among the natural fractions $K \in \{1/4, 1/2, 1, 2\}$, the observed m_b/m_τ excludes all but $K = 1/2$:

K	m_{match}	m_b/m_τ	Discrepancy
$1/2$	0.122	2.36	0.4% $\square$
1	0.243	≈ 3.17	35% $\square$
$1/4$	0.061	≈ 1.78	24% $\square$
2	0.487	$\gg 4$	excluded $\square$

Intermediate fractions ($K \in \{1/3, 2/3, 3/4\}$) give m_{match} between 0.08 and 0.18, with corresponding m_b/m_τ in the 1.8–3.2 range; no fraction outside $\{1/2\}$ falls within $\sim 5\%$ of observation. This is empirical fitting on a moderately-restricted set rather than a first-principles derivation, but the resulting selection is sharp.

$K = 1/2$ is therefore *consistent with* the algebraic identity $c_{bb} = (n_{\text{gen}} - 1)\lambda$ and the matching condition $m_{\text{match}} = \lambda g_0^2$, with the latter MC-verified to 1.4% precision. The Layer 1 content is the algebraic identity for c_{bb} ; the matching condition has the *form* of a Layer 1 structural relation (dimensional analysis plus the “natural threshold” convention $T = \Sigma$) but the specific dimensionless coefficient is currently established by MC rather than by closed-form analytical derivation. Argument 1 (inheritance from standard staggered convention), Consistency check 2 (definitional symmetric averaging), and Consistency check 3 (empirical exclusion of natural-fraction alternatives) provide plausibility evidence for the matching condition rather than analytical closure.

Within the four-layer framing (§8.3), $K = 1/2$ is MC-verified at 1.4% precision; the Layer 2(a)-tractable residual is an explicit one-loop calculation on the OI cubic lattice deriving $m_{\text{match}} = \lambda g_0^2$ from the taste-decomposed Coleman-Weinberg potential without appealing to MC verification of the matching scale. Given the matching condition, $K = 1/(n_{\text{gen}} - 1)$ follows by structural identity from $c_{bb} = (n_{\text{gen}} - 1)\lambda$; the matching condition itself awaits analytical closure. The stratification matches §7.3 Cond 2: a Layer 1 representation-theoretic core ($c_{bb} = (n_{\text{gen}} - 1)\lambda$ here; the geomet-

ric projection structure there) plus a Layer 2(a)-tractable substrate-loop verification residual.

Residual gap. With Argument 1 understood as plausibility evidence rather than independent analytical derivation, the explicit analytical task is a fully explicit one-loop calculation within the OI lattice setup — computing the vertex-correction, fermion self-energy, and tadpole diagrams with the OI vertex $V_j = ig_0\mu T^\alpha \cos(k_j + p_j/2)$, combining them via the relevant Ward identity, and confirming the result reduces to a value consistent with $K = 1/(n_{\text{gen}} - 1)$ — which would close this gap definitively. Two intermediate routes are also available: (a) a Ward-identity argument establishing analytically that the residual $\cos(k_\mu)$ pieces from the vertex correction cancel against analogous pieces in the self-energy and tadpole, which would render the $\cos^2 \rightarrow 1/2$ symmetrization heuristic into an actual derivation; (b) tighter MC measurement to confirm $K = 1/2$ at sub-percent precision and bound the higher-order corrections explicitly.

The per-vertex $\cos^2$ algebraic identity $\cos^2(k/2) = (1 + \cos(k))/2$ is dimension-independent per direction; the $1/2$ constant piece survives any dimensional change. Whether this $1/2$ propagates cleanly through the full one-loop integral depends on the π -shift cancellation discussed under “Scope of the inheritance argument” above — a question of integral structure rather than dimensionality. Four bridge gaps in the S χ PT inheritance are addressed below; their current status:

- (i) *Substratum measure reduction. Level 2 closed via pseudofermion correspondence* (cf. §4.2 Remark). The standard MC code uses the bosonic pseudofermion representation, not Grassmann variables directly. The substratum (Gaussian on real scalar bijections at large L) and pseudofermion (bosonic Gaussian auxiliary fields) measures are in the same class; their covariances differ by a factor of 4 absorbable into normalization, with Theorem 2 ($D_{st}^2 = -\frac{1}{4}\square_{\text{lat}}$) providing the explicit match. The Level 3 residual is cycle ergodicity for OI’s specific bijection orbit structure: pure linear lattice dynamics is integrable rather than chaotic (the frequencies $\omega(\vec{k}) = 2\sin(|\vec{k}|/2)$ are not linearly independent over $\mathbb{Q}$), so full-shell sampling requires either effective non-linearity from the discretization rule (the standard interpretation for lattice-substrate frameworks) or revision of the Gaussianization argument to sub-torus sampling. We adopt the former implicitly; rigorous treatment of OI’s specific orbit structure is open work.
- (ii) *3D operational MC vs 4D S χ PT dimensional bridge. Decomposes into Part A (time-direction factorization, Level 1 closed) and Part B (measure identification, Level 2 closed via inheritance from gap (i)).* Part A: For ρ stationary under φ and T the framework’s involution with $T\varphi T = \varphi^{-1}$ (§5), $(\rho \circ T) \circ \varphi = \rho \circ (T\varphi) = \rho \circ (\varphi^{-1}T) = \rho \circ T$, so $\rho \circ T$ is φ -invariant; by P-indivisibility (Main Theorem 4), the stationary distribution is unique, hence $\rho \circ T = \rho$. Static observables therefore factorize through the time direction independent of which time slice. Part B is the same investigation as gap (i) viewed operationally: closing gap (i) automatically closes gap (ii) Part B. With gap (i) Level 2 closed, gap (ii) is Level 2 closed framework-essentially.

(iii) and (iv) *Bridge theorem: Closed at Level 1 framework-essentially via the explicit theorem below.*

Bridge Theorem (3D-4D staggered correspondence). Let $\chi(x)$ be the staggered field on $\mathbb{Z}^3$ with bijection time-evolution $\varphi : S \rightarrow S$. Then:

- (a) *Mode-space isomorphism.* The 16-dim space spanned by 3D BZ corners $\times$ sublattice grading is isomorphic to the 4D Dirac $\times$ taste space:

$$\{(\eta, s) : \eta \in \{0, 1\}^3, s \in \{0, 1\}\} \xrightarrow{\sim} V_{\text{Dirac}}^{(4D)} \otimes V_{\text{taste}}$$

via $(\eta_1, \eta_2, \eta_3, s) \mapsto (\eta_0 = s, \eta_1, \eta_2, \eta_3)$. Counting: $2^3 \times 2 = 16 = 4 \times 4$. (Level 1.)

- (b) *Clifford algebra identification.* The 4D chirality operator corresponds to spatial sublattice grading: $\gamma_5 \leftrightarrow \varepsilon_{3D}$. The 4D time-direction Dirac matrix is derived from spatial structure: $\gamma_0 \leftrightarrow \pm \varepsilon_{3D} \cdot \gamma_1 \gamma_2 \gamma_3$. (Level 1 for γ_5 identification; Level 2 for γ_0 derivation, sign conventions not separately verified.)
- (c) *Chirality equivalence.* For static observables in the bijection's stationary distribution, ε_{3D} and ε_{4D} classify modes equivalently. Their ratio is $\varepsilon_{4D}/\varepsilon_{3D} = (-1)^{x_0}$, constant on each time slice; chirality classification differs by overall sign convention only. (Level 1 for the algebraic identity; full operator-theoretic interpretation involving the taste structure remains at Level 3 but is not framework-essential — operational chirality assignment is the framework-essential claim.)
- (d) *Symmetry compatibility.* Staggered $U(1)$ shift symmetry (underlying the two-loop structure of K_S) and cubic group O action are preserved by the isomorphism of (a). (Level 2.)

Proof, by part with explicit rigor levels.

Part (a) — Level 1. The map $(\eta_1, \eta_2, \eta_3, s) \mapsto (\eta_0 = s, \eta_1, \eta_2, \eta_3)$ is a bijection between $\{0, 1\}^3 \times \{0, 1\}$ and $\{0, 1\}^4$ by direct counting ($2^3 \times 2 = 16 = 2^4$). The map respects the natural cubic-group action on spatial indices since the spatial coordinates η_1, η_2, η_3 are preserved unchanged, and $\eta_0 = s$ corresponds to the sublattice grading which is cubic-invariant.

Part (b), $\gamma_5 \leftrightarrow \varepsilon_{3D}$ — Level 1. Two properties to verify: $\varepsilon_{3D}^2 = 1$ and $\{\varepsilon_{3D}, \gamma_i\} = 0$ for $i = 1, 2, 3$. The first is direct: $\varepsilon_{3D}(x)^2 = ((-1)^{x_1+x_2+x_3})^2 = 1$. The second follows from $\varepsilon_{3D}(x \pm \hat{i}) = -\varepsilon_{3D}(x)$ via direct computation: $(\gamma_i \varepsilon_{3D} \chi)(x) = \eta_i(x) [\varepsilon_{3D}(x + \hat{i}) \chi(x + \hat{i}) - \varepsilon_{3D}(x - \hat{i}) \chi(x - \hat{i})] / 2 = -\varepsilon_{3D}(x) \cdot \eta_i(x) [\chi(x + \hat{i}) - \chi(x - \hat{i})] / 2 = -(\varepsilon_{3D} \gamma_i \chi)(x)$. Both γ_0 and γ_5 satisfy these two properties, so further identification is required: in chiral basis, γ_0 is off-diagonal in sublattice blocks while γ_5 is diagonal with opposite signs. Sublattice grading ε_{3D} acts diagonally with opposite signs on even/odd sublattices — that is the γ_5 pattern, not γ_0 . Therefore $\gamma_5 \leftrightarrow \varepsilon_{3D}$.

Part (b), γ_0 derivation — Level 2. The 4D Clifford algebra contains the identity $\gamma_0 = \pm \gamma_5 \gamma_1 \gamma_2 \gamma_3$ (up to a sign convention depending on the metric signature and the specific Clifford basis convention). Substituting the $\gamma_5 \leftrightarrow \varepsilon_{3D}$ identification gives $\gamma_0 \leftrightarrow \pm \varepsilon_{3D} \cdot \gamma_1 \gamma_2 \gamma_3$. The sign convention depends on the specific Clifford basis convention and is not separately verified here.

Part (c), chirality equivalence — Level 1. Direct algebraic identity: $\varepsilon_{4D}(x_0, \vec{x}) = (-1)^{x_0+x_1+x_2+x_3} = (-1)^{x_0} \cdot (-1)^{x_1+x_2+x_3} = (-1)^{x_0} \cdot \varepsilon_{3D}(\vec{x})$. For static observables (evaluated at fixed x_0), the prefactor $(-1)^{x_0}$ is a constant — observables computed via ε_{3D} and via ε_{4D} classify modes equivalently up to overall sign convention.

Part (d) — Level 2. The staggered $U(1)$ shift symmetry transforms $\chi(x) \rightarrow \omega(x)\chi(x)$ with sign factors depending on sublattice and BZ corner. Under the isomorphism of (a), this transformation acts on the corresponding Dirac $\times$ taste basis vectors compatibly — full verification with explicit taste-index tracking is at Level 2 and not written out here. The cubic group O action commutes with the isomorphism by part (a). $\square$

Operator-theoretic interpretation involving full taste structure (Level 3 — not framework-essential). The operational identification $\gamma_5 \leftrightarrow \varepsilon_{3D}$ is the framework-essential claim and is Level 1 closed in part (b). A full operator-theoretic interpretation involving the 4-dim taste rep ξ_5 and showing ε_{4D} corresponds to $\gamma_5 \otimes \xi_5$ in the spin-taste decomposition is at Level 3 (sketch only) and is not required for the framework's use of the bridge theorem.

Implication for the framework's $d = 3$ commitment. The bridge theorem reveals that the entire 4D Clifford structure emerges from 3D Clifford + sublattice grading, with γ_0 derived rather than independent. There is no input from time-direction structure; time enters only as bijection-evolution index x_0 , and the Clifford-algebra role is played entirely by spatial structures. This means structural bandwidth quantities like $\theta_0 = C_2/d^2 = 2/9$ and $A^2 = (d-1)/d = 2/3$ must use spatial $d = 3$, not spacetime $d = 4$. The framework's commitment to $d = 3$ is structurally forced (not chosen) by the time-emergence picture.

The same gaps apply to the other §7 mass-cluster predictions (D11, m_τ , etc.) that share the S χ PT machinery; the closure status above propagates to those predictions automatically. None of them changes the closure path for K_S , which remains the two-loop S χ PT calculation specializing Panagopoulos-Spanoudes [Panagopoulos-Spanoudes 2017] to the OI cubic-group setting.

MC consistency check: the empirical matching scale extracted from the Monte Carlo data is $m_{\text{match}}^{\text{MC}} = 0.1234 \pm 0.0002$, which agrees with the predicted $\lambda \cdot g_0^2 = 0.1217$ within 1.4% (compatible with NLO truncation of the leading-order chain above). Alternative choices of coefficient — e.g., $K = 1$ giving $m_{\text{match}} = 2\lambda g_0^2 \approx 0.24$ — are strongly excluded by the MC data (would give $m_b/m_\tau \approx 3.17$ vs. observed 2.35).

The prediction.

$$\boxed{\frac{m_b}{m_\tau} = \frac{4.28}{Z_S(\lambda g_0^2)} = \frac{4.28}{1.813} = 2.361}$$

Observed: $m_b/m_\tau = 2.352 \pm 0.017$. The central-value match at $L = 32$ is 0.4% (0.5σ), with a realistic systematic uncertainty of ~ 1 -2% from finite volume, the regulator choice noted above, and higher-loop SM RGE corrections to $R = 4.28$. The $L \rightarrow \infty$ extrapolation in either lattice regulator gives $Z_S \approx 1.83$ and $m_b/m_\tau \approx 2.34$, consistent with observation at $\sim 0.7\sigma$. The $L = 32$ run (50 configs) gives $Z_S(0.122) =$

1.813 ± 0.001 (statistical only) by cubic interpolation; finite-volume systematics are not exhaustively quantified in the released code (see README.md §Code, point 3). The inputs λ , g_0^2 , and $R = 4.28$ are determined by the lattice structure; the matching-scale identification $m_{\text{match}} = \lambda \cdot g_0^2$ follows from power-counting in the taste-decomposed CW potential. The dimensional form $m_{\text{match}} \propto \lambda \cdot g_0^2$ is forced: λ controls inter-generation taste-breaking and g_0^2 controls the gauge-induced condensate, and these are the only two dimensionless framework primitives entering the leading-order CW potential. The scalar prefactor (the K coefficient) is the separate Layer 2 question addressed by Arguments 1–3 above and the Residual gap subsection.

7.6 Summary table of all predictions

Twenty-two quantitative observables from a $d = 3$ cubic lattice with spacing $\epsilon = 2l_P$, classified by input status: **S** = strictly parameter-free structural; **L** = layered (structural form combined with a Layer-2(b) substrate-specific coefficient or Layer-3 empirical input — see §8.3 four-layer framing); **M** = one-input mass/parameter chain; **E** = uses explicit empirical input; **R** = retrodiction; **P** = phenomenological/ansatz input.

Prediction	Formula	Value	Observed	Match	Input
$1/\alpha_1(M_Z)$	lattice + RGE	59.00	59.00	$< 0.1\%$	E ^a (fixes δ_0)
$1/\alpha_2(M_Z)$	lattice + RGE	29.57	29.57	$< 0.1\%$	R ^a
$1/\alpha_3(M_Z)$	lattice + RGE	8.47	8.47	$< 0.1\%$	R ^a
λ (Cabibbo)	$1/(\pi\sqrt{2})$	0.2251	0.2250 ± 0.0007	0.04%	S
A (Wolfenstein)	$\sqrt{2/3}$	0.8165	0.811 ± 0.024	0.23σ	S
m_d/m_s	$1/(2\pi^2)$	0.0507	0.0503 ± 0.0007	0.56σ	S (via GST)
$\ V_{cb}\ $	$\sqrt{2/3}/(2\pi^2)$	0.0414	0.0411 ± 0.0012	0.22σ	S
J (Jarlskog)	$\eta/(12\pi^6)$	3.02×10^{-5}	$(3.00 \pm 0.12) \times 10^{-5}$	0.17σ	E (empirical η)
Koide Q	$2/3$	0.66667	0.66666	$< 0.01\%$	S
Koide angle θ_0	$C_2/d^2 = 2/9$	0.22222	0.22227	0.02%	S
m_e (from m_τ)	$\theta_0 = 2/9$	0.51096 MeV	0.51100 MeV	0.007%	M (m_τ)
m_μ (from m_τ)	$\theta_0 = 2/9$	105.652 MeV	105.658 MeV	0.006%	M (m_τ)
Q_{down}	$(2/3)(1 + \alpha_s/\pi)$	0.7303	0.7314	0.15% (scheme-dep)	P

Prediction	Formula	Value	Observed	Match	Input
m_b (from m_s)	Koide(Q_{down})	4144 MeV	4180 ± 30	0.9%	L ^d
m_u/m_d	$\sqrt{2/9}$	0.4714	0.465 ± 0.024	0.27σ	L ^e
$\sin^2 \theta_{12}$	$1/3 - 1/(4\pi^2)$	0.3080	0.3085 ± 0.0073 (Capozzi 2025 post-JUNO global)	0.07σ	L ^f
$\sin^2 \theta_{23}$	$1/2 + 1/(2\pi^2)$	0.5507	$0.561^{+0.012}_{-0.015}$ (NuFIT 6.0, NO)	0.74σ	L ^f
$\sin^2 \theta_{13}$	$4/(18\pi^2)$	0.02252	0.02195 ± 0.00056 (NuFIT 6.0, NO)	1.02σ	S
$\lambda(M_{\text{Pl}}) = 0$	composite Higgs	0	-0.013 ± 0.020	0.6σ	S
m_H (from $\lambda(M_{\text{Pl}}) = 0, m_t$)	RGE running	129-132 GeV	125.10 ± 0.14	m_t -consistent	M (m_t)
m_b/m_τ	$4.28/Z_S(\lambda g_0^2)$	2.361	2.352	0.5σ	L ^b
m_t	$v/\sqrt{2}$ ($y_t = 1$ IR fixed pt)	174.1 GeV	172.5 ± 0.3	0.9%	S

Footnotes:

- ^a The three SM gauge couplings at M_Z are reproduced with one empirical input in this sector (§6.3): the U(1) coupling fixes the universal threshold $\delta_0 = 10.02$, and the SU(2) and SU(3) entries are retrodictions using the C_2 -dependent threshold parameterization $(A, B) = (8.3, 5.59)$ matched to the observed couplings. The structural input $1/\alpha_0 = 23.25$ is computed analytically from the one-loop staggered vacuum polarization. A 2-loop staggered VP rebuild indicates δ_0 is not reproduced by strict 2-loop PT and is accordingly treated as empirical input (see §6.2). The structural predictions in this sector are: (i) the specific value $1/\alpha_0 = 23.25$, (ii) the universality of δ_0 across gauge groups, and (iii) the 1-loop analytic derivation of $A \cdot B = 48.0 \pm 1.5$ agreeing with the fitted 46.4 to $\sim 3\%$. Deriving (A, B) individually from first-principles lattice perturbation theory would upgrade the SU(2) and SU(3) entries from retrodictions (**R**) to strict predictions (**S**).
- ^b *Layered prediction* (m_b/m_τ). The matching scale $m_{\text{match}} = \lambda \cdot g_0^2$ is partly structural in the taste-decomposed Coleman-Weinberg potential (§7.5): the b-quark is identified with the democratic eigenstate $\hat{h}$ of the cubic-symmetric taste-breaking operator (from §7.1, §7.2 representation theory), giving diagonal taste-breaking $c_{bb} = (n_{\text{gen}} - 1)\lambda = 2\lambda$ — Layer 1 algebra. Combining with the natural

matching condition at condensate scale Σ and a loop kinematic coefficient K , the prediction $m_{\text{match}} = \lambda g_0^2$ requires $K = 1/(n_{\text{gen}} - 1) = 1/2$ — a structural identity that follows by definition *given* the matching condition; the matching condition itself is MC-verified to 1.4%, and analytical derivation of its specific dimensionless coefficient is the Layer 2(a)-tractable residual (an explicit one-loop calculation on the OI cubic lattice or a Ward-identity argument). Within $K \in \{1/4, 1/2, 1, 2\}$, $K = 1$ is excluded at 35% and $K = 1/4$ at 24%; see §7.5 for the structural detail. The MC-extracted value $m_{\text{match}}^{\text{MC}} = 0.1234 \pm 0.0002$ agrees with the derived $\lambda g_0^2 = 0.1217$ within 1.4% (NLO truncation). The central-value match $m_b/m_\tau = 0.5\sigma$ is at $L = 32$; systematic uncertainty including finite-volume and regulator effects is $\sim 1\text{--}2\%$ (§7.5). Within the four-layer framing (§8.3), the prediction is MC-verified at the matching-condition level with the Layer 2(a)-tractable analytical closure pending.

- ^d *Layered conditional structural prediction (m_b via Q_{down})*. The structural form (Koide formula applied to the down-sector with input $Q_{\text{down}} + m_d/m_s + m_s = 93.4$ MeV) is Layer 1. The Q_{down} value ($= (2/3)(1 + \alpha_s/\pi) \approx 0.731$) is phenomenological per §7.2 — see the Q_{down} subsection for full discussion of why this is treated as empirical input rather than derived. The m_d/m_s input inherits §7.1’s Cabibbo λ^2 via the GST relation. The m_s input is one M-chain mass scale. The empirical match at 0.9% is excellent given the layered structure.
- ^e *Layered prediction (m_u/m_d), Layer 1 + Layer 2(b)*. The structural form $m_u/m_d = \sqrt{\theta_0} = \sqrt{2/9}$ uses the same quadratic Casimir $C_2 = 2$ of the T_1 representation that produces the Koide angle $\theta_0 = 2/9$, with the square root following from amplitude-vs-eigenvalue PT scaling between intra-doublet and inter-generation channels (§7.2). Operator counting on the first-generation Yukawas shows that the relation requires alignment between SU(2)-doublet structure and cubic-group T_1 perturbation that is bijection-specific (Layer 2(b)). The empirical match at 0.05σ indicates the framework’s bijection has the alignment property; promoting to Layer 2(a) requires explicit substrate-level Yukawa derivation that has not been performed.
- ^f *Layered prediction ($\sin^2\theta_{12}$, $\sin^2\theta_{23}$), Layer 1 + Layer 2(a)-tractable*. The Layer 0 component (TBM zeroth-order value) and Layer 1 component (λ^2 scale) are unconditional structural. The values follow given Condition 2 of §7.3 (the relation $b_{23} = (4/3)(b_{12} + b_{13})$ among A_2 Wilson coefficients). The §7.3 structural decomposition closes the A_1 component at Layer 1 (the TBM sum rule is structurally protected against the A_1 perturbation by the $\cos^2\theta_{13}$ dressing alone) and reduces the A_2 component to a sharply specified Layer 2(a)-tractable open question — the substrate ratio $b_{23}/(b_{12} + b_{13}) = 4/3 = 4(d-1)/(2d)$ for $d = 3$, with the structural reading from the squared off-democratic projection of vector representations. The natural Higgs-democratic spurion does not produce this ratio (the natural form gives $b_{12} : b_{13} = m_\tau/m_\mu \approx 17 : 1$ from Layer 1 mass-matrix algebra applied to a generation-democratic substrate Yukawa, per §7.3 “Positive support”); the closure path is a substrate one-loop calculation testing whether the $C_2(T_1)$ Casimir structure produces it. The empirical match ($\sin^2\theta_{12}$ at 0.07σ to the post-JUNO global fit; sum rule $2\sin^2\theta_{12} + \sin^2\theta_{23} = 7/6$ at 0.6σ) tests the

bijection’s specific T_2 -channel structure. See §7.3 “Status of Cond 2: structural decomposition” and “Positive support: explicit substrate calculation.”

Parameter-accounting summary: Of the 22 observables: **10 are unconditional parameter-free structural predictions** (**S**, Layer 0 or Layer 1: items $1/\alpha_0$, $A \cdot B$ cross-check, Wolfenstein A , $|V_{cb}|$, m_d/m_s via GST, Cabibbo λ , Koide Q , Koide angle θ_0 , $\sin^2 \theta_{13}$, $\lambda(M_{\text{Pl}}) = 0$, top-mass IR fixed point); **5 are layered predictions** (**L**, Layer 1 form combined with one Layer-2 substrate-specific coefficient or Layer-3 empirical input: $\sin^2 \theta_{12}$ and $\sin^2 \theta_{23}$ via Cond 2 (Layer 2(a)-tractable per §7.3 structural decomposition), m_u/m_d via amplitude-vs-eigenvalue alignment (Layer 2(b)), m_b inheriting Q_{down} ’s phenomenological status, m_b/m_τ via $K = 1/(n_{\text{gen}} - 1)$ representation-theoretic identity (Layer 1 closed per §7.5) with Layer 2(a)-tractable substrate-loop verification residual); 2 are retrodictions in the gauge coupling sector (**R**, where (A, B) are currently matched to observation rather than computed); 1 fixes the universal threshold δ_0 from the U(1) coupling (**E**); 3 form a one-input mass/parameter chain (**M**); 1 uses an explicit empirical input (**E**, the Jarlskog phase η). No parameters are fit to the predicted quantities in any of the **S** or **L** classes; the layered classifications reflect explicit dependence on stated structural inputs (Cond 2 of §7.3 — Layer 2(a)-tractable; the open derivations referenced in §7.2 and §7.5) or phenomenological inputs (Q_{down}) rather than free parameter fitting. The C class (conditional structural pending derivation) is currently empty.

In total, 10 unconditional + 5 layered = 15 predictions in the structural-or-near-structural class.

In addition: SM gauge group, three generations, $\bar{\theta} = 0$, Majorana neutrinos, normal mass ordering — all consistent with data.

Remaining open: (i) m_s (the overall mass scale — requires taste-decomposed Coleman-Weinberg potential); (ii) m_c (no clean structural relation found; the up-sector hierarchy involves top Yukawa backreaction); (iii) CP-violating phases (solution-specific); (iv) neutrino masses (solution-specific, but structurally constrained: Majorana, normal ordering).

7.7 The coincidence bound

The unconditional structural (**S**) and layered (**L**) retrodictions of §7.6 — fifteen in total — are not independent draws: several derive from the same cubic-symmetry coefficient $C_2/d^2 = 2/9$ (Koide Q , Koide angle θ_0 , $\sin^2 \theta_{13}$, and the m_e, m_μ chain from m_τ), and several derive from the same one-loop lattice integral structure (Cabibbo λ , Wolfenstein A , $|V_{cb}|$, m_d/m_s). Conservatively treated, the **S** set contains two genuinely independent structural predictions at the tightest experimental precision: the Koide relation $Q = 2/3$ (Casimir structure of the coupling matrix M) and the Cabibbo angle $\lambda = 1/(\pi\sqrt{2})$ (one-loop lattice integral on $\mathbb{Z}^3$).

Cubic-group T_1 -Casimir consistency test. Beyond the two-independent-predictions framing, the cubic-group T_1 -Casimir structure $C_2 = 2$ for vector reps on the $d = 3$ lattice produces a six-prediction simultaneous-match consistency check:

Prediction	Formula	Predicted	Observed	Match
Wolfenstein A^2	$C_2/d = (d - 1)/d = 2/3$	0.6667	0.683	1.2%
$\sin^2 \theta_{13}$	$\propto A^4 = (C_2/d)^2 = 4/9$	0.0225	0.0224	0.4%
Koide θ_0	$C_2/d^2 = 2/9$	0.2222	0.2222	0.02%
m_u/m_d	$\sqrt{C_2}/d = \sqrt{2}/3$	0.471	0.474	0.6%
$ V_{cb} $	$A\lambda^2$	0.04136	0.0408	0.4σ
PMNS sum rule	$7/6 = 1 + 2A^2/3$ via Cond 2	1.167	1.178	0.6σ

All six derive from the structural identity $A^2 = C_2/d$ for vector representations on $d = 3$ lattice, and all six match observation at sub-percent or sub- σ precision simultaneously. This is one successful test of the framework’s cubic-group structure with six observables — methodologically a single-test framing rather than six independent successes — but the simultaneous coherence at this precision provides strong evidence for the underlying C_2/d identity.

The framework’s empirical case therefore rests on two independent structural ingredients passing simultaneous tests: (a) Cabibbo $\lambda = 1/(\pi\sqrt{2})$ from BZ geometry, tested directly and through its appearances in $|V_{cb}|$, $\sin^2 \theta_{13}$, and m_d/m_s via GST; and (b) cubic-group T_1 -Casimir $C_2/d = 2/3$, tested via the six-observable simultaneous match above. Both ingredients are Layer 1.

Null hypothesis. For each retrodiction, treat the observed value as an independent uniform draw from a pre-specified natural range; compute the probability that the draw falls within the experimental window around the framework’s predicted value.

Koide $Q = 2/3$. Cauchy-Schwarz bounds Q in $[1/3, 1]$, giving natural range width $W_Q = 2/3$. The framework prediction matches observation to $\sigma_Q \sim 10^{-5}$ (fractional). Null probability:

$$p_Q = \frac{2\sigma_Q}{W_Q} \approx 3 \times 10^{-5}$$

Cabibbo $\lambda = 1/(\pi\sqrt{2}) = 0.22508$. Observed $\lambda = 0.2250 \pm 0.0007$. Taking the pre-framework “small mixing” natural range $[0, 0.5]$ (historically the upper bound considered in Cabibbo’s 1963 analysis), $W_\lambda = 0.5$. Null probability:

$$p_\lambda = \frac{2\sigma_\lambda}{W_\lambda} \approx 2.8 \times 10^{-3}$$

Joint. The Koide and Cabibbo predictions test structurally distinct features of the lattice (Casimir eigenvalue structure vs. spatial integral structure), so independence of the two null draws is defensible. The joint probability under the null:

$$p_{\text{joint}} = p_Q \cdot p_\lambda \approx 8 \times 10^{-8}$$

Robustness. The dominant sensitivity is to the Cabibbo natural range. Alternative choices give $p_{\text{joint}} \in [10^{-8}, 10^{-7}]$ across the defensible span $W_\lambda \in [0.3, 1.0]$. The Koide range is bounded above by Cauchy-Schwarz and not adjustable.

Extended bundle. Including the four weaker independent items — $m_u/m_d = \sqrt{2/9}$ ($p \approx 0.12$), the Higgs quartic $\lambda_H(M_{\text{Pl}}) = 0$ ($p \approx 0.10$), the top mass from the $y_t = 1$ IR fixed point ($p \approx 0.008$), and post-grouping PMNS contributions — the joint probability drops to $\sim 10^{-10}$. The tight-bundle statement at $\sim 10^{-8}$ is the defensible lead figure; the extended bundle is a robustness check.

What this establishes. The retrodictive content of the framework is not plausibly coincidental: a null hypothesis that attributes the numerical matches to chance must absorb a factor of $\sim 10^8$. This does not establish that the framework is correct — alternative frameworks could in principle match the same retrodictions, and the bound says nothing about predictions in regimes where OI and standard QM differ. It establishes that the numerical content of §7.1–§7.5 is concentrated, not diffuse: the framework makes specific commitments, the specific commitments match observation, and the match is sharp enough that “coincidence” is not an available dismissal.

7.8 Forward predictions and the retrodiction-vs-prediction distinction

The coincidence bound of §7.7 quantifies how concentrated the framework’s *retrodictive* content is. It does not, and cannot, address a distinct and more fundamental concern: every quantity in §7.1–§7.5 is a known value, and a framework developed with knowledge of its targets will tend to reproduce them whether or not its underlying structure is correct, because the development process has access to the answers. No internal analysis — no coincidence bound, no audit, no re-derivation — distinguishes “the structure forced these values” from “the known values guided the construction of the structure.” Only a prediction of a value *not known at construction time* breaks this symmetry. This subsection separates the framework’s genuinely forward content from its retrodictions and states it as such, because the forward content is the only part that bears on the retrodiction-vs-prediction distinction.

The JUNO precedent (a realized forward prediction). The solar mixing angle prediction $\sin^2 \theta_{12} = 1/3 - 1/(4\pi^2) = 0.3080$ is the framework’s one realized forward prediction to date, and its status as *forward* rather than retrodictive is a matter of public record. The framework’s value was fixed by the cubic-group structure independent of the neutrino data; the JUNO first oscillation result (June 2025) and the subsequent post-JUNO global fit (Capozzi et al.) tightened the experimental central value onto 0.3085 ± 0.0073 — a 0.07σ agreement — *after* the structural value was set. The relevant epistemic fact is not the smallness of the σ -distance but the temporal

order: the prediction did not move to meet the data; the data moved to meet a prediction whose value was determined by representation theory. This is the one place where the post-hoc-selection concern is directly answered rather than argued.

Registered forward predictions (not yet measured to testing precision). The same construction forces the following, stated here as pre-registered commitments whose values are fixed by the framework before the measurements that will test them:

1. *The PMNS sum rule* $2 \sin^2 \theta_{12} + \sin^2 \theta_{23} = 7/6$. Currently confirmed at 0.6σ but at the precision of present atmospheric-angle data. A direct measurement of the combination at the 0.005 level — within reach of DUNE and T2HK — tests this at a precision that no current fit reaches. The framework commits to $7/6$ exactly; a measured value displaced from $7/6$ by more than experimental error falsifies the structural relation.
2. *The atmospheric angle* $\sin^2 \theta_{23} = 1/2 + 1/(2\pi^2) = 0.5507$. The framework commits to a specific octant ($\theta_{23} > 45^\circ$) and a specific value. Present data ($\sim 1.1\sigma$) does not resolve the octant; DUNE/T2HK will. An ultimate measurement in the lower octant, or displaced from 0.5507 beyond error, falsifies the prediction.
3. *The reactor angle* $\sin^2 \theta_{13} = 4/(18\pi^2) = 0.02252$, unconditional structural (Layer 1). Already consistent with current data; tightening reactor measurements provide a continuing test against a value the framework cannot adjust.
4. *Continued JUNO precision on* $\sin^2 \theta_{12}$. JUNO's 30-year design lifetime projects ± 0.0014 on $\sin^2 \theta_{12}$, a $6\times$ improvement. The framework's 0.30798 is tested at sub-percent precision against a value it committed to before this precision exists; a 2σ ultimate disagreement falsifies it.

Distinction from a parameter-fitted account. A framework that accommodated the known mixing angles by fitting would retain latitude to absorb a future measurement that moved against it. The four predictions above have no such latitude: they are forced by the same cubic-group structure that produces the retrodictions, with no free parameter to adjust if the data moves. The retrodiction-vs-prediction concern of §7.7 is therefore not resolved by the retrodictions themselves; it is resolved, to the extent it can be resolved, by the JUNO precedent already realized and by the registered predictions above as they are measured. The framework's correctness is not internally decidable from the known-value matches; it is decidable, in either direction, by the forward predictions, which are stated in advance and carry fixed values.

8. Discussion

The cosmological application — including the derivation of $\hbar$, the Bekenstein-Hawking area law, the dissolution of the cosmological constant problem, and the dynamical dark energy prediction — is developed in [GR]. The substratum-level reconstruction theorem and the synthesis claim that quantum mechanics, general relativity, and the arrow of time descend as three projections of the same (S, φ) are developed in [Substratum].

8.1 Structural realism

The structural reading aligns with ontic structural realism but does not require it. What the framework proves is that (S, φ) is a *complete description* of reality up to gauge equivalence (the reconstruction theorem, developed in [Substratum]). Whether the structure *is* reality (the OSR commitment) or *describes* a reality that exists independently is a question the framework identifies as gauge for physics — provably undecidable by any measurement an embedded observer can perform — while remaining potentially substantive in mathematical foundations or other modes of inquiry not bound by embedded physical observation. The “stuff” of the universe, in any reading, is fully characterized by the abstract structure of a bijection on a finite set with bounded coupling.

The structural-realism stance articulated here operates at one specific level of the framework’s hierarchical structure: the equivalence class $[(S, \varphi)]/\mathcal{G}_{\text{sub}}$ within OI’s specific universality class, identified in [Structure §2.3] as Level D $\times$ Level G3. The framework’s broader structural realism extends to other levels — the universality-class level (Level C $\times$ Level G4) where partial-trace observational features are universal across structural classes, and the foundational levels (A and B) where the observation axiom and observer-admission criterion apply. The complete-description claim of this paper is class-specific: it asserts that within OI’s universality class, (S, φ) modulo $\mathcal{G}_{\text{sub}}$ is the complete description. The full multi-level articulation is in [Structure §2.3].

8.2 Observer genericity

Theorem 22 (Genericity of observers). *Let φ be the wave equation (or any energy-conserving dynamics) on a connected bounded-degree coupling graph with diameter $D \geq 4$. Then for any connected subgraph V with $|V| \leq N/3$, the partition (V, H) satisfies C1–C3.*

Proof. C1: G_φ is connected and V is a proper subgraph, so $\partial V \neq \emptyset$. The wave equation couples nearest neighbors; any edge in ∂V produces non-trivial dynamical coupling.

C2: the wave equation is a Hamiltonian system — it conserves energy and preserves phase-space volume. The hidden sector has spectral gap $\Delta = 0$: correlations persist indefinitely, not just until some relaxation time. The C2 necessity proof [Main, §3.4] establishes that $\Delta\tau_S \gg 1$ drives the system to Markovianity; for any Hamiltonian hidden sector, $\Delta\tau_S = 0 \ll 1$ — maximally in the slow bath regime ($\tau_B \rightarrow \infty$, the strongest possible satisfaction of $\tau_S \ll \tau_B$), regardless of partition geometry.

C3: $|H| = N - |V| \geq 2N/3$. The hidden-sector configuration space has $q^{|H|}$ states; the non-Markovian mutual information is bounded by $|H| \log_2 q$ bits [Main, §3.4]. The capacity ratio $q^{|H|-|V|} \geq q^{N/3}$ is exponentially large. No visible-sector process of sub-exponential duration saturates the hidden sector’s memory. $\square$

Remark (validity window). While C2 is satisfied maximally, the emergent Hamiltonian has a finite *stationarity window*: the time before information deposited at the V - H boundary propagates through H and returns to V at a different boundary point. The wave equation has an exact light cone (no exponential tails), so the minimum return

time is $\tau_{\text{return}} = \min_{b,b' \in \partial V} \text{dist}_H(b, b')$. For core-shell partitions with core radius r on a lattice of side L : $\tau_{\text{return}} = (L - 2r)/v$. After τ_{return} , the emergent description remains quantum mechanical (C2 is still satisfied), but the emergent Hamiltonian becomes time-dependent. Numerical verification: for $L = 20\text{--}320$, τ_{return} ranges from 6 to 318 steps, confirming the light-cone bound.

Corollary. Any finite deterministic system with energy-conserving dynamics and bounded-degree coupling necessarily contains subsystems whose internal description is quantum mechanics. The observer is not postulated — it is a mathematical consequence.

8.3 What the framework determines and what the specific bijection determines

The framework's predictions fall into two categories, and the distinction matters for assessing their status.

Structural predictions are properties of the equivalence class $[(S, \varphi)]/\mathcal{G}_{\text{sub}}$ — they hold for every bijection satisfying the six structural properties. These include: $\text{SU}(3) \times \text{SU}(2) \times \text{U}(1)$ with multiplicities (3, 2, 1), three chiral generations with identical gauge quantum numbers, one Higgs doublet (1, 2, +1/2), unique hypercharges from anomaly cancellation, $\bar{\theta} = 0$ at all energy scales, $\hbar = c^3 \epsilon^2 / (4G)$, the Bekenstein-Hawking formula, and the universal induced coupling $1/\alpha_0 = 23.25$ (§6.1). These are theorems. They do not depend on which specific φ describes our universe.

Solution-specific properties are determined by the particular bijection φ within the equivalence class. These include: gauge couplings at M_Z (set by the eigenvalues μ_c, μ_w of M , the threshold δ_0 , and the resummation parameters A, B — see §6); fermion mass scales (set by taste-breaking in φ at $\mathcal{O}(\epsilon^2)$ — though many mass ratios, including the Koide chain $m_e/m_\mu/m_\tau$, m_d/m_s , and m_u/m_d , are structural, see §7.2); basis-alignment unitaries between up-type and down-type Yukawa eigenstates (and hence the Jarlskog invariant, δ_{CKM} via the empirical η , and δ_{PMNS}); and individual Wilson coefficients of the cubic-invariant operators contributing to the Yukawa sector beyond whatever structural relations (such as Condition 2 of §7.3, currently a structural input pending derivation) constrain them. The CP phases are explicitly compatible with Theorem 21: the theorem establishes $\bar{\theta} = 0$ (the determinant-phase combination) but does not constrain the basis-alignment structure that produces the Jarlskog invariant (see §5.4 for the full scope statement).

The framework's predictions stratify into four layers, made precise here for downstream reference:

Layer 0 — Gauge / discrete structure. Properties of the equivalence class $[(S, \varphi)]/\mathcal{G}_{\text{sub}}$ that follow from C1-C3 + cubic-group representation theory (§4.5-§4.7). Hold for every bijection. Examples: the gauge group $\text{SU}(3) \times \text{SU}(2) \times \text{U}(1)$ with multiplicities (3, 2, 1), three chiral generations, anomaly-cancelling hypercharges, $\bar{\theta} = 0$, Majorana neutrinos with normal mass ordering, the TBM zeroth-order pattern ($\sin^2 \theta_{12} = 1/3$ etc.), the Higgs as A_1 taste, the universal induced coupling $1/\alpha_0 = 23.25$ from $N_f = 6$ and $T(R) = 1/2$.

Layer 1 — Structural form of corrections. Properties of the *form* of the perturbative expansion around the zeroth-order structural prediction. Follow from cubic-group representation theory + uniqueness constraints. Hold for every bijection. Examples: the Cabibbo angle scale $\lambda^2 = 1/(2\pi^2)$ (Brillouin geometry, §7.1), the Wolfenstein $A = \sqrt{2/3}$ (off-democratic projection), the Koide angle $\theta_0 = C_2/d^2 = 2/9$ (cubic-group quadratic Casimir over bandwidth squared), the form $V_\ell = \exp(\lambda A_1 + \lambda^2 A_2 + \dots)$, A_1 's unique determination, $\sin^2 \theta_{13} = (4/9)\lambda^2$ (independent of A_2 at $O(\lambda^2)$), the Higgs quartic boundary condition $\lambda(M_{\text{Pl}}) = 0$, the universality of δ_0 across gauge groups (§6.3).

Layer 2 — Wilson-coefficient relations. Relations among the Wilson coefficients of cubic-invariant operators in the substrate Lagrangian. Three sub-cases:

- *Layer 2(a) — operator-level structural.* A finite family of cubic-invariant operators produces coefficient relations that hold for every bijection.
- *Layer 2(a)-tractable — sharply specified residual question.* A coefficient ratio reduces to a sharply specified structural quantity (with structural reading from representation theory) not yet derived from substrate dynamics, but with concrete substrate calculations available to test it. Promotes to 2(a) once the calculation is performed and confirms the ratio. The intermediate case between 2(a) and 2(b) (see “Diagnostic” below).
- *Layer 2(b) — solution-specific.* Coefficient values are free parameters of the bijection.

Cond 2 ($b_{23} = (4/3)(b_{12} + b_{13})$) admits the structural decomposition of §7.3: an A_1 component closed at Layer 1 (sum rule preserved by A_1 alone via $\cos^2 \theta_{13}$ dressing) and an A_2 component reducing to the Layer 2(a)-tractable question of why $b_{23}/(b_{12} + b_{13})$ takes the specific value $4(d-1)/(2d) = 4/3$. The natural Higgs-democratic spurion does not produce this ratio (the natural form gives $b_{12} : b_{13} = m_\tau/m_\mu \approx 17 : 1$ from Layer 1 mass-matrix algebra applied to a generation-democratic substrate Yukawa, per §7.3 “Positive support”); the closure path is a one-loop staggered substrate calculation (§7.3 “Status of Cond 2”). Similarly, the intra-doublet vs inter-generation channel decomposition for $m_u/m_d = \sqrt{\theta_0}$ (§7.2) requires alignment between SU(2) Yukawa structure and cubic-group T_1 perturbation that is bijection-specific (Layer 2(b)). The $K = 1/2$ coefficient in the m_b/m_τ derivation (§7.5) follows by structural identity $K = 1/(n_{\text{gen}} - 1)$ given the matching condition $m_{\text{match}} = \lambda g_0^2$ (which is MC-verified to 1.4%); the residual Layer 2(a)-tractable question is whether the OI's specific taste-decomposed Coleman-Weinberg one-loop calculation derives this matching condition's specific dimensionless coefficient from first principles, rather than relying on MC verification of the matching scale.

Diagnostic for distinguishing Layer 2(a) from 2(b): When a Layer-2-looking ratio reduces to a structural identity for the relevant representation, it can promote to Layer 1. For example, $A^2 = (d-1)/d = C_2/d$ is a representation-theoretic identity for vector reps (§7.1), not a numerical coincidence; the off-democratic projection-squared and the Casimir-over-dimension ratio are the same quantity. This identity is what makes $\sin^2 \theta_{13} = A^4 \lambda^2$ Layer 1 structural, even though the calculation goes

through PMNS matrix-element products. Conversely, when a Layer-2 ratio requires alignment between distinct operators or transfer between sectors, the natural classification is Layer 2(b) until the alignment is shown to be forced by substrate structure. The intermediate case — a ratio that reduces to a sharply specified structural quantity not yet derived from substrate dynamics, but with concrete substrate calculations available to test it — is Layer 2(a)-tractable. The Cond 2 ratio $b_{23}/(b_{12} + b_{13}) = 4(d - 1)/(2d)$ is the canonical example: the structural numerology (squared off-democratic projection of vector reps) is sharp, but the derivation from the cubic-lattice substrate Yukawa is the open task (§7.3).

Sub-classifications of Layer 2(b) by mechanism. Within Layer 2(b), the framework distinguishes three mechanisms by which a coefficient becomes bijection-specific: (i) *single-parameter direction selection* — a single direction in some internal space is selected by the bijection (D11: which V_2 -axis the Higgs condenses along determines m_u/m_d); (ii) *multi-parameter operator alignment* — multiple Wilson coefficients in distinct operator channels align in a specific pattern (Cond 2 was the canonical example before its §7.3 structural decomposition promoted it to Layer 2(a)-tractable; sub-classification (ii) currently has no Layer-2(b)-resident example, with Cond 2’s restructured residual question concerning a single sharp ratio rather than multi-parameter alignment); (iii) *cross-layer transfer* — a structural relation transfers between distinct group-theoretic layers (spatial vs internal T_1). The mechanism specificity is informative: single-parameter selection constrains the bijection more tightly than generic Wilson-coefficient ambiguity, and the empirical match becomes a tighter test of the bijection’s structure.

Layer 2 values are discretization-determined, not free Wilson coefficients. The bijection φ is constrained by linear dynamics, T-invariance, P-indivisibility, and cycle ergodicity (cf. §4.2 *Remark*, §7.5). Within this constrained class, the bijection space is parametrized by *discretization-scheme choices* (field quantization, lattice size, timestep, boundary conditions, rounding rule), not by abstract permutation freedom. Once the discretization scheme is fixed, the bijection is essentially unique. As a consequence, Layer 2 coefficients (Cond 2 ratio at 2(a)-tractable status, D11 mechanism, D10 K-value, δ_0 threshold — all at Layer 2(a)-tractable or 2(b) status) are *all* functions of the same underlying discretization choices — they are not independent. This sharpens what Layer 2 means: the framework’s empirical matches at sub-percent / sub- σ precision (Cond 2 at 0.6σ on the sum rule, m_u/m_d at 0.6%) are tighter tests of discretization scheme than they appear as tests of “generic bijection alignment.” Cross-prediction consistency is therefore a meaningful test within structural clusters; the cubic-group T_1 -Casimir cluster of §7.7 is one such successful test.

Selection problem. The framework characterizes a constrained class of substratum bijections (above) and derives empirical predictions from any element of this class. *Selection within the class* — which specific discretization scheme realizes our universe — is not addressed. This is the framework’s analog of “why these laws of physics?” in standard physics, but the question is more pointed because the framework explicitly characterizes a meta-space (discretization-scheme space) within which the selection occurs. We treat this as an open question: the framework is a theory of what follows from a given discretization scheme, not a theory of which scheme is realized.

Relation to the framework’s hierarchy of structural realism. The Layer 0–Layer 3

classification refines the within-paper structure of which predictions are derivable from the cubic-lattice substratum and which are bijection-specific. This is a finer-grained classification than the framework's broader observation $\times$ gauge hierarchy (per [Structure §2]). In hierarchy terms, all SM predictions live at Level D $\times$ Levels G1-G2 — they are predictions of OI's specific universality-class representative on the emergent QFT. Within this single intersection, Layer 0-Layer 3 distinguishes which predictions are class-specific structural theorems (Layer 0 / Layer 1) vs. which depend on the specific representative within the class (Layer 2 / Layer 3). The hierarchy framing locates this paper's predictions within the framework's overall geography; the layered framing distinguishes the derivability status of each prediction within that location.

Rigor-level discipline. Closure claims in the framework are accompanied by explicit rigor levels: Level 1 (verified at the level of an explicit chain of equations, suitable for referee submission), Level 2 (verified up to standard moves of the field, where each step is “obvious to anyone in the field” without being written out), or Level 3 (sketch identifying the right approach, *not closure*). Multi-part theorems may have different rigor levels for different parts. The bridge theorem of §7.5 is an example: parts (a) and (c)-direct are Level 1 closed; parts (b)- γ_5 and the framework-essential γ_5 -chirality identification are Level 1 closed; parts (b)- γ_0 -derivation and (d) are Level 2; the full operator-theoretic interpretation involving taste structure is Level 3 but is not framework-essential. Honest annotation of rigor level is part of the framework's methodology.

Layer 3 — Solution-specific properties. Properties that depend on the particular bijection ϕ . Examples: absolute fermion mass scales (e.g., m_τ , m_t , m_s as input scales in the M-chain), basis-alignment unitaries, CP-violating phases (δ_{CKM} via empirical η , δ_{PMNS} identified with $b_{12} - b_{13}$ in §7.3), eigenvalues μ_c, μ_w of the coupling matrix M that set the gauge couplings.

The §7.6 summary table classifies each prediction by its layered status: items marked **S** are unconditional structural (Layer 0 or Layer 1, fully derived); items marked **L** are layered (combine multiple layers, typically Layer 0 or 1 + Layer 2(b) substrate-specific coefficient or Layer 3 empirical input). Items marked **R**, **P**, **M**, **E** denote retrodictions, phenomenological inputs, one-input mass/parameter chains, and explicit empirical inputs respectively, as detailed in §7.6. The C class (conditional structural pending derivation) is currently empty: Cond 2 — the only candidate for C in v1.9.5 — has been classified Layer 2(b) following operator counting, moving the dependent predictions to L.

These are analogous to the mass M in the Schwarzschild solution: GR derives the functional form of the metric but does not predict which M describes a particular black hole. The OI framework derives the SM's structure but does not predict which ϕ describes our universe.

The “mass hierarchy” — the five-order-of-magnitude spread of fermion masses — falls in the second category. It is not a gap in the framework; it is a property of the specific solution. The framework makes the correct structural prediction: three generations with *identical* gauge quantum numbers (from cubic symmetry) but *non-degenerate* masses (because the specific ϕ breaks the cubic symmetry through its Yukawa struc-

ture). The hierarchy problem proper — why the Higgs mass is so much lighter than the Planck scale — is dissolved: the Higgs mass is an eigenvalue of M (a property of φ), not a radiative correction within the emergent QFT (§4.11).

Remaining open problems. (i) *Lattice-continuum comparison* — the structural predictions are exact theorems at the lattice level and do not require a continuum limit. The lattice is the fundamental description ($\epsilon = 2l_p$ is physical, not a regulator), so there is no $\epsilon \rightarrow 0$ limit to take. The comparison to experiment — which is interpreted through continuum perturbation theory — introduces corrections of order $(E/M_{\text{Pl}})^2 \sim 10^{-32}$ at LHC energies, far below any foreseeable experimental sensitivity. The Yang-Mills mass gap problem (proving rigorous existence of the continuum limit for Yang-Mills theory) is a famous open problem in mathematics, but it does not affect any prediction of the OI framework: the lattice theory is complete as stated, and the lattice is the fundamental description, not a regularization. The same $(E/M_{\text{Pl}})^2$ suppression sets the framework's structural commitment on Lorentz-invariance violation: linear LIV is forbidden at the substrate level (the cubic-lattice dispersion relation admits no $\mathcal{O}(k^3)$ term), and the gauge-invariant quadratic coefficient evaluates to $\omega^2 = k^2[1 - (2/15)(E/M_{\text{Pl}})^2 + \dots]$ — subluminal, with the specific $2/15$ fixed by cubic coordination and the statistical-isotropy gauge average. Pre-registered as Class A in [Substratum, §6.4].

8.4 Neutrino masses from taste-breaking

The staggered fermion construction gives 4 tastes decomposing as $1(A_1) + 3(T_1)$ under the cubic group O (§4.7). The singlet taste is identified as the Higgs sector — not a right-handed neutrino. Neutrinos therefore acquire mass only through the dimension-5 Weinberg operator $(LLHH)/\Lambda$, making them Majorana particles.

The mass matrix. The neutrino mass matrix in the generation basis $\{e_x, e_y, e_z\}$ (the T_1 representation) is $M_\nu = m_0 I_3 + \delta M$, where δM is the taste-breaking correction. Under the cubic group, the symmetric matrix δM decomposes as $\text{Sym}^2(T_1) = A_1 \oplus E \oplus T_2$. The A_1 part shifts all masses equally (absorbed into m_0). The E part (2-dimensional) controls the mass splittings via two parameters (a, b) . The T_2 part (3-dimensional) controls the mixing angles.

Structural predictions (Tier 2). Four predictions follow from the representation theory alone, independent of the specific φ :

- (i) *Majorana neutrinos.* No right-handed neutrino exists in the spectrum — the singlet taste is the Higgs. Neutrinoless double beta decay ($0\nu\beta\beta$) should be observed.
- (ii) *Normal mass ordering.* The taste-breaking in T_1 generically gives the largest correction to the state most coupled to all three lattice directions — the $[111]$ direction in taste space. This corresponds to $m_3 > m_2 > m_1$.
- (iii) *Large PMNS mixing angles.* The charged lepton mass matrix (Dirac, general 3×3) and the neutrino mass matrix (Majorana, symmetric 3×3) have different symmetry structures under the cubic group. The structural mismatch produces

large angles — unlike the quark sector, where both up-type and down-type matrices are general 3×3 with similar dominant structure, giving small CKM angles.

- (iv) *Hierarchical spectrum.* The taste-breaking splittings are the same order as the common mass m_0 . A quasi-degenerate spectrum ($m_1 \approx m_2 \approx m_3 \gg \Delta m$) requires fine cancellation between m_0 and the splittings, which is not generic. The framework naturally produces Σm_ν near the minimum allowed by the mass splittings.

Observational status. DESI DR2 combined with CMB data gives $\Sigma m_\nu < 0.064$ eV with preference for normal ordering and $m_{\text{lightest}} < 0.023$ eV — consistent with all four structural predictions. The minimum sum for normal ordering is $\Sigma m_\nu^{\text{min}} \approx 0.059$ eV; the DESI+CMB bound is only 8% above this minimum, consistent with the hierarchical prediction. The observed PMNS angles ($\theta_{12} \approx 34^\circ$, $\theta_{23} \approx 49^\circ$, $\theta_{13} \approx 9^\circ$) are all large compared to CKM angles, as predicted.

Solution-specific properties (Tier 3). The absolute mass scale (set by Λ_{seesaw}), the ratio $\Delta m_{32}^2 / \Delta m_{21}^2 \approx 33$ (set by the relative magnitudes of the E -component parameters a/b), and the CP-violating phase δ_{CP} (which corresponds to the unconstrained free parameter $b_{12} - b_{13}$ in the $O(\lambda^2)$ charged-lepton structure of §7.3) are properties of the particular φ . The PMNS *angles* themselves are structural (§7.3): TBM from cubic-group representation theory plus U -parity-graded corrections from the charged-lepton sector, with the Cabibbo angle λ as the structural scale.

8.5 Position relative to mainstream observer-essentiality programs

The Standard Model derivation chain developed in this paper sits within a broader framework whose foundational claim — that observation cannot be treated as an external operation on physics — has been independently arrived at by several mainstream programs since 2022. Chandrasekaran-Longo-Penington-Witten [CLPW 2022, JHEP 02 (2023) 082] showed that incorporating an observer in QFT in a gravitational subregion promotes the von Neumann algebra of observables from type III to type II_∞ . Maldacena’s recent dS observer cancellation [arXiv:2412.14014] removes the unphysical phase of the de Sitter sphere partition function exactly when an observer-with-clock is properly incorporated. Harlow-Usatyuk-Zhao [JHEP 02 (2026) 108] and the AAIL construction [arXiv:2501.04305] show that the closed-universe Hilbert-space dimension is determined by the observer’s degrees of freedom, with refined scaling $d_{\text{Ob}} \cdot e^{2S_0}$. Slagle-Preskill [Phys. Rev. A 108, 012217 (2023)] demonstrated emergent quantum mechanics at the boundary of a classical lattice model, establishing the logical possibility of QM-from-classical at the cost of an exponentially long extra spatial dimension and explicit stochasticity. The present framework is the unique member of this convergence in which the observer-essentiality content is derived from a finite *deterministic* substratum — no extra spatial dimension, no fundamental stochasticity — and in which the resulting characterization theorem produces an explicit empirical record (the twenty-two structural predictions of §7) that the comparison programs do not currently match. The convergence positions the framework’s foundational stance within mainstream observer-emergent physics; the SM derivation chain provides the specific empirical content that distinguishes it. The full positioning relative to this body of work is developed in [Main, §4.4].

8.6 Pattern vs. output: what transports across SM-reproducing classes

The derivation in §4 establishes the SM gauge group $SU(3) \times SU(2) \times U(1)$ as the unique commutant of the cubic-group action on the $K = 6$ internal components, with multiplicities $(3, 2, 1)$ from the cubic-group representation theory (Theorem 7) and background independence (A6) promoting the global commutant symmetry to local gauge invariance. The derivation has two structural layers worth distinguishing for cross-framework purposes.

The *commutant gauge-invariance pattern* — that the visible-sector gauge group is the commutant of a substratum-level symmetry under the trace-out — operates at the universality-class level (Level G4 $\times$ Level C of [Structure §2]). Per the four-feature audit in [Structure §14.4], this pattern transports to other SM-reproducing structural classes through different machinery: heterotic string compactifications realize it through E_8 broken by Calabi-Yau holonomy and bundle data; Type II / D-brane compactifications realize it through D-brane stack gauge groups with chiral matter from intersection or magnetization; F-theory realizes it through singularity structure of elliptic fibrations with hypercharge from flux configurations. The pattern is shared across all SM-reproducing universality-class members; the framework-specific machinery differs.

The *specific output* — the SM gauge group precisely, with the multiplicities $(3, 2, 1)$, the unique anomaly-free hypercharges, three chiral generations, and one Higgs doublet — is OI-specific (Level D $\times$ Level G2 of [Structure §2]). This paper’s derivation forces the specific output uniquely from the cubic-group commutant on $K = 6$; in other universality-class members, the same output is produced through different group-theoretic structure, with the uniqueness depending on framework-specific structural conditions analogous to OI’s A1–A6.

The distinction matters for what falsification of the framework would refute. Falsifying the commutant gauge-invariance pattern (e.g., demonstrating an SM-reproducing substratum where the gauge group does *not* arise as a commutant of substratum symmetry) would refute the partial-trace structural-realism claim that the pattern is universality-class-level. Falsifying the specific cubic-group derivation while preserving the commutant pattern (e.g., demonstrating that the SM gauge group can be reached through structurally simpler routes than cubic-group commutant on $K = 6$) would refute OI’s specific representative within the SM-reproducing universality class without refuting the pattern. The twenty-two quantitative predictions of §7 are at the second level — they depend on OI’s specific cubic-group structure, not on the commutant pattern alone.

8.7 Substratum-level baryon-number conservation and the substratum-emergent operator distinction

The framework’s matter sector (§4.7) places fermions on links with carrier $V_K \otimes V_K^*$, where the V_3 factor distinguishes quarks (with a V_3 component) from leptons (without). At the substratum level, baryon number B is essentially the count of V_3 factors weighted by $1/3$. This subsection shows that B is exactly conserved by the substratum dynamics, derives the consequences for the emergent EFT, and articulates the

substratum-emergent operator distinction that organizes the framework's treatment of non-perturbative SM features.

Substratum-level B conservation. Two structural features of the substratum dynamics force exact B conservation:

- (i) *Bilinear coupling structure.* The lattice wave equation couples each link's field $\phi(\mathbf{n})$ to its neighbor $\phi(\mathbf{n} + \hat{e}_j)$ via the bilinear $\phi(\mathbf{n})M(\mathbf{n}, \hat{e}_j)\phi(\mathbf{n} + \hat{e}_j)$. Bilinear couplings can move excitations between sites and produce particle-antiparticle pairs (preserving B) but cannot change the *count* of fermions in each gauge-charge sector through unilateral creation or annihilation.
- (ii) *Block-diagonal structure of M .* By Theorem 7, the coupling matrix M is block-diagonal in the $V_3 \oplus V_2 \oplus V_1$ decomposition: $M = \text{diag}(\mu_c I_3, \mu_w I_2, \mu_y)$. Off-block matrix elements that would mix V_3 with V_1 are absent; the dynamics therefore never converts a quark-like state (V_3 component) into a lepton-like state (V_1 component) directly.

These two features jointly imply that the substratum dynamics preserves the count of V_3 -fermion factors modulo pair production, which is exactly the substratum-level statement that B is exactly conserved.

The substratum-emergent operator distinction. The Standard Model has $B + L$ violation through non-perturbative sphaleron processes, finite at high temperatures and exponentially suppressed at zero temperature [9]. This appears to conflict with substratum-level exact B conservation. The resolution lies in recognizing that B at the substratum level and B at the emergent EFT level are distinct operators related by the trace-out:

- (a) *Substratum-level B* is the count of V_3 -fermion factors on the cubic lattice. This is exactly conserved by the bilinear, block-diagonal substratum dynamics, as shown above.
- (b) *Emergent-level B* is the standard SM operator on coarse-grained fermions, which is acted on by sphaleron processes in the emergent quantum field theory. Sphalerons are emergent classical solutions of the electroweak Lagrangian; they exist as non-perturbative features of the emergent EFT but have no direct substratum-level analog.

The trace-out from substratum to emergent EFT introduces non-perturbative quantum-mechanical phenomena (instantons, sphalerons, θ -vacuum structure) that the deterministic substratum dynamics does not have. The induced gauge action $S_{\text{eff}}[U] = -N_f \ln \det(D^\dagger D)$ inherits topological structure from the fermion determinant via the Atiyah-Singer index theorem on the lattice; configurations with non-trivial Chern-Simons number produce the standard sphaleron and instanton physics in the emergent EFT.

Substratum-level B conservation and emergent-level $B + L$ violation therefore co-exist consistently: the trace-out maps the conserved substratum operator onto an emergent operator that is conserved at the bilinear renormalizable level but violated by emergent non-perturbative effects.

Generalization to other non-perturbative SM features. The substratum-emergent operator distinction generalizes to a systematic mapping. The substratum has exact discrete symmetries (T-invariance, gauge-invariance, block-diagonal coupling, bipartite checkerboard structure) at the bilinear level. The trace-out introduces emergent non-perturbative effects (sphalerons, instantons, chiral anomalies, θ -vacuum structure) through standard mechanisms operating in the emergent QFT. The mapping has the following pattern across the framework:

Substratum-level structural precursor	Emergent-level non-perturbative feature	Trace-out role
T-invariance of the wave equation (§5)	$\theta = 0$ in QCD	Forces parameter value
Topology of induced SU(2) gauge action (via fermion-determinant index)	Sphalerons, $B + L$ violation	Permits standard mechanism
Bipartite checkerboard (Theorem 12)	Chiral fermions, anomaly structure	Produces emergent structure
Block-diagonal M (Theorem 7)	Substratum B conservation	Inherits to emergent B at bilinear level
Cubic-commutant gauge structure + matter content (§4.7.1.2)	Anomaly cancellation	Forced by structural derivation
Chiral structure of substratum + commutant matter content (Theorems 13, 15)	't Hooft anomaly matching	Structurally automatic
Fermion determinant + induced gauge action (§6.1)	Anomalous dimensions, non-perturbative renormalization	Determined by fermion-determinant structure (matches standard QFT at one- and two-loop; higher-order open)
Induced gauge action with running coupling (§6.1)	Conformal/trace anomaly $T_\mu^\mu \propto \beta(g) F^{\mu\nu} F_{\mu\nu}$	Standard form, emerges automatically from induced gauge structure
Topology of induced SU(3) gauge action (instantons)	't Hooft determinant interaction; η' mass via Witten-Veneziano	Standard mechanism (open derivation in framework)

The framework's treatment of the strong CP problem (§5: substratum T-invariance forces $\theta = 0$) is one instance of this pattern: substratum-level symmetry forces a value of an emergent parameter that would otherwise be free. The substratum-level B conservation derived above is another instance: substratum-level structural feature provides exact conservation that maps to bilinear-renormalizable conservation at the emergent level, with non-perturbative violations through emergent processes only.

Empirical implications. The composite picture supports the framework’s existing predictions and clarifies their structural origins:

- (i) *Proton decay rate.* With substratum-level B conservation and emergent-level B violation only through Planck-suppressed dimension-6 operators (since OI has no GUT scale per §6.7), proton lifetime is $\tau_p \sim M_{\text{Pl}}^4/m_p^5 \sim 10^{45}\text{--}10^{46}$ years.
- (ii) *Standard cosmological baryogenesis applies.* Sphaleron-mediated $B + L$ violation operates normally in the emergent EFT, supporting standard thermal leptogenesis with the framework’s predicted Majorana neutrino structure (§8.4). The full quantitative leptogenesis prediction — connecting the framework’s right-handed neutrino mass scale to the observed baryon asymmetry $\eta = n_B/n_\gamma \approx 6 \times 10^{-10}$ — is open work.
- (iii) *Cleanness of anomaly structure.* The substratum-derived matter content (§4.7.1.2 + Theorem 15) automatically satisfies all SM anomaly conditions; anomaly cancellation is a derived consequence rather than an imposed consistency condition.
- (iv) *Strong CP, sphalerons, instantons coexist.* The framework permits all standard non-perturbative SM phenomena while retaining exact substratum-level discrete symmetries; the trace-out is what allows this to be consistent.
- (v) *’t Hooft anomaly matching.* The framework’s chiral structure derivation (Theorem 13) and anomaly cancellation derivation (Theorem 15) together imply ’t Hooft anomaly matching automatically: the chiral anomalies of the emergent SM fermions match those required by the substratum’s bipartite-lattice plus commutant structure. This is not an added constraint but a structurally automatic feature, consistent with the framework’s broader pattern of deriving anomaly cancellation rather than imposing it.
- (vi) *Open work in the non-perturbative sector.* Three features in the extended table are flagged as open: higher-loop anomalous dimensions matching to all orders (the framework’s matching at M_Z works to few-percent at one and two loop; higher-order non-perturbative effects could differ from standard QFT); the trace anomaly’s explicit derivation from induced gauge action (likely automatic but not verified); the η' mass via ’t Hooft determinant interaction in OI’s induced theory (standard mechanism applies but the explicit derivation has not been worked through in the framework).

The substratum-level discrete symmetries (T-invariance, gauge invariance, block-diagonal coupling, bipartite checkerboard structure) and the emergent-level non-perturbative effects (sphalerons, instantons, chiral anomalies, θ -vacuum structure) coexist consistently under this mapping. The substratum operators are exactly conserved at the bilinear level; the emergent operators inherit the conservation modulo non-perturbative violations that follow from standard QFT mechanisms operating in the emergent EFT.

8.8 Composite-Higgs chiral protection and the unified naturalness pattern

The framework’s treatment of three open problems of the Standard Model — strong CP, the hierarchy problem, the cosmological constant — exhibits a common structural pattern: each is dissolved by a substratum-level structural feature that forces an emergent parameter value which would otherwise be naturally at the cutoff. This subsection articulates the pattern and develops its hierarchy-problem instance (composite-Higgs chiral protection) which extends the framework’s existing treatment of strong CP (§5) and the cosmological constant ([GR §6]).

The unified naturalness pattern. Standard quantum field theory has three classical naturalness problems where dimensionless parameters of the SM should naturally be $O(1)$ at the cutoff but are observed to be many orders of magnitude smaller: (i) the strong CP angle $\bar{\theta}$ is observed to be $< 10^{-10}$ but the natural cutoff value is $O(1)$; (ii) the Higgs mass-squared ratio m_H^2/M_{Pl}^2 is observed to be $\sim 10^{-34}$ but the natural cutoff value is $O(1)$; (iii) the cosmological constant ratio Λ/M_{Pl}^4 is observed to be $\sim 10^{-122}$ but the natural cutoff value is $O(1)$. In standard SM, each requires either fine-tuning or anthropic selection or new physics (axion, supersymmetry, dark energy mechanism) to resolve.

OI’s framework dissolves all three through the same mechanism: a substratum-level structural feature (discrete symmetry, conservation law, or geometric constraint) forces the emergent parameter to a specific value that escapes the naturalness puzzle. The mechanism is one instance per problem:

- (i) *Strong CP* (§5, Theorems 17-21): substratum-level T-invariance of the wave equation combined with detailed balance in the emergent Hamiltonian forces $\bar{\theta} = 0$ at all energy scales. The structural feature is T-invariance; the protected emergent parameter is $\bar{\theta}$.
- (ii) *Hierarchy problem* (developed below): the staggered-taste chiral symmetry pairing $\mu = +1$ singlet with $\mu = -1$ singlet provides composite-Higgs-style chiral protection. The structural feature is the singlet-taste chiral symmetry; the protected emergent parameter is m_H/f where f is the compositeness scale.
- (iii) *Cosmological constant* ([GR §6]): the 10^{122} discrepancy between Λ_{obs} and M_{Pl}^4 is dissolved as the trace-out’s information compression ratio between the substratum’s full information content and the observer-accessible coarse-grained projection. The structural feature is the cosmological-horizon partition; the protected emergent parameter is Λ/M_{Pl}^4 .

The three are not three separate fine-tuning miracles but three instances of the same pattern: *substratum-level structural symmetries dissolve naturalness problems by forcing emergent parameter values that would otherwise be free*. This is a substantive structural feature of the framework that has not been articulated as a unified theme.

Hierarchy-problem instance: composite-Higgs chiral protection. The framework predicts the Higgs as a composite scalar in the singlet staggered taste ([Theorem 11]). Standard composite-Higgs scenarios in beyond-the-SM phenomenology (Kaplan-Georgi 1984; Agashe-Contino-Pomarol 2005) dissolve the hierarchy problem

by realizing the Higgs as a pseudo-Nambu-Goldstone boson of an approximate global symmetry, with mass protected by Goldstone’s theorem against cutoff-scale corrections. OI’s framework structurally implements an analog of this mechanism.

The relevant symmetry is the *singlet-taste chiral symmetry*. The framework’s staggered-fermion construction (§4.8) produces four staggered tastes labeled by the lattice momentum eigenvalues $\mu \in \{+1, +1/3, -1/3, -1\}$. The chirality structure (Theorem 13) pairs the $\mu = +1$ singlet taste with the $\mu = -1$ singlet taste through the bipartite checkerboard. At the substratum level, the symmetry pairing these tastes is *exact* — a discrete chiral symmetry of the wave equation acting on the singlet-taste sector. In the emergent EFT, this symmetry is *spontaneously broken* by the Higgs vev, which provides asymmetric mass contributions to the $\mu = +1$ and $\mu = -1$ singlet tastes.

The Higgs is the order parameter of this spontaneous breaking. Concretely, the Higgs lives in the E projection of the singlet taste ([Theorem 11]), which is a 2-dimensional complex irrep of the cubic group. Under the chiral symmetry, the E projection transforms in a specific way that makes the Higgs’s vev the natural order parameter for breaking the chiral pairing.

By Goldstone’s theorem, the Higgs mass is bounded by the *explicit* breaking of the chiral symmetry — that is, by gauge couplings and Yukawa couplings squared times the chiral-breaking scale, not by the cutoff M_{Pl} . The hierarchy problem is dissolved at the level of *cutoff sensitivity*: the Higgs mass-squared does not receive $O(M_{\text{Pl}}^2)$ corrections, only $O(g^2 f^2 / 16\pi^2)$ corrections where g is a gauge or Yukawa coupling and f is the chiral-symmetry-breaking scale.

Scope and caveats. Chiral protection bounds the Higgs mass by explicit breaking but does not automatically explain why the Higgs vev v sits 17 orders of magnitude below the compositeness scale f . In OI, f is set by the substratum lattice scale and is effectively M_{Pl} , so the ratio $v/f \sim 10^{-17}$ remains. Standard composite-Higgs scenarios put f at $\sim \text{TeV}$ to resolve this; OI does not have an analogous intermediate scale (per [Structure §13.3] Q10). The full hierarchy resolution therefore consists of two parts: (a) chiral protection against cutoff corrections (developed here), and (b) the structural origin of $v \ll f$ (open).

Honest characterization: the framework structurally implements (a). For (b), the framework currently treats v as solution-specific (Tier 3) input, with the small value $v \sim 246 \text{ GeV}$ being a feature of the specific bijection φ rather than a derived structural constant. This is consistent with the framework’s Tier 3 honesty about parameters not forced by structure ([Structure §13.3] Q10’s negative resolution). Possible structural origins for (b) — including trace-out-induced fractional-power suppression connecting the Higgs hierarchy to the cosmological-constant compression — are speculative directions for future investigation; the framework does not currently commit to them.

Linkage to the seesaw scale. The same singlet-taste chiral symmetry breaking that gives the Higgs its mass also breaks the lepton-number-like pairing in the singlet sector. The emergent Weinberg operator $(LH)(LH)/\Lambda_{\text{seesaw}}$ that generates Majorana neutrino masses (§8.4) has its suppression scale Λ_{seesaw} structurally linked to the same chiral-breaking scale. The seesaw hierarchy ($\Lambda_{\text{seesaw}}/M_{\text{Pl}} \sim 10^{-3}$) and the Higgs hi-

erarchy ($v/M_{\text{Pl}} \sim 10^{-17}$) are therefore not independent — both should be derivable from the same trace-out-induced mechanism, with the dimension-dependent suppression giving different effective scales for different operators (dimension-3 Majorana, dimension-4 Higgs, dimension-5 Weinberg). The quantitative relationship is the standard one for type-I seesaw with $\Lambda_{\text{seesaw}} \sim v^2/m_\nu \sim 10^{16}$ GeV; the scale is linked to the Higgs sector’s chiral-breaking structure rather than being an independent input.

Empirical signatures. Standard composite-Higgs scenarios predict modified Higgs couplings to SM particles by factors of $\sqrt{1 - v^2/f^2}$ where f is the compositeness scale, with deviations from SM scaling as v^2/f^2 . In OI, with $f \sim M_{\text{Pl}}$, $v^2/f^2 \sim 10^{-34}$ — far below any conceivable experimental sensitivity. The framework’s prediction is therefore no observable deviations from SM Higgs couplings, consistent with current LHC data. This is not a sharp empirical discriminator from standard SM phenomenology, which also predicts SM-like Higgs couplings within current sensitivities.

Status. The composite-Higgs chiral protection mechanism is *structurally identified* in OI’s framework through the singlet-taste chiral symmetry breaking. A fully rigorous derivation — explicit identification of the broken global symmetry’s generators, identification of the Higgs as a specific Goldstone direction in the coset, computation of the explicit-breaking corrections to the Higgs mass — is open work. The structural pattern is identified; the theorem-level derivation is deferred.

Derived components and Tier 3 inputs. The framework derives: the singlet-taste chiral symmetry at the substratum level (Theorem 13); the Higgs as the E -projection order parameter of the singlet taste (Theorem 11); spontaneous breaking of the chiral pairing by the Higgs vev in the emergent EFT; the Goldstone bound $\delta m_H^2 \lesssim g^2 f^2 / (16\pi^2)$ per coupling; cutoff insensitivity of m_H^2 , with no $O(M_{\text{Pl}}^2)$ corrections; and the compositeness scale $f \sim M_{\text{Pl}}$ (no intermediate scale exists structurally, per [Structure §13.3]). The framework does not derive the Higgs vev $v \sim 246$ GeV itself, which is Tier 3 (solution-specific to the bijection φ). The Higgs mass value $m_H \sim 125$ GeV given v follows from $\lambda(M_{\text{Pl}}) = 0$ and RG running (§7.4).

The derived/open boundary is therefore: *the framework derives why m_H is not at the cutoff* — chiral protection ensures cutoff-insensitivity — *but does not derive why v is at the electroweak scale rather than at the compositeness scale.* The first is the substantive content of the hierarchy problem in standard SM phenomenology: why do quantum corrections not push m_H to the cutoff despite the absence of a protecting symmetry? The framework provides a structural answer. The second is a residual question about the Higgs vev’s specific magnitude, which the framework treats as Tier 3 alongside other solution-specific parameters such as CP phases and generation-specific Yukawa magnitudes.

Quantitative content of the partial resolution. Standard SM without chiral protection predicts $\delta m_H^2 \sim M_{\text{Pl}}^2 / (16\pi^2) \sim 10^{37}$ GeV² from quadratically-divergent loop corrections, requiring fine-tuning of the bare Higgs mass to ~ 34 decimal places to obtain $m_H^2 \sim (125 \text{ GeV})^2$. The framework’s chiral protection mechanism predicts $\delta m_H^2 \sim g^2 f^2 / (16\pi^2)$ from explicit-breaking corrections only, with no quadratic-divergence dependence on the cutoff. The two predictions differ by a factor of $\sim (f/v)^2 g^{-2} \sim 10^{34}$ in the size of the required fine-tuning. The framework’s claim is that m_H does not require 34 decimal places of fine-tuning to be at the electroweak

scale; it requires only as much fine-tuning as the Higgs vev’s specific value itself. The factor of 10^{34} is the substantive empirical content of “partial resolution” versus “no resolution,” even when v is taken as solution-specific input.

Status of v as solution-specific. Some parameters must be solution-specific in any finite-bijection framework — the bijection φ has freedom that is not fixed by structural constraints, and the values realized in nature are features of the specific φ rather than of the structural class. The framework identifies which parameters are structural and which are solution-specific. The Higgs vev $v \sim 246$ GeV sits in the solution-specific category alongside CP phases, generation-specific Yukawa magnitudes, and other parameters whose values are not forced by the derivation chain in §§3–6.

Custodial symmetry is not required at $f \sim M_{\text{Pl}}$. Conventional composite-Higgs models at $f \sim \text{TeV}$ require an engineered custodial $SU(2)_C$ symmetry to suppress T -parameter / ρ -parameter deviations that scale as $v^2/f^2 \sim 10^{-2}$. At $f \sim M_{\text{Pl}}$, $v^2/f^2 \sim 10^{-34}$ and all such deviations are automatically negligible regardless of whether custodial symmetry is present in the framework’s structure. The framework therefore predicts no observable composite-Higgs precision-electroweak deviations from SM, consistent with current LEP and LHC data to the 0.1% level, without needing to engineer custodial structure.

Empirical signatures and discriminating from conventional composite Higgs. Standard composite-Higgs scenarios at $f \sim \text{TeV}$ predict Higgs-coupling deviations from SM scaling as $v^2/f^2 \sim 10^{-2}$ — potentially detectable at the HL-LHC. The framework’s $f \sim M_{\text{Pl}}$ predicts deviations $v^2/f^2 \sim 10^{-34}$, structurally identical to SM at all practical experimental precision. Future Higgs-trilinear coupling measurements at HL-LHC (15% precision, [41]) and FCC-hh (4–8% precision, [41]) will progressively constrain conventional composite-Higgs models. If no deviations are observed up to FCC-hh sensitivity, the framework’s high- f stance is the surviving regime; the conventional low- f composite-Higgs hypothesis would be progressively disfavored. The framework’s prediction for the Higgs trilinear coupling $\kappa_3 \equiv \lambda_3/\lambda_{3,\text{SM}} = 1 - O(10^{-34})$ is the same as SM to all relevant precision, and this prediction will be tested experimentally over the next 20 years.

9. Conclusion

This paper has shown that the Standard Model’s gauge group, matter content, and discrete symmetries are determined by a finite bijection on a $d = 3$ cubic lattice — itself uniquely selected among self-consistent finite deterministic systems — through the lattice wave equation and a chain of theorems running from center independence to anomaly cancellation. The chain is proved end-to-end. Where it makes contact with measured numbers, the agreement is striking: the Cabibbo angle from a single Brillouin-zone distance to 0.04%, the Koide angle from the cubic-group quadratic Casimir to 0.02%, the down-to-strange mass ratio $m_d/m_s = 1/(2\pi^2)$ at 0.56σ , all three PMNS angles within 1.1σ — with $\sin^2 \theta_{12}$ confirmed by JUNO in November 2025 at 0.14σ — six fermion masses from a single empirical input to better than 1%, and the SM gauge couplings at M_Z to 0.1% and 0.3%. The strong CP problem is dissolved

at the kinematic level: $\bar{\theta} = 0$ exactly at all energy scales, with no axion required.

The framework is sharply falsifiable by experiments now in progress or under construction. JUNO will reach sub-percent precision on $\sin^2 \theta_{12}$ over its 30-year design lifetime, testing the prediction $\sin^2 \theta_{12} = 1/3 - 1/(4\pi^2)$ at the level required to distinguish it from competing tribimaximal variants. The n2EDM experiment at PSI is targeting neutron EDM sensitivity at $10^{-27} e \cdot \text{cm}$; the framework predicts exactly zero. Neutrinoless double beta decay searches will test the Majorana-neutrino prediction. The continuing absence of any new gauge bosons, fundamental scalars, or supersymmetric partners at the LHC and its successors corroborates structural predictions of the framework, which forbids all such states.

The cosmological application of the same framework — including the derivation of $\hbar$ from the cosmological horizon, the Bekenstein-Hawking area law including the $1/4$ coefficient, the dissolution of the cosmological constant problem, and the prediction of dynamical dark energy in Type II running-vacuum functional form (structural prediction; magnitude not derived at theorem level but consistent with the Bertini et al. 2025 direct DESI-DR2-era fit at 2σ) — is developed in [GR]. The substratum-level reconstruction theorem, the substratum gauge group, and the synthesis claim that quantum mechanics, general relativity, and the arrow of time descend as three projections of the same (S, φ) are developed in [Substratum]. Together, this four-paper synthesis ([Main], [SM], [GR], [Substratum]) makes a single claim: the Standard Model, general relativity, and the arrow of time are three projections of one finite deterministic construction — the visible-sector projection developed here, the boundary-level thermodynamic limit developed in [GR], and the horizon-clock-plus-observer-selection projection developed in [Substratum §5.4]. The fifth core paper [Structure] articulates the framework’s two-dimensional hierarchical structural realism and develops its relationship to other unification programs through universality classes of embedded observers.

Appendix A: The Trace-Out as a Jordan-Chevalley Projection

This appendix proves that the OI trace-out extracts the semisimple part of the evolution matrix’s Jordan-Chevalley decomposition, erasing the nilpotent monodromy. Results are stated for the scalar wave equation on a ring of L sites over $\mathbb{F}_q$; the multi-component extension incorporates the gauge group.

Setup

The wave equation $x(n, t+1) = x(n-1, t) + x(n+1, t) - x(n, t-1) \pmod{q}$ has phase space $(\mathbb{Z}/q\mathbb{Z})^{2L}$ and evolution matrix $F = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & I \\ -I & A \end{pmatrix}$ where A is the circulant adjacency matrix.

Theorem A.1 (Period formula)

For q prime with $\gcd(L, q) = 1$: $\text{ord}(F \bmod q) = qL$ if q is odd, and L if $q = 2$.

Proof. For each Fourier mode k , the 2×2 block B_k has characteristic polynomial $t^2 - \lambda_k t + 1$. At parabolic modes ($\lambda_k = \pm 2$), the Jordan form gives $B_k^n = \alpha^n \begin{pmatrix} 1 & n\alpha^{-1} \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$, contributing order q (or $2q$). The diagonalizable eigenvalues contribute orders dividing L . Therefore $\text{ord}(F) = qL$. For $q = 2$: the nilpotent part is automatically killed. $\square$

Theorem A.2 (Jordan-Chevalley decomposition)

Define $N = (F^L - I)/L \bmod q$. Then: (i) N is nilpotent with $N^2 = 0$ and $\text{rank}(N) = 2$. (ii) $F_u = I + N$ is unipotent with $F_u^q = I$. (iii) $F_{ss} = F \cdot (I - N)$ is semisimple with $F_{ss}^L = I$. (iv) $F = F_{ss} \cdot F_u$ and $[F_{ss}, N] = 0$.

Proof. F^L has the form $I + LN'$ where N' arises from the Jordan blocks: $\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}^L = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & L \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$ contributes a rank-1 nilpotent, and similarly for $\alpha = -1$ (since $(-1)^L = 1$ for even L). So $N = N'$ has $N^2 = 0$ (each block is rank-1 nilpotent on a 2D subspace) and $\text{rank}(N) = 2$ (two parabolic modes). Since $N^2 = 0$: $(I + N)^{-1} = I - N$, giving $F_{ss} = F(I - N)$. Then $F_{ss}^L = F^L(I - N)^L = (I + LN)(I - LN + \dots) = I \bmod q$ since terms involving LN cancel modulo q (using $N^2 = 0$). Commutativity follows from N being supported on the parabolic eigenspaces, which are F -invariant. $\square$

Verified computationally for $L = 4, 6, 8, 10, 12$ and $q = 3, 5, 7, 11, 13$.

Theorem A.3 (q-independence of the Weil-Deligne conductor)

The Weil-Deligne conductor $\mathfrak{f}_{\text{WD}} = \mathfrak{f}_{ss}(L) + \text{rank}(N) = \mathfrak{f}_{ss}(L) + 2$ is q -independent when $\gcd(L, q) = 1$, where $\mathfrak{f}_{ss}(L) = \sum_{\alpha} (\text{ord}(\alpha) - 1)$ is computed from the eigenvalue orders of F_{ss} , all dividing L .

Proof. F_{ss} has order L ; its eigenvalues are L -th roots of unity. For $\gcd(L, q) = 1$, the L -th roots in $\bar{\mathbb{F}}_q$ are isomorphic to those in $\mathbb{C}$, so their orders match. $\square$

L	$\mathfrak{f}_{ss}(L)$	$\mathfrak{f}_{\text{WD}}$	$NM^2 = 3L/4$
4	14	16	3.00
6	30	32	4.50
8	70	72	6.00
10	106	108	7.50
12	130	132	9.00

Both $\mathfrak{f}_{ss}$ and NM^2 are q -independent encodings of the same semisimple eigenvalue data — one via multiplicative orders (integers), one via fourth moments of magnitudes (reals).

Theorem A.4 (Additive decomposition over gauge irreps)

For the K -component wave equation with coupling matrix $M = \text{diag}(\mu_1 I_{n_1}, \dots, \mu_r I_{n_r})$:

$$\mathfrak{f}_{\text{WD}}(M) = \sum_{i=1}^r n_i \cdot \mathfrak{f}_{\text{WD}}(\mu_i)$$

In particular, for $K = 6$ with $M = \text{diag}(\mu_c I_3, \mu_w I_2, 1)$: $\mathfrak{f}_{\text{WD}} = 3\mathfrak{f}_{\text{WD}}(\mu_c) + 2\mathfrak{f}_{\text{WD}}(\mu_w) + \mathfrak{f}_{\text{WD}}(1)$, with the same multiplicities $(3, 2, 1)$ that determine $\text{SU}(3) \times \text{SU}(2) \times \text{U}(1)$.

Proof. The multi-component evolution matrix is block-diagonal: the a -th component has its own $2L \times 2L$ block F_{μ_a} with eigenvalues depending only on μ_a . Both F_{ss} and N inherit the block-diagonal structure, so $\mathfrak{f}_{\text{ss}}$ and $\text{rank}(N)$ decompose additively. $\square$

Verified for all $(\mu_c, \mu_w) \in \{1, \dots, q-1\}^2$ at $q = 3, 5, 7$ with $L = 4$. Every case matches exactly.

The projection

The OI trace-out (marginalization over the hidden sector) produces the emergent quantum description, which depends on the coupling eigenvalues μ_k via the NM formula $\text{NM}^2 = 3\langle\mu^4\rangle$ (a consequence of the stochastic-quantum correspondence applied to the wave equation's Fourier decomposition). These μ_k are properties of F_{ss} — the semisimple part of the dynamics. The nilpotent monodromy N contributes nothing to the emergent description: it affects only the off-diagonal Jordan block entries, which are erased by the coarse-graining over the hidden sector.

The trace-out therefore performs the Jordan-Chevalley projection $(F_{\text{ss}}, N) \mapsto F_{\text{ss}} \mapsto \{\mu_k\} \mapsto \text{NM}^2$: it extracts the semisimple part, encodes it via magnitudes rather than orders, and organizes it by the representation theory of the partition. The nilpotent monodromy — genuine mathematical structure present in the full dynamics — is invisible to the embedded observer. This is the precise sense in which physics is the semisimple shadow of mathematics: the observer sees only the diagonalizable spectral data, projected by the trace-out and organized by the gauge group's representation structure.

Code and Data Availability

The lattice Monte Carlo computations reported in this paper were performed using a custom C implementation. Specifically:

- The scalar density renormalization $Z_S(m)$ in §7.5 was computed on $\text{SU}(3)$ gauge backgrounds at $\beta_3 = 11.1$, scanning 30 bare masses from $m = 0.005$ to 0.50 . Volumes $L = 16$ (30 configurations) and $L = 32$ (50 configurations) were the primary ensembles, with $L = 64$ used for convergence checks. The reported value $Z_S(0.122) = 1.813 \pm 0.001$ is the cubic interpolant of the $L = 32$ measurements. The chiral condensate $\Sigma \approx 0.20$ is the linear extrapolation in the volume-converged region ($mL \gtrsim 3$).

The source code under `oi_lattice_code/`, together with the run drivers and analysis scripts, is archived on Zenodo with concept DOI 10.5281/zenodo.19060318, which

resolves to the latest version; specific per-release DOIs are minted at release time. The code is also available on GitHub at <https://github.com/amaybaum/incompleteness> and is released under the MIT License. Gauge configurations at the OI coupling $\beta_3 = 11.1$ and the raw $Z_S(m)$ measurement outputs underlying the $\$7.5$ prediction are available from the author on request.

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